



NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP

EDGuide



ISSUE 9-10

*The beginning is
always today.*

— Mary Shelley



2025

SEPTEMBER - OCTOBER

NHEG EDGUIDE

EDITORIAL TEAM

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Contents

2	EDITORIAL TEAM
4	THOUGHT OF THE MONTH
8-15	OPEN EBOOKS
18-29	NHEG BOOKS
50-69	NHEG COURSE
68-69	MISSING CHILDREN
88-99	NHEG INTERNET RADIO PROGRAM
110-111	NHEG BIRTHDAYS AND ANNIVERSARIES
114-115	EARN BOX TOPS

116-119	PRESS RELEASE
120-123	NHEG STUDENTS ARTICLES
124-165	FEE ARTICLES
166-171	RECIPES
172-173	NHEG PARTNERS & AFFILIATES

Thought for the Month



As the school year begins, we wish you a year brimming with knowledge, personal growth, new opportunities, enriching field trips, and genuine learning experiences.

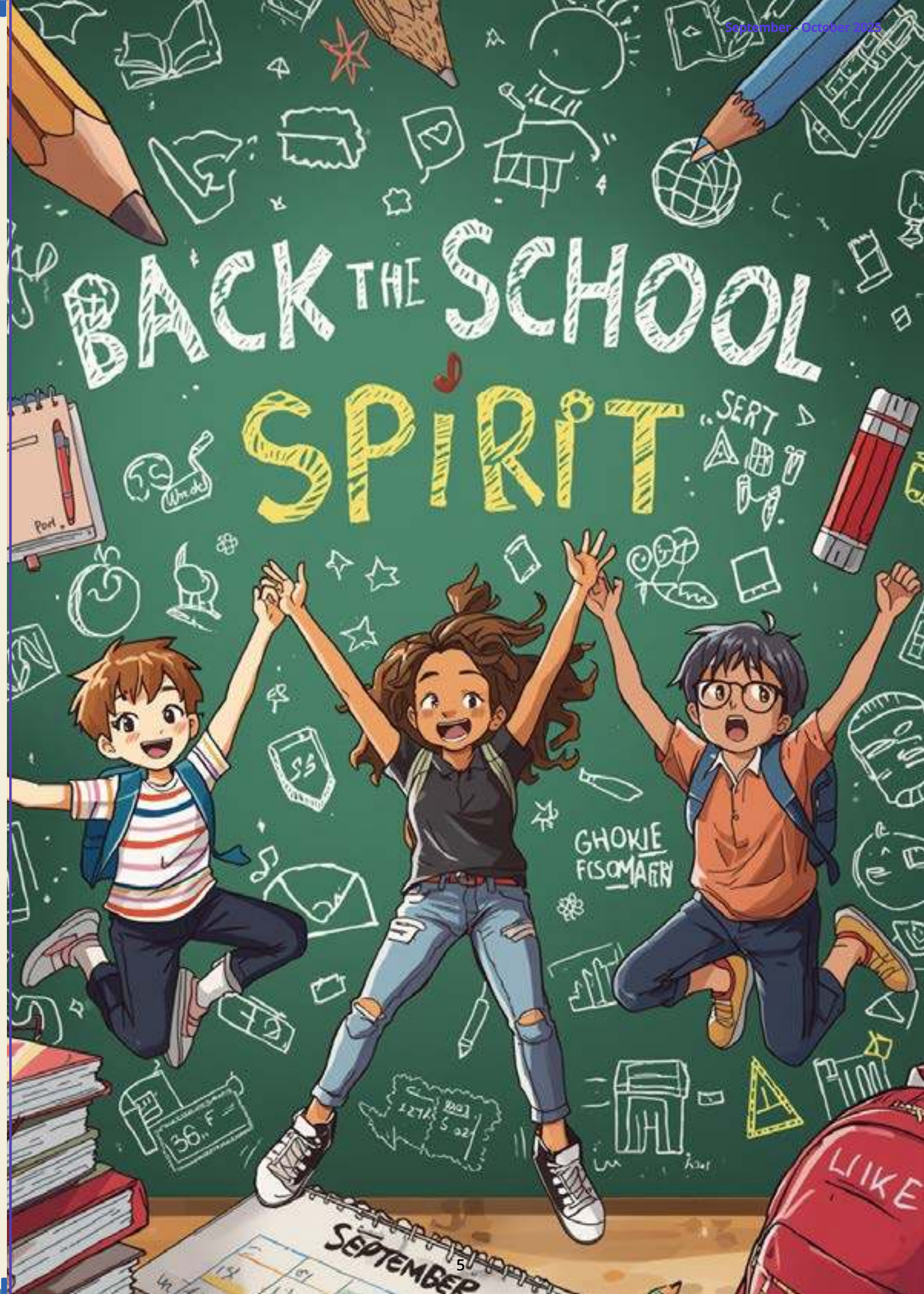
May you cultivate a passion for discovering new things and exploring the world around you.

Pamela Clark
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The White House <noreply@contact.whitehouse.gov>
To: info@newheightseducation.org

Wed, Aug 6, 2025 at 6:31 PM



THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

August 6, 2025

Dear Mrs. Clark,

Thank you for taking the time to share your views regarding education.

As President, some of my most critical duties are to restore greatness to the American education system, return common sense to our classrooms, and empower parents to choose the education that best suits their needs and values. My Administration's policy is simple: Parents and local communities-not progressive bureaucrats in Washington, D.C.-have the fundamental right as Americans to oversee their children's education.

My Administration is putting an end to the federal control that has failed generations of American children-and we are returning authority back where it belongs: with States, parents, and local communities. To that end, I have directed my Secretary of Education to facilitate the closure of the Department of Education, which has overseen an American literacy crisis of historic proportions. At the same time, we are banning unlawful "Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion" mandates, withholding federal funds from schools that push anti-American propaganda, and revoking visas for foreign students who hate our country. Our education system must be based on merit and love of country so that the next generation of American students will grow, thrive, succeed, and take pride in our Nation.

With the passage of the historic One Big Beautiful Bill earlier this year, my Administration also expanded education savings accounts and is prioritizing school choice in grant programs so that families have the freedom to select the charter, public, religious, or home school option that works best for their child.

These reforms will ensure that every student receives the high-quality education they deserve. America's Golden Age begins in the classroom, and by restoring the greatest education system in the world, we are building a stronger future for our culture, our children, and our beloved country.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be "Donald Trump", with a large, stylized initial "D" and "T".

You may follow President Trump and the White House on [Facebook](#), [Instagram](#), [X](#), and [YouTube](#).

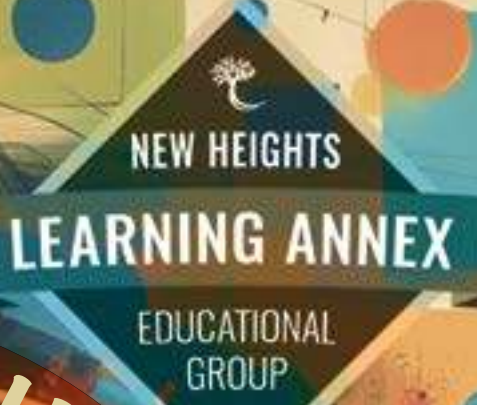
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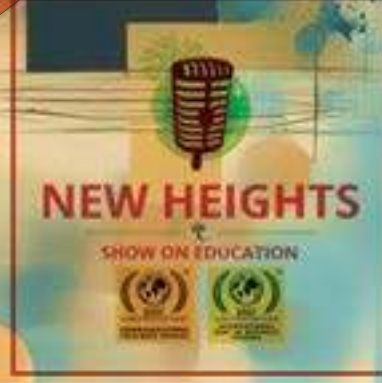


PROMOTES LITERACY FOR CHILDREN AND ADULTS





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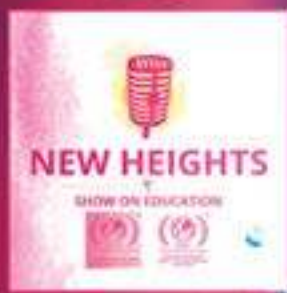
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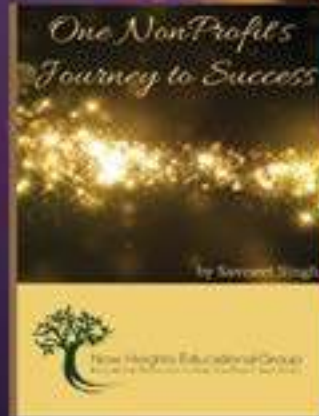


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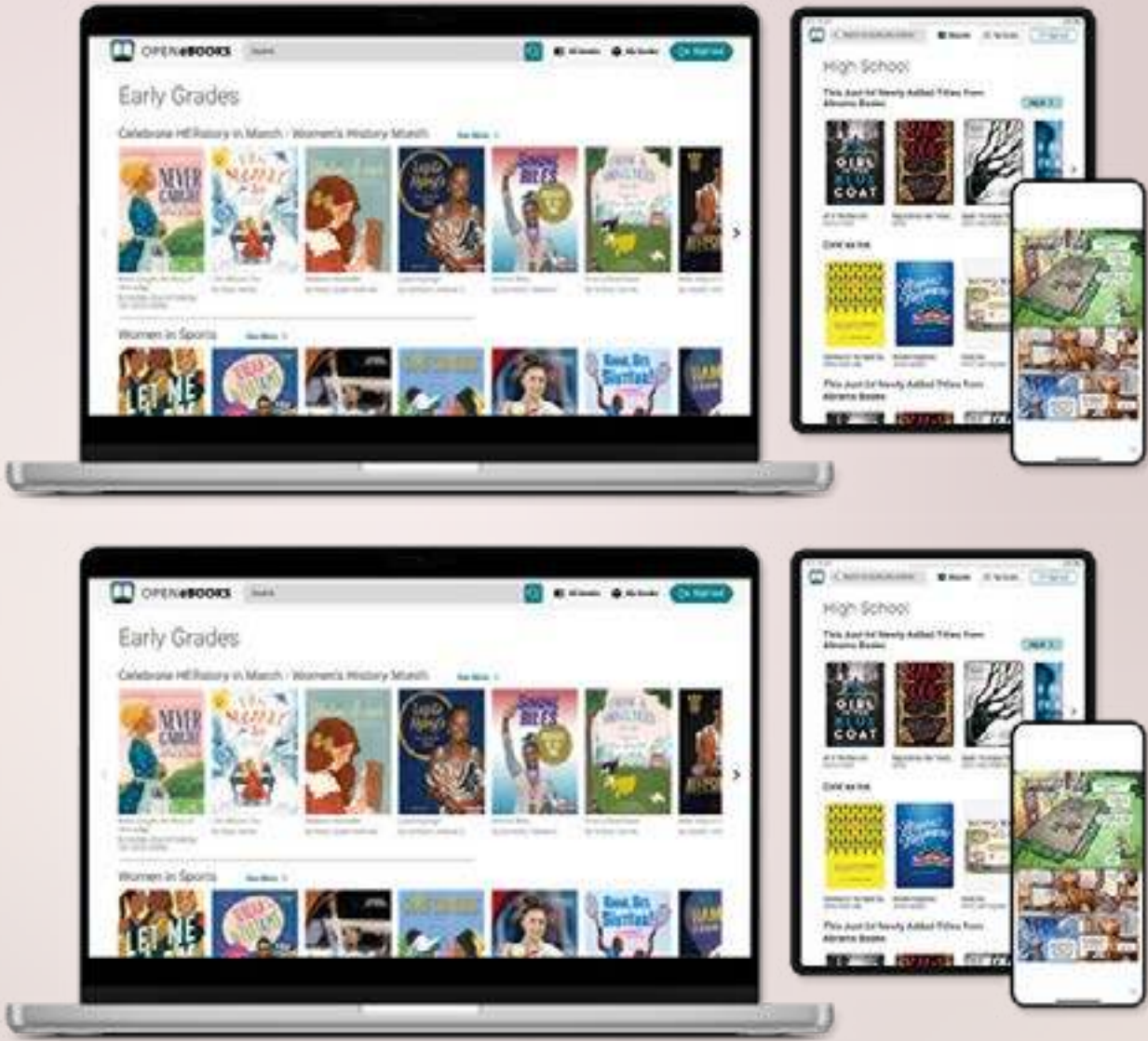


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New Heights Educational Group

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CONTACT US





Dear Friends of New Heights Educational Group

Hello! My name is Heather Ruggiero. In 2017, I began working with the organization as a tutor and course developer. I'm excited to be joining the Board of Directors and contributing to the organization as the Assistant Virtual Development Director of Education.

vision

I envision an evolution in education, where we compassionately walk alongside our students on the learning journey. Instead of manufacturing them to a set of standards, we nurture their creativity, curiosity, and innate love for learning.



background

Education is not the filling of a pail, but the lighting of a fire.

personal notes

With a warm cup of tea, favorite blanket, and our fluffy Shiba Inu, my (almost) five-year old daughter and I relish a good story book.

It's my pleasure to support the growth and efforts of the New Heights Educational Group and to create meaningful resources for the community.

MASTERS OF ARTS,
ELEMENTARY EDUCATION



TEACHER, TUTOR, CURRICULUM
DEVELOPER, CONTENT CREATOR

BACHELORS OF SCIENCE, BUSINESS
MANAGEMENT



DIRECTOR, ADMINISTRATOR,
COORDINATOR, CONSULTANT



Heather Ruggiero

Uplifting Memoir UNPREDICTABLE Chronicles Abuse Recovery, Courage

Through Faith

SUBHEAD: Palmetto Publishing unveils stellar, inspirational autobiography on overcoming lifelong trauma

CHARLESTON, SC, November 9, 2023 (GLOBE NEWSWIRE) –

Honey Kasper is an overcomer. After beating cancer, surviving eighty-nine surgeries, and processing a childhood filled with every kind of abuse, she has built a successful and deeply fulfilling life. Her true story is recounted in her memoir, Unpredictable: The walk in and out of darkness, a brand new title launched this fall by Palmetto Publishing. Kasper’s website contains additional information.

The book was written to reach those who have faced chronic illness, other serious health conditions, domestic violence, and childhood trauma. Kasper believes sharing her story candidly will help readers experience a sense of camaraderie in their journeys. More than anything, she believes she was able to heal as a result of her faith. Kasper describes her story as “the hand of God steering my life away from tragedy,” and she adds that “overcoming with grace and faith in God can change a life.”

The book itself is deeply emotional, showing how trauma can affect a person’s mindset for a lifetime—but also demonstrating how perseverance and taking back control of one’s choices can help survivors to recover. The title also features a collection of poems and a list of song titles that the author has found inspirational.

Reviewers have called the book “an insightful, honest, and inspirational tale of a battle survivor,” and a story that “gives hope to readers . . . from dysfunctionalfamilies.” Kasper, who writes under a pseudonym, invites readers to embark on the incredible journey of healing, and to “build a life of purpose and love.” Kasper can be found on Twitter (@KasperHoney) Facebook and LinkedIn for readers who wish to stay connected.

UNPREDICTABLE: THE WALK IN AND OUT OF DARKNESS is available for purchase online at Amazon.com and Barnes and Noble.com.

About the Author:

Honey Kasper is an overcomer whose life shows how grace and faith in God can transform a life. Having survived many years of abuse, trauma, severe malnutrition, over eighty-nine surgeries, and cancer, Kasper writes to help people find freedom from their struggles.

About the Book:

Title: Unpredictable: The walk in and out of darkness

Author: Honey Kasper

Publisher: Palmetto Publishing

Publication date: November 2023

ISBN-13: 979-8-8229-3211-1

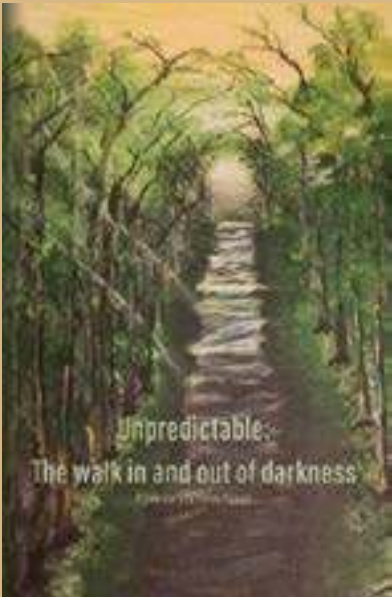
Media Contact:

Honey Kasper

Email: unpredictablethewalk@yahoo.com

Available for interviews: Author, Honey Kasper

Related Images



FROM DARKNESS TO TRIUMPH: A TALE OF FAITH AND RESILIENCE

Step into Honey Kasper’s world as she navigates life’s cruelest challenges. In *Unpredictable: The Walk in and Out of Darkness*, Honey shares her tale of survival against malnutrition, surgeries, abuse, and cancer. Fueled by faith and resilience, this is a story of triumph over trauma. Be inspired. Find hope.

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2024 INTERNATIONAL IMPACT BOOK AWARDS

- WINNER -

AWARDED TO

Honey Kasper

Unpredictable: the walk in and out of
darkness

Inspirational & Religious Autobiographies

Presented by Go All In Media, May , 2024







HONEY
KASPER,
AUTHOR

<https://UnpredictableTheWalk.com/>
UnpredictableTheWalk@yahoo.com
NW Ohio



DEADLINE: Uplifting Memoir UNPREDICTABLE Chronicles Abuse Recovery, Courage Through Faith.
SUBHEAD: Unpredictable: the walk in and out of darkness, just became a bestseller. Palmetto Publishing unveiled this stellar, inspirational autobiography on overcoming lifelong trauma in November 2023.

NW Ohio Author October 4, 2024 -

Honey Kasper is an overcomer. Two battles with cancer, surviving ninety-three surgeries, and processing a childhood filled with every kind of abuse, she has built a successful and deeply fulfilling life. Her true story is recounted in her memoir, Unpredictable: The walk in and out of darkness, her work became a bestseller on

October 4, 2024. The Kindle e-book scored Best Sellers Rank: #317 Free in Kindle Store

#1 in Two-Hour Biography & Memoir Short Reads

#2 in Survival Biographies & Memoirs

The book was written to reach those who have faced chronic illness, other serious health conditions, domestic violence, and childhood trauma. Kasper believes sharing her story candidly will help readers experience a sense of camaraderie in their journeys. More than anything, she believes she was able to heal as a result of her faith. Kasper describes her story as "the hand of God steering my life away from tragedy," and she adds that "overcoming with grace and faith in God can change a life."

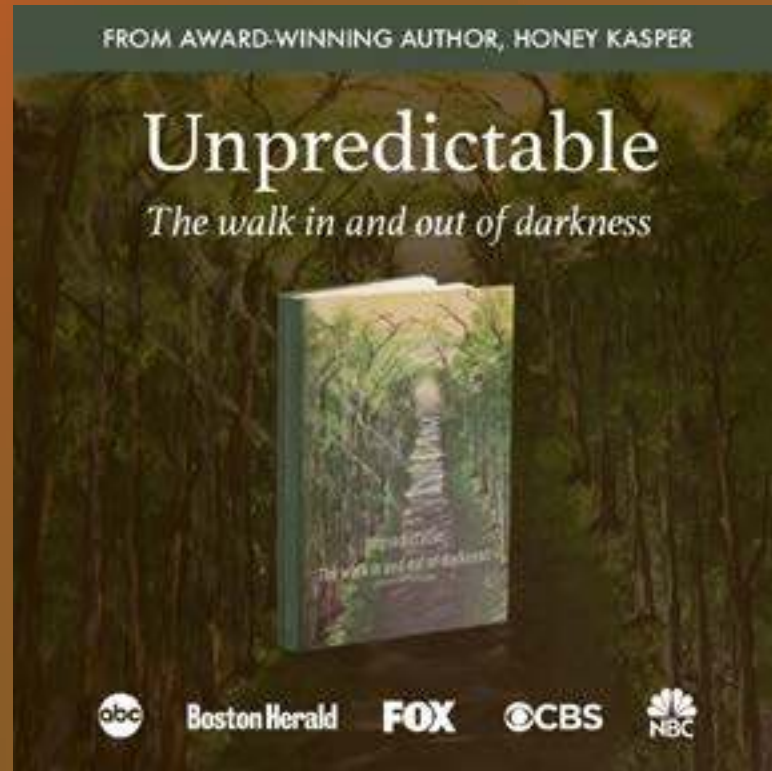
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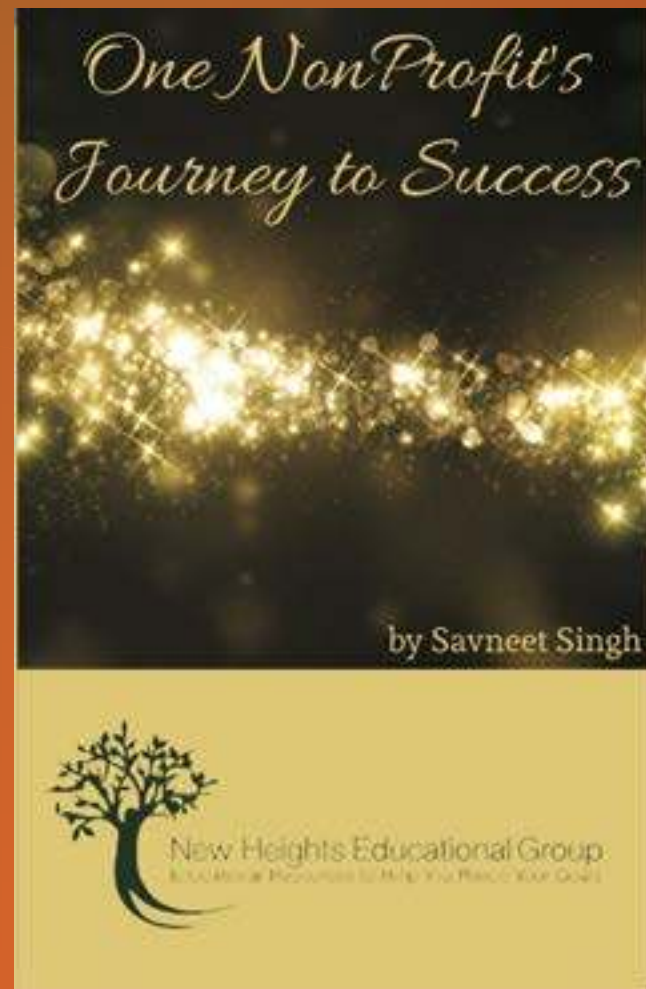
NW Ohio Author

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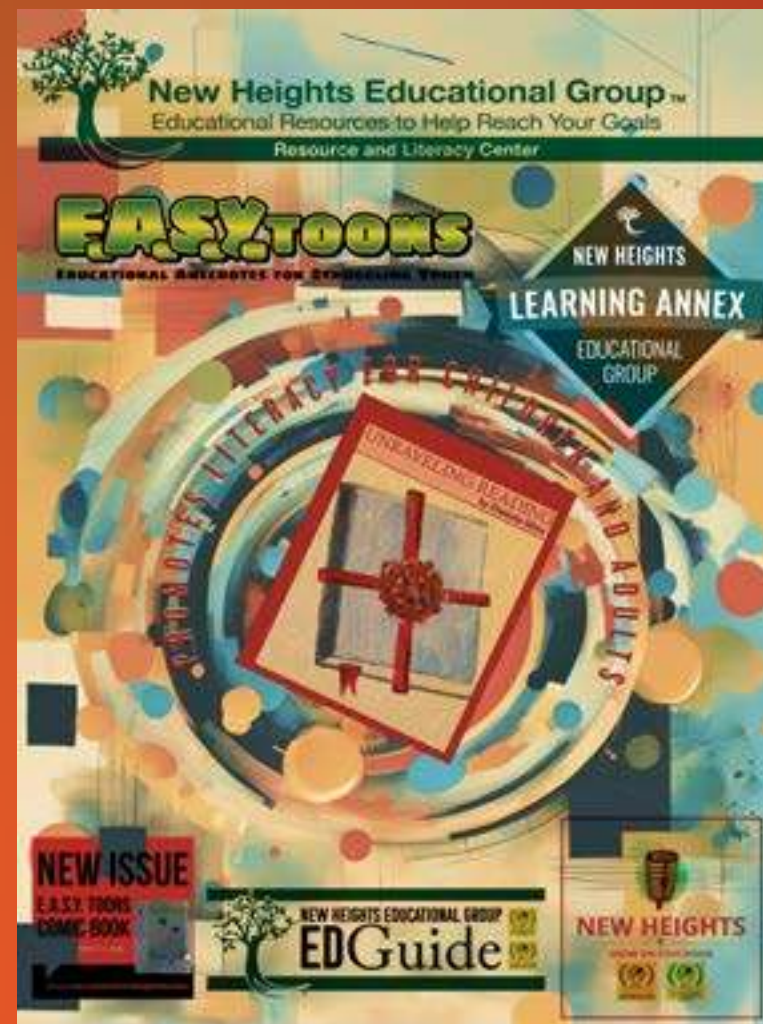
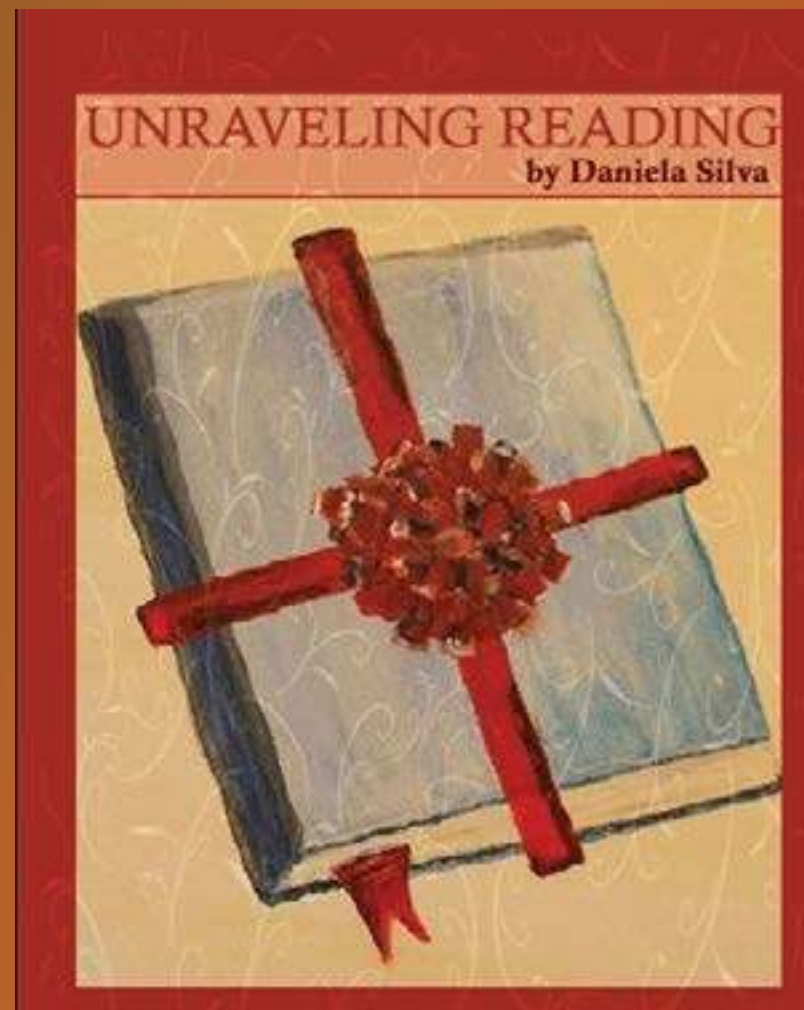




One Nonprofit's Journey to Success



Unraveling Reading



One Nonprofit's Journey to Success - NHEG's New Book

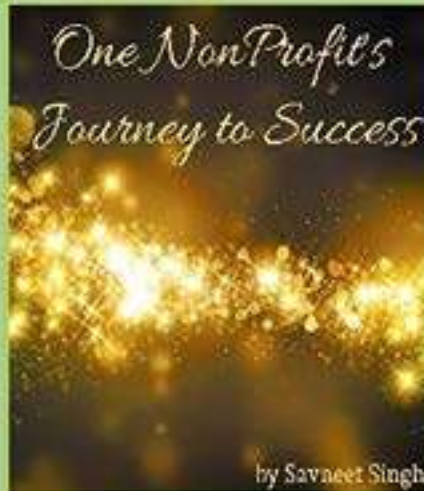
Savneet Singh, MS, M.Ed., M.Sc.

About Our Writer

Savneet discovered the world of freelance writing 9 years back and she is currently exploring the endless possibilities associated with it.

She had the pleasure to work on several projects as a writer, instructional designer and social media specialist.

She has a strong inclination for spirituality, and practices meditation and yoga every morning during the sunrise.

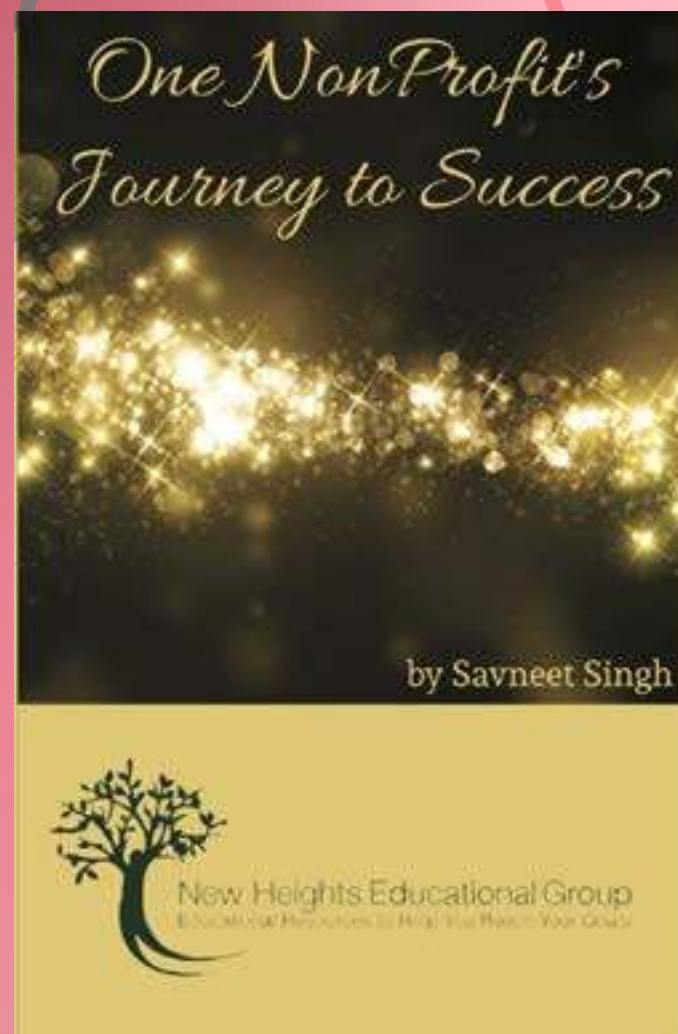


Book Summary

This book will make people believe that there's a natural power dynamic that comes along with personal experience and willingness to serve others. Parents, nonprofit stakeholders or just someone who wants to learn more about educational services and opportunities - everyone will find this book helpful. Many readers will find Ms. Clark's good work, perseverance and Christian faith inspirational.



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International Adult Literacy Facts

ProLiteracy's work to improve adult literacy rates worldwide directly aligns with the UN Sustainable Development Goal on education to ensure all youth and a substantial number of adults—both men and women—achieve literacy and numeracy by 2030.¹

763 Million

adults worldwide do not have basic literacy skills.

The Global State of Literacy

Despite the steady rise in literacy rates over the past 50 years, United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) data shows that in 2020, 763 million adults worldwide still don't have basic literacy skills.

While more adults are literate today, it is largely because more went to school when they were young—not because they were given a second chance to learn as adults.²

Low Literacy Rates by Region³



The Cost of Low Literacy

Economic

\$1 Trillion

Low literacy costs the global economy more than **\$1 trillion** each year.⁴

30%-42% less earnings

Adults with low literacy earn **30%-42% less** than their literate peers.⁵

Social

50% more likely

In developing countries, a child born to a mother who can read is **50% more likely to survive** past age 5.⁶

If all adults completed secondary school, the global poverty rate would be more than halved.⁷

Women's Literacy

2/3 of adults with low literacy skills are women.⁸



50%

More than half of all disadvantaged rural women in developing countries lack basic literacy skills.⁹

Of the 99 million illiterate youth, **56% are girls.**¹⁰

56%

The Digital Divide



No Internet Access

53% of people in developing countries do not have access to the Internet compared to 13% in the rest of the world.

Globally, only **40%** of primary, **50%** of intermediate, and **65%** of high school-level schools have internet access.

Almost 9% of the global population—and more than **70%** of people in rural sub-Saharan Africa—**lack access to electricity.**¹¹

ProLiteracy

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US Adult Literacy Facts

US Facts

48 Million

Approximately 48 million adults in the United States cannot read above a third-grade level.¹

Member Services

51%

51% of ProLiteracy member programs put students on a waiting list due to demand exceeding program capacity.²

29%

29% of adult basic literacy students enter a program reading at or below a third-grade level.³

The Cost of Low Literacy

\$2.2 Trillion

Bringing all adults to the equivalent of a sixth-grade reading level would generate an additional \$2.2 trillion in annual income for the country.⁴

\$106-238 Billion

It is estimated between \$106-\$238 billion in health care costs a year are linked to low adult literacy skills.⁵

English Language Learners

50.6 Million

The US has the world's largest immigrant population. Immigrants comprise 15% of the US population.⁶

53% Proficient

Among immigrants only half (53%) are proficient English speakers.⁷

3X The Earnings

Workers who have less education than a high school diploma have the lowest median weekly earnings (\$592), three times less than the highest level of education.⁸

One-in-Six

The US immigrant population is projected to grow to 69 million by 2060, or to about one in six people living in the US.⁹

Incarceration

75%

75% of state incarcerated individuals did not complete high school or can be classified as low literate.¹⁰

43%

Incarcerated individuals who participate in correctional education programs are **43% less likely to recidivate** than inmates who do not.¹¹

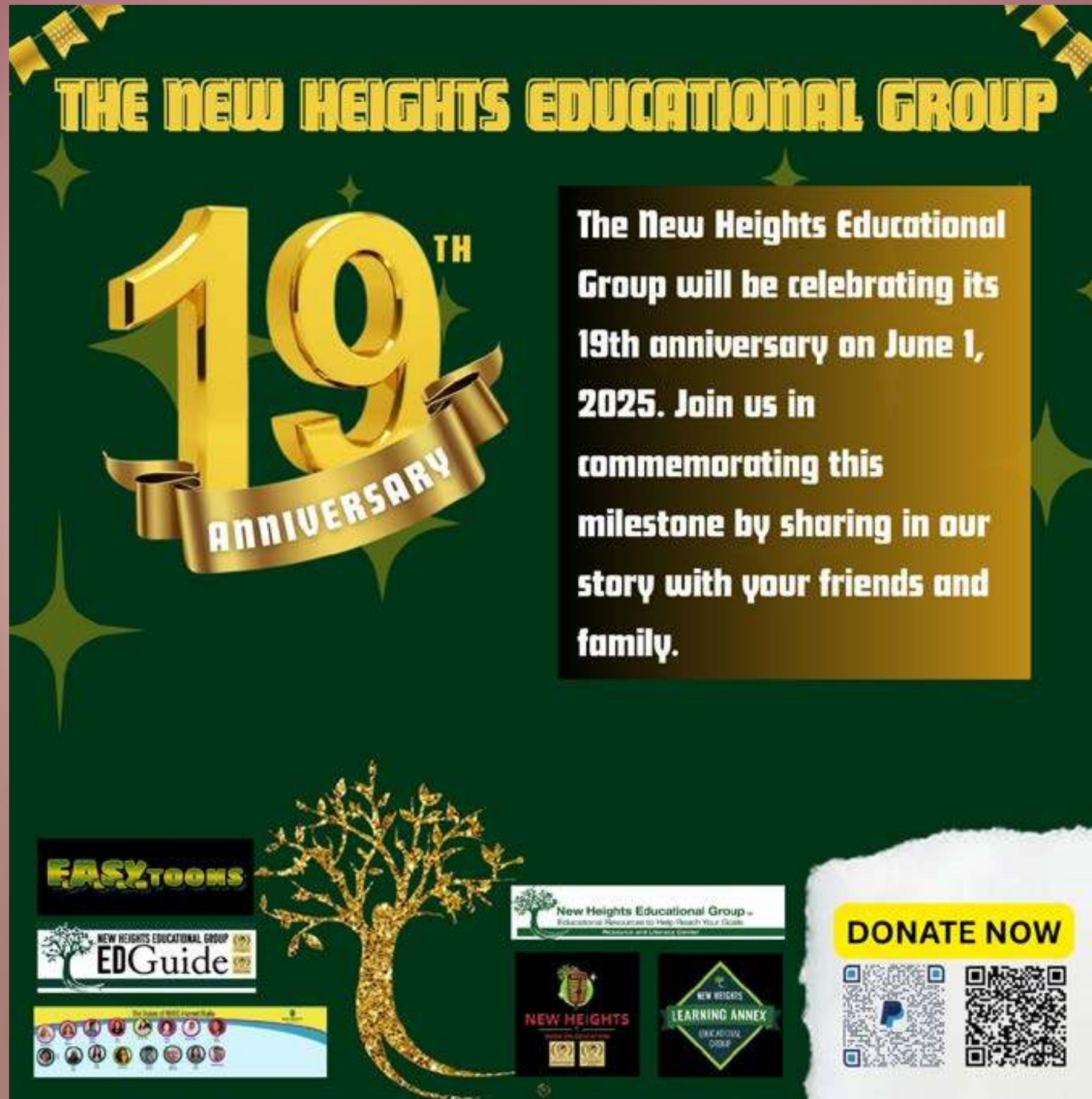
Family Literacy



A mother's reading skill is the greatest determinant of her children's future academic success, outweighing other factors, such as neighborhood and family income.¹²

ProLiteracy

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THE NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP

19TH
ANNIVERSARY

The New Heights Educational Group will be celebrating its 19th anniversary on June 1, 2025. Join us in commemorating this milestone by sharing in our story with your friends and family.

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Thank you for all that you do

Hi Pamela,

We hope you and your team are achieving all your year-end appeal goals (and more)! Remember, as you use our tools during this busy time, our team and our partners are here to answer your questions and help you find the best resources to meet the moment.

Our team is in awe of how New Heights Educational Group is making its mark on the world. We see how you are continually asked to do more with less, yet still create meaningful change in your community. It is such a joy to engage with you and the over 300,000 nonprofits around the globe who are leveraging Microsoft resources to drive this positive impact.

Your stories inspire us every day and we are grateful for your tireless work.

Thank you again for all that you do, and we look forward to deepening our collaboration in the year ahead.

Regards,
Microsoft Tech for Social Impact

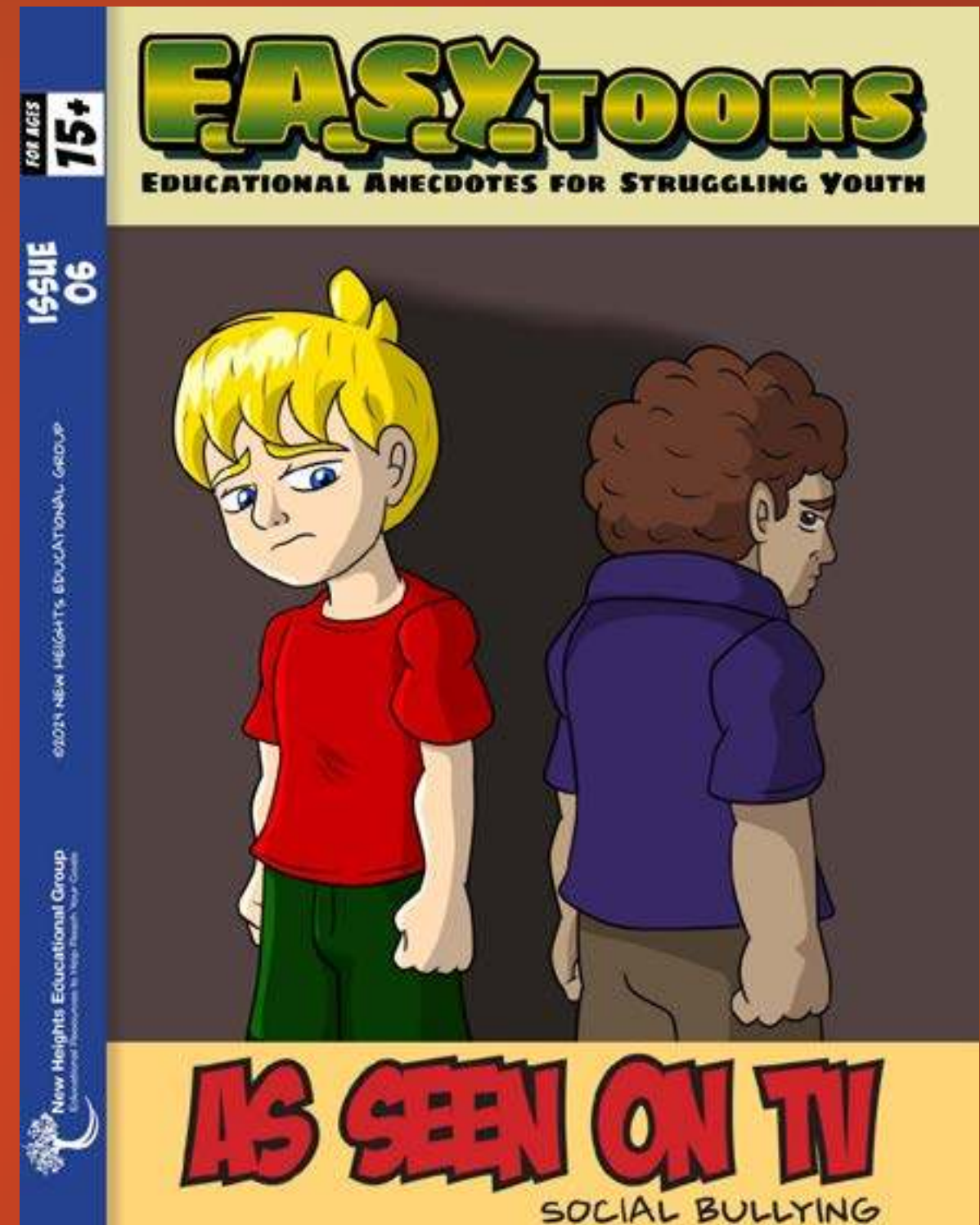
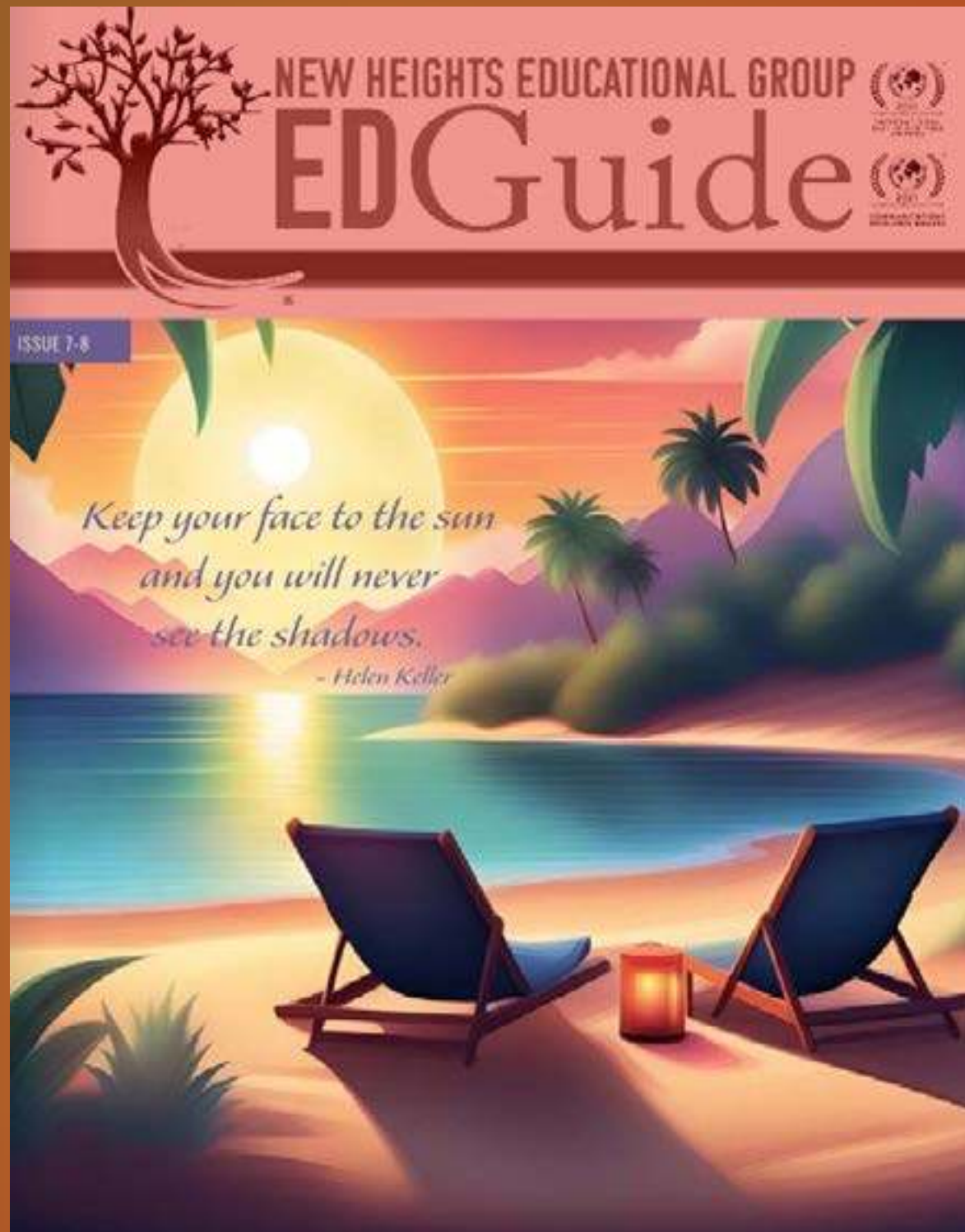
 

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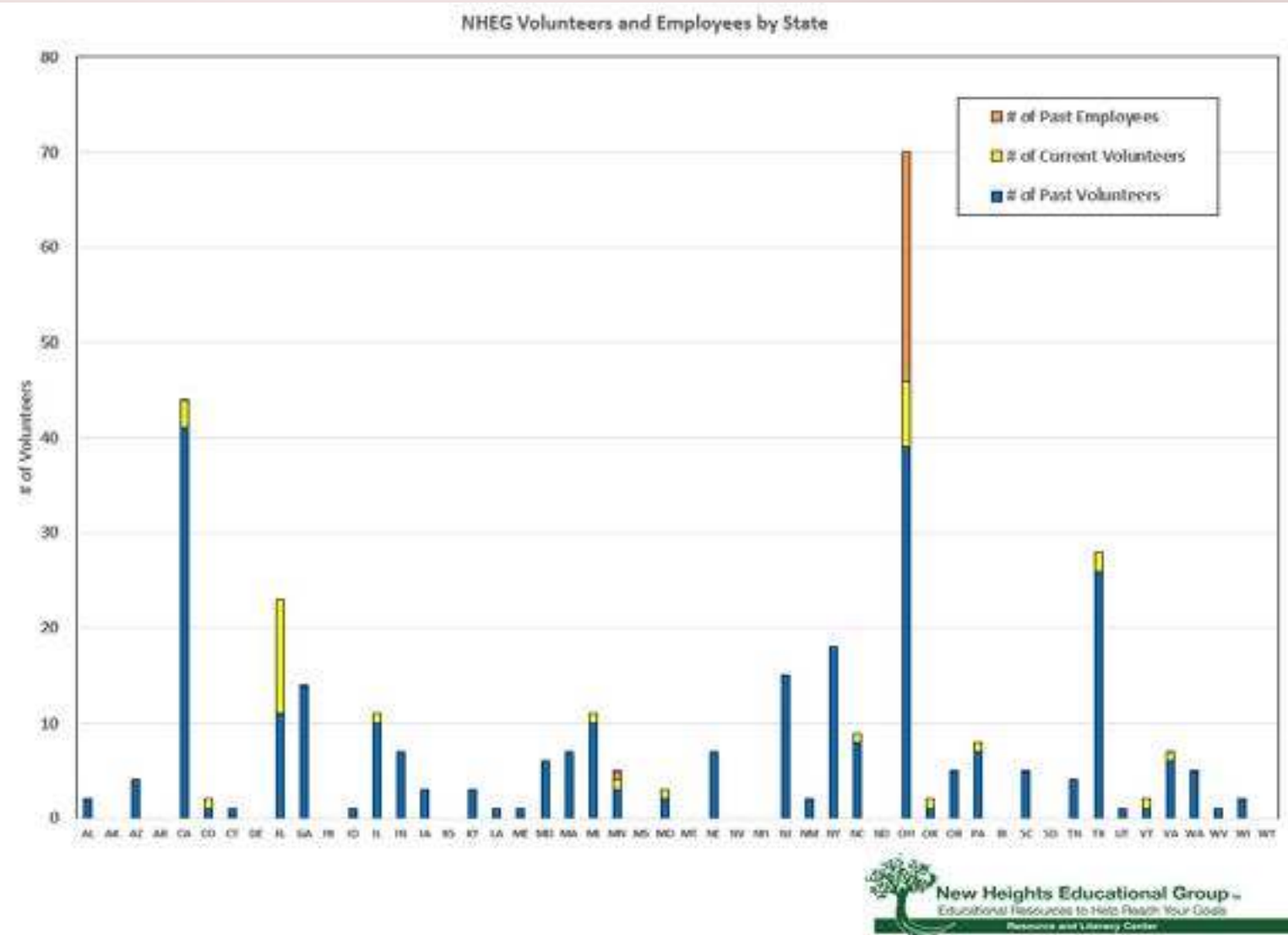
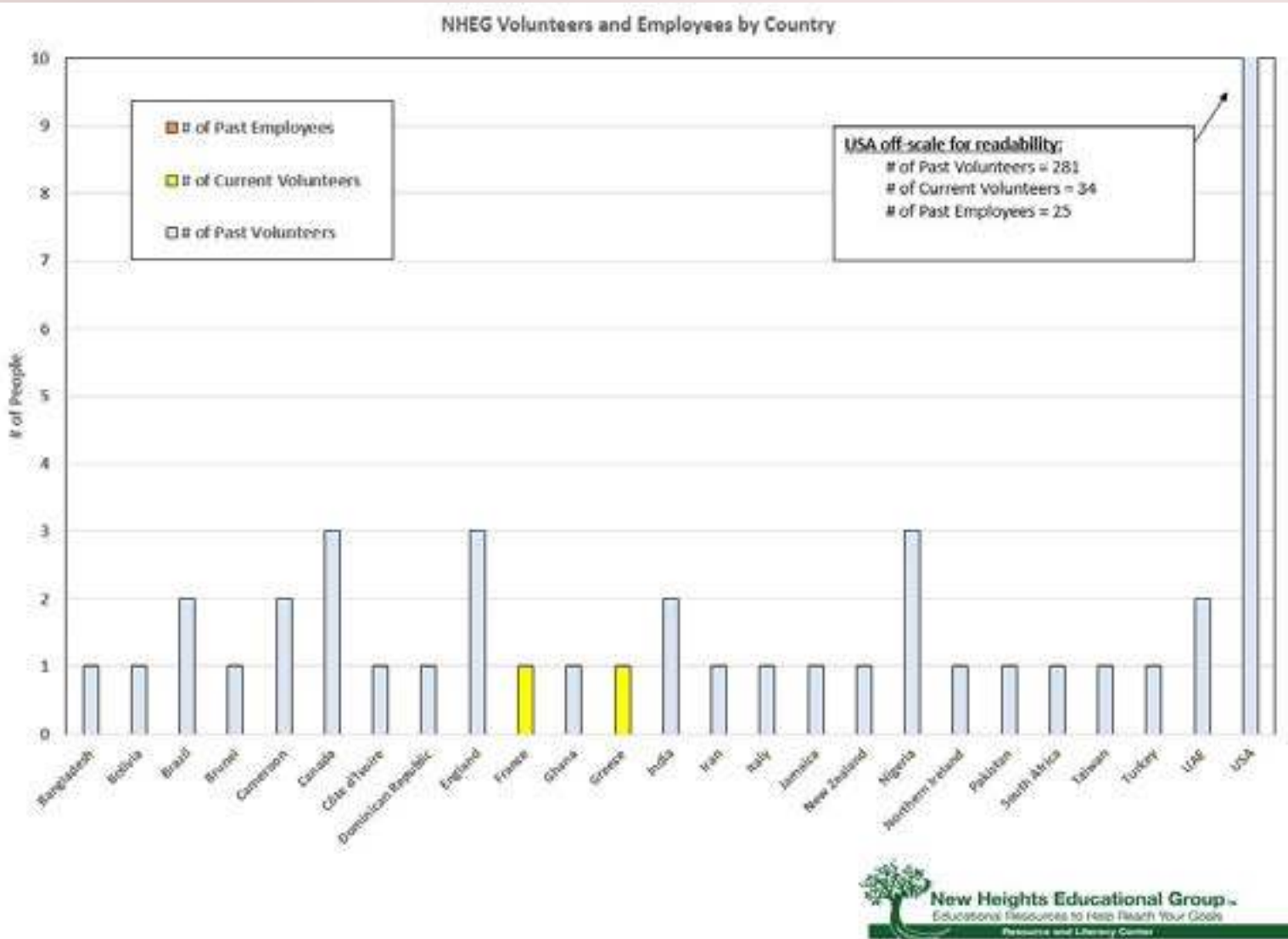
Silver
Transparency
2024

Candid.

Gold
Transparency
2024

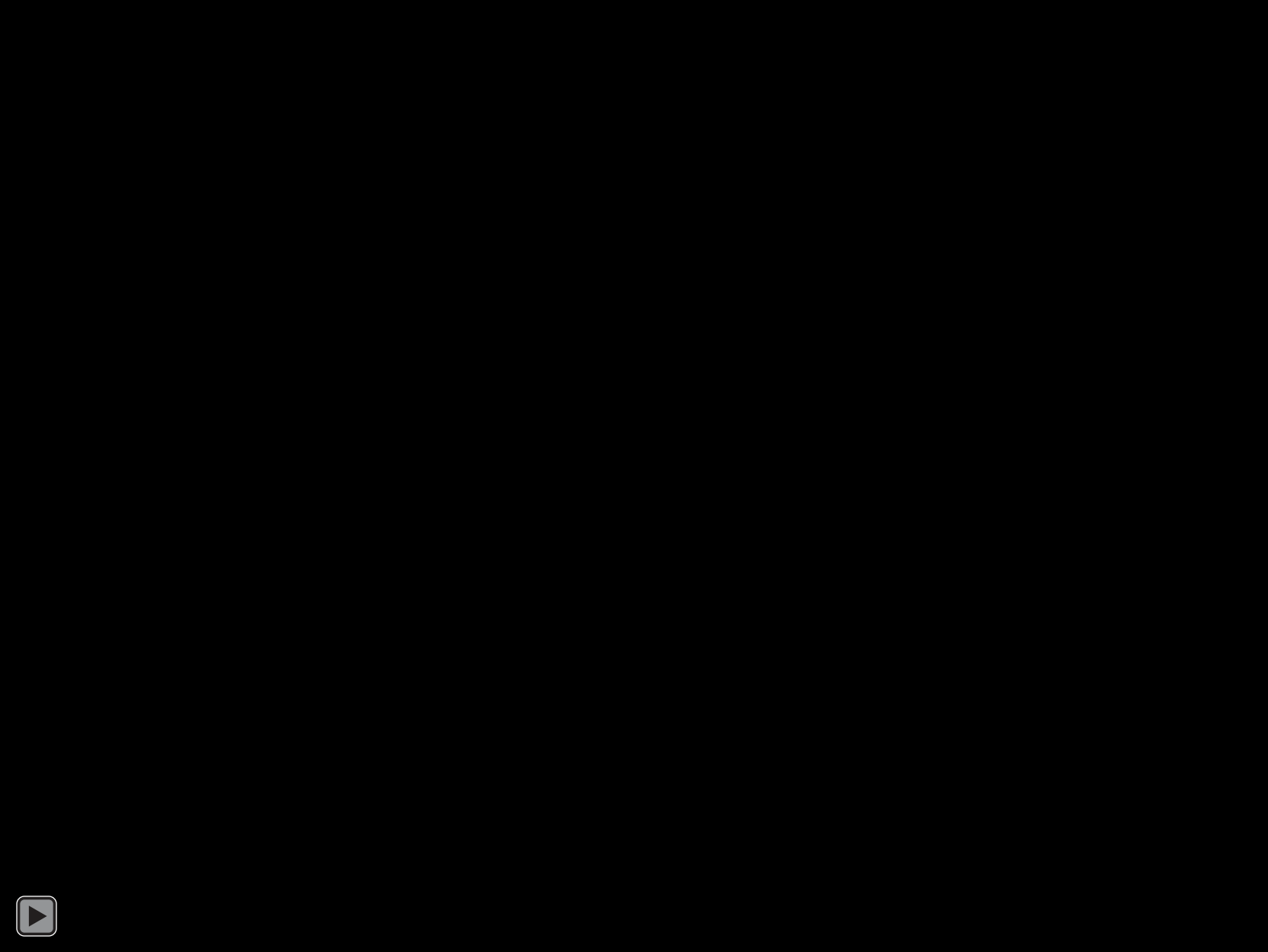
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New Volunteer Stats



Organized/Created by Gary Stevens

NHEG PITCH DECK



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NHEG fall/winter fundraiser will provide much needed funds to keep our services, NHEG created courses and website(s) free and available to all those looking to improve their lives.

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Reading for a Reason



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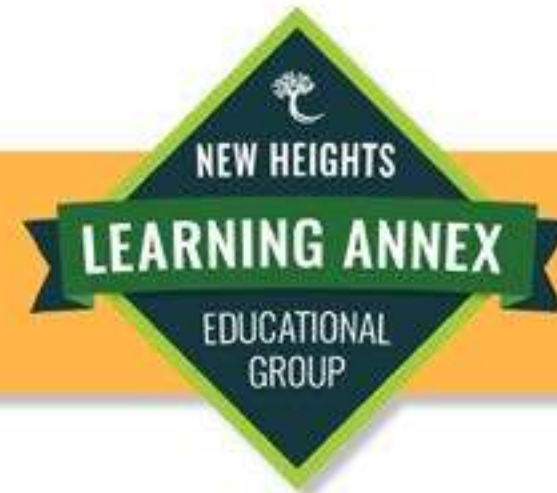
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NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP COURSE CATALOG



2025-2026 School Year CATALOG

Language Arts



WRITING

In this ten-lesson writing course, students will learn about basic writing patterns. The course includes warm-up exercises, detailed instructions and multiple examples for students to visualize writing movements. Students will also have the opportunity to practice writing strategies to develop functional handwriting. At the end of the course, students will be proficient in basic writing skills and able to compose words involving different types of letters.

LEARN TO READ - YOUTH

FREE!

The NHEG Learn to Read online course aims to educate parents/tutors/teachers/guides on how to help their student practice reading skills and fluency, cultivate strategies for reading, broaden vocabulary, increase spelling ability and conquer reading anxieties. Proven exercises and fun tips are provided to keep the student motivated and engaged throughout the process. The course takes the student and their selected reading guide through easy-to-follow stages – Expectations & Tips for Success, Prepare, Read in a Relaxed Setting, After Reading, Daily Practice and Practice Tips – creating a foundation of literacy on which they can build over time.

This course is for younger students from first grade to seventh grade.
Note: This class works as a complement to the lessons in Natural Speller, which are available, for free, on NHEG's website.



LEARN TO READ - ADULTS

The NHEG Learn to Read: Adult Literacy online course gives teachers/tutors/reading guides strategies for helping older students acquire literacy skills and provides methods for consistent, repeated practice. The course demonstrates the reputable and proven Laubach method, and provides resources for continuing practice beyond the course: Preparing for the Course, Reading the Laubach Charts, Reading the Laubach Stories, Writing the Laubach Lessons, Continuing Your Practice – creating a foundation of literacy on which they can build through consistent, repeated practice.

NHEG recommends the Laubach Learning System for middle school, high school and adult reading students. An online course for younger students is also available.

NATURAL SPELLER

FREE!

The NHEG Learn to Read online course aims to educate parents/tutors/teachers/guides on how to help their student practice reading skills and fluency, cultivate strategies for reading, broaden vocabulary, increase spelling ability and conquer reading anxieties. Proven exercises and fun tips are provided to keep the student motivated and engaged throughout the process. The course takes the student and her or his selected reading guide through easy-to-follow stages – Expectations & Tips for Success, Prepare, Read in a Relaxed Setting, After Reading, Daily Practice and Practice Tips – creating a foundation of literacy on which they can build over time.

Even though this course can be taken by a student of any age, we suggest the Laubach Learning System for middle school, high school and adult reading students. The course for using the Laubach Learning System is coming soon, so you will be able to choose which course is best for your student.

Note: This class works as a complement to the lessons in Natural Speller, which are available, for free, on NHEG's website.



Virtual Reading Five-Tier Program



ONE TIER



Is a virtual reading program designed for young children to read books along with 6-year-old Rishaan Gupta on special occasions. (Pre-school – 1st grade students)

TWO TIER



In partnership with 2nd & 7 Foundation and our Reading Ambassador Rhone-Ann Huang, we have implemented a virtual reading program for children. As part of 2nd & 7's "Tackling Illiteracy" program, and with the help of Zoom video conferencing, student-athletes will read with second-grade students and discuss why reading and staying on top of schoolwork is essential.

This school year, the volunteer readers are student-athletes from Dartmouth University. The "Hog Mollies" books were written by 2nd & 7. Each book is 30 pages and contains a different lesson and moral. There are 13 "Hog Mollies" books, and we have now read all of them. Don't worry "Hog Mollies" is releasing another book this summer. Check back for updates. All second-graders are welcome to listen.

All virtual readings are available from our site.



THREE TIER

Rhone-Ann Huang is reading 9th- to 12th-grade and young adult books weekly.

FOUR TIER



Rhone-Ann Huang reading time for students from 2nd to 5th grade.



FIVE TIER

Rhone-Ann Huang reading time for students from 6th – 8th grade.

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First Book Network



If your children or students lack access to quality books, NHEG can help provide them with a high quality, online library through the First Book Network. Members have 24-hour, year-round access to an award-winning repository of new and affordable books, educational resources and basic necessities curated for kids and young adults up to 18 years of age.

To claim access to these free books, contact us at Info@NewHeightsEducation.org and send us the name, email address and age for each child you would like access for. We will send you an email with sign-up information (check your spam folder if you don't see this email in your inbox).

New Heights Educational Group

We are now part of the First Book Network!

If your Child or Student lacks access to quality books, NHEG can help provide you with a high quality, online library through First Book.

FIRST BOOK 

Eliminating Barriers. Inspiring Young Minds.

Need Books?

Members of the First Book Network have 24-hour, year-round access to an award-winning repository of affordable and new books, educational resources, and basic necessities curated for kids in need ages 0-18.

WE CAN HELP
YOUR STUDENT
GAIN ACCESS TO
FREE, HIGH
QUALITY READING
MATERIAL!

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Foreign Languages



CHINESE

The 10-week course will take place for one hour twice a week and will be open for middle school to adult students who wish to learn to speak and write Chinese.

The pre-recorded course will include greetings, essential dialogues, useful words and phrases and basic grammar. This course will also teach students basic writing. For those students who don't have a Chinese name, this course will assist students in getting theirs! Throughout the process, students will learn about Chinese cultures and etiquette. This class is a great beginning course for anyone who wants to learn Mandarin Chinese but doesn't know where to start.

The course will introduce the Chinese writing system, both pinyin and the romanization system. It will have step-by-step guides on how to write Chinese characters and is great for a self-motivated beginner student who wants to learn to speak, read and write in Chinese. The course will provide beginner students of Chinese with a good basic knowledge of the language and build a great foundation for future learning.

FREE!



Science & Math

CHEMISTRY

In the NHEG Chemistry online course, we will provide you a better understanding of chemistry and how it is used.

We will discuss a variety of topics, from chemical bonds and reactions to electronegativity trends in the periodic table and atomic structure. It's important to complete all your assignments on time and on your own (and to have fun, too!).

FREE!



FREE!

GENEALOGY & DNA

NHEG is launching a Genealogy and Education course and a DNA and Education course. These courses will help students begin to explore their ancestry and are a precursor to a potential genealogy program that will help youth explore their roots.

These classes are for middle- and high school-level students and adults. In this course, students will explore the history of genealogy and be inspired to learn about their family history and its connection to their community.

Course topics:

- History of genealogy
- Family history and its ties to their environment
- Significance of learning about family history
- Steps to researching family history
- Sites to help organize a family tree
- Steps to downloading and transferring family tree data

ALGEBRA 1

Algebra 1 is a high-school level course that is typically taken in the 9th grade. It prepares students for more advanced mathematics. In this course, students will be introduced to the concepts of variables, negative numbers and advanced mathematical operations and use them to write, solve and graph linear and quadratic equations.

Students should have a strong foundation in basic mathematical operations and will develop the analytical and critical-thinking skills needed to model real-life application word problems. The tutor uses "Teaching Textbooks" to teach this course.

FREE!



FREE!

PRECALCULUS

Pre-Calculus with Chinmay Anind Chapter 1-7 and Meghna Kilaparthi teaches chapter 8 to the end of the book.

Learn Function Basics, Polynomial Functions, Rational Functions, Exponential and Logarithmic Functions, Radical Functions, Power Functions, Triangle Trigonometry, Trigonometric Functions, Trigonometric Identities, Vectors and Polar Coordinates, Systems, Matrices, and Determinants, Analytic Geometry, Sequences, Probability, and Statistics, Introduction to Calculus, and many more topics. All of which will prepare you for the Calculus course.

Sign up now free with members to our Learning Annex.

PRE-ALGEBRA

Pre-Algebra course is taught by Meghna Kilaparthi. It is an online course with recorded lectures that will help you strengthen your mathematic and, more specifically, algebraic skills. This course will encompass topics such as adding, subtracting, multiplying and dividing whole numbers, fractions and decimals as well as discussing percentages, powers, roots, measuring the area and volume, negative numbers and solving algebraic equations with and without variables.

PRE-ALGEBRA COURSE LAYOUT:

- Topic 1 - Adding, Subtracting, Multiplying and Dividing Whole Numbers (Chapter 1 and 2)
- Topic 2 - Fractions (Chapter 3, 4, and 5)
- Topic 3 - Decimals (Chapter 6)
- Topic 4 - Percents (Chapter 7)
- Topic 5 - Measuring Length, Area and Volume (Chapter 8 and 9)
- Topic 6 - Simple Algebra Equation (Chapter 10)
- Topic 7 - Negative Numbers (Chapter 11)
- Topic 8 - Longer Equations (Chapter 12)
- Topic 9 - Combining x's and Fractions with x's (Chapter 13 and 14)
- Topic 10 - Powers and Roots (Chapter 15)

FREE!



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Electives



FREE!

VIOLIN VISION with Satya Vedula

The Violin Vision course covers all content regarding how to play the violin and sight reading violin music. The course is divided from beginner to advanced content, even including easy-to-remember tips and tricks.

Goals:

- Identify & interpret basic musical symbols
- Understand parts of a single line of music
- Start to understand basic note-reading
- Identify parts of the violin and the bow
- Learn about 2 main violin-holding positions



FREE!

MUSIC COURSE

NHEG Music Program will offer many musical opportunities, including Music Theory, History of Music, Famous Composers, Famous Musicians, individual classes, instrumental lessons and much more. These lessons will range in price from free to low-cost.

FINANCIAL LITERACY

FREE!



NHEG Financial Literacy course is a self-taught class that helps you build a better understanding of your finances. This high school- and adult-level class covers topics such as financial responsibility, income sources, deductions, financial institutions, purchasing decisions, taxes, credit, debts, assets, risk management, protection laws and budgeting.



FREE!

ORPHAN TRAIN

The Orphan Train Movement was a supervised welfare program that transported orphaned and homeless children from crowded eastern cities of the United States to foster homes located largely in rural areas of the Midwest. The orphan trains operated between 1854 and 1929, relocating about 200,000 orphaned, abandoned or homeless children. Charles Loring Brace, founder of the Children's Aid Society, decided the best way to help these children would be to take them out of the crowded eastern cities and instead put them in farming families in the Midwest.

He believed by removing them from poverty, he would be able to change the fates of the children and allow them to be able to make something of their lives. Children would be transported by train from the east to the Midwest where they lived and worked with farming families for free. On the route west, the orphan trains stopped in 45 states across the country. This program helped over 120,000 children and led to reforms in child labor policies, adoption and foster care policies, health care and public education.

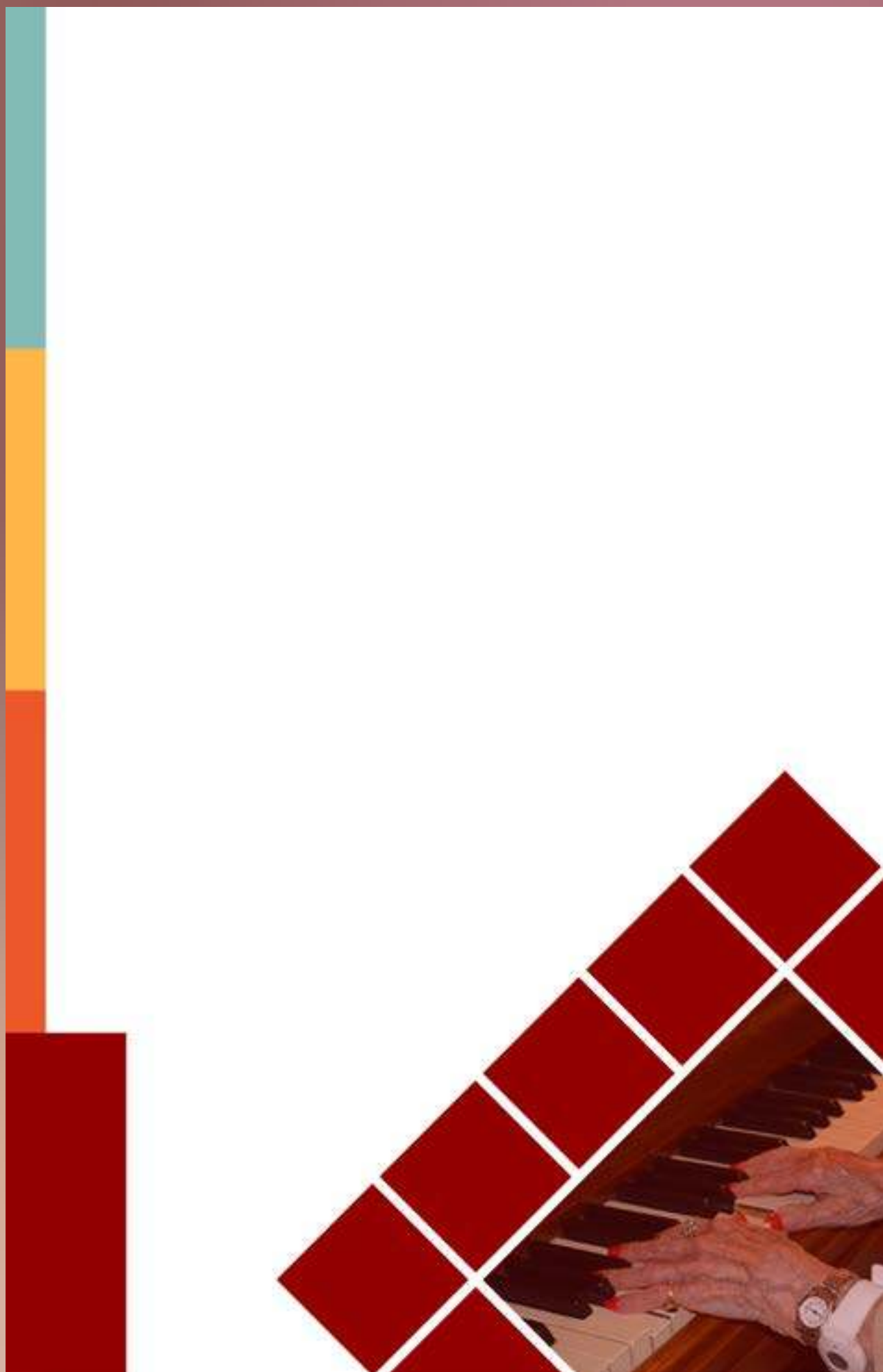
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HOLIDAYS AROUND THE WORLD

The Holidays Around the World courses will explore cultures, foods, history and beginnings of holidays from all over the world. Each course will take a unique look at these holidays and will feature six classes. Parents are encouraged to review courses before sharing with their children, and many classes are aimed at middle school, high school, college-level and adult students.

WORLD HOLIDAYS 1

CHRISTMAS

In this course you will learn about the history of Christmas and its origins, religious connections, comparisons between Christmas and Hanukkah, foods, cultures, beliefs, Santa Claus and so much more.

CHINESE NEW YEAR

In this course you will learn about the history of the Chinese New Year and its origins, traditions, foods, symbols and greetings and so much more.

EASTER

In this course you will learn about the history of Easter and its origins, persecution, religious beliefs, a comparison between Easter and Passover, foods, Christianity, Judaism, biblical references, Easter in America, eggs, rabbits, Babylonian heritage, Ishtar, festivals, cultures that celebrate it, fertility, folk customs, Palm Sunday, Easter Tuesday, Easter Parades and so much more.

HALLOWEEN

In this course you will learn the history of Halloween and its origins, signs and symbols, saints, martyrs, Christianity, Samhain and Celtic roots, foods, bonfires, harvest times, beliefs regarding the boundary of this world and the outer world, costumes, games, fortunes, dreams, altars and candles, the holiday's evolution to modern times in America and beyond, cultures that celebrate it and how they celebrate, All Hallows' Eve and so much more.

HANUKKAH

In this course you will learn about the history of Hanukkah and its origins, Jewish roots, the revolt, menorah candles and the lighting of them, errors in lighting the candles, Judaism, the Torah, foods and the use of oil, blessings, songs, the population of Jews and where they live.

PASSOVER

In this course you will learn about the history of Passover and its origins, Jewish and Christian roots, Tribes of Israel, the Death Angel, Egypt and escape from it, biblical references, foods, a comparison between Passover and Easter, references to Jesus Christ, early Christians, Galatians, Easter taking over Passover throughout time, churches and how they celebrate, Pesach, Seder, Jewish practices, breads, unleavened bread, wine, genealogy/family roots, cultures that celebrate it and how they celebrate it and so much more.

WORLD HOLIDAYS 2

All holidays covered explore its origins, traditions, foods, symbols, greetings and much more:

- DIWALI
- FATHER'S DAY
- GROUNDHOG DAY
- MOTHER'S DAY
- ST. PATRICK'S DAY
- VALENTINE'S DAY



INTERVIEW SKILLS

This class will instruct students on how to apply for a job and what is expected of them during the hiring process.

Partners & Affiliates

PARTNERS AND AFFILIATES INCLUDE:

Homeschooler Today



Hillsdale College



HILLSDALE COLLEGE

Home School Legal Defense Online Academy



Learn Play Connect

LEARN... PLAY... CONNECT... WITH MATH

Lima Symphony Orchestra



Chamber Theatre Productions



CHAMBER THEATRE PRODUCTIONS

Natural Born Leaders



National CSI



Fiverr



Personal & Professional Development Coaching -
Georgia Woodbine

Personal Development Coaching - Bette Williams

Civic Theatre of Fort Wayne
(aka United Arts and Education)



The Animation Course



THE DRAWING COURSE

Izzit



FEE - Foundation for Economic Education

FEE FOUNDATION for
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The Hip Hop Healthy Heart Program for Children™



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with the NHEG Magazine
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and www.Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org

OUR ACHIEVEMENTS

New Heights Educational Group is an Award-Winning Organization.
Scan Here to View the Full List!



Student and Adult Leadership Opportunities

NHEG national groups promote leadership, providing student internship opportunities to serve in our organization and earn relevant experience. The Adult Advisory Group is for parents and others in the community who want a voice in education, and alongside these, NHEG offers various support groups for students and citizens.



Other Programs and Services Include:

- A free online 5-tier reading program
- Publications - E.A.S.Ytoons Comic Book and the NHEG EDGuide Magazine
- Internet Radio Program - New Heights Show on Education



Our Achievements

Scan QR code to see our awards!



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We know how to help you.



Mission Statement

New Heights Educational Group, Inc., promotes literacy for children and adults by offering a range of educational support services. Such services include the following: assisting families in the selection of schools; organization of educational activities; and acquisition of materials. We promote a healthy learning environment and various enrichment programs for families of preschool and school-age children, including children with special needs.

Student Services

NHEG offers resources for students who are homeschooled or attending charter schools or public schools in Ohio. This includes students from pre-k to adults of all ages. Resources include:

- Over 1,200 free and discounted courses
- Student leadership opportunities
- Access to free scholarship searches via our website
- Online affordable student assessments and placement tests
- Student lesson planning
- Diploma and transcript preparation

Learning Annex

NHEG is providing students discounted and free online classes that they can take in their free time or incorporate into their current studies. This includes students who are homeschooled or attending a charter, private, or public school. Also, NHEG has partnered with HSLDA Academy, so you will receive a discount when you use our code in one of their classes.

Scan QR code to visit the Learning Annex



Discounted and Online Classes

NHEG provides discounted and free online classes for home school, charter, public and private school students. Classes can be used to fulfill curriculum requirements (this only pertains to homeschool students) or to supplement current studies. NHEG has also formed a partnership with HSLDA which allows us to offer a discount to NHEG students taking HSLDA classes. Courses range from core subjects to hard-to-find subject matter, such as mathematics, economics, and even theology.

Parent & Teacher Services

NHEG offers training courses and information for parents of homeschool, charter school, public school, and special-needs students concerning schooling, resources, and education available to them. Likewise, NHEG also provides various resources to teachers such as classroom and training resources and educational technologies.



CALL 911 OR
1-800-843-5678 (1-800-THE-LOST®)

Madison County Sheriff's Office (Ohio) 1-740-852-1212

MISSING CHILD



Simba was last seen on August 7, 2025.

Simba Shakur
NCIC# M078554472
Missing Since: August 7, 2025
Toledo, OH
Age Now: 16 Years Old
Male



Toledo Police
Department (Ohio) 1-419-255-8443



MISSING CHILD



Gary was last seen on August 5, 2025.

Gary Lee Phillips
NCIC# M988605133
Missing Since: August 5, 2025
Cincinnati, OH
Age Now: 16 Years Old
Male



Cincinnati Police
Department (Ohio) 1-513-765-1212



MISSING CHILD



Alanna was last seen on August 17, 2025.

Alanna Lee Dold
NCIC# M728600364
Missing Since: August 17, 2025
Newark, OH
Age Now: 16 Years Old
Female



Newark Police
Department (New York) 1-973-733-6000



NCMEC: 2059155

MISSING CHILD



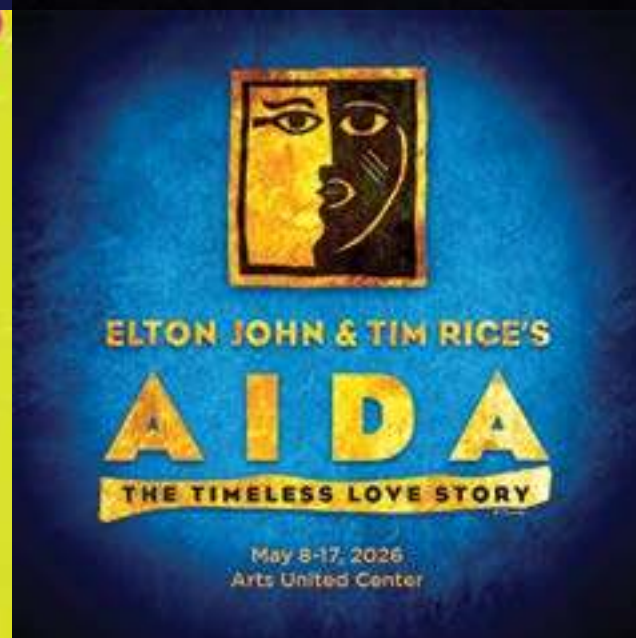
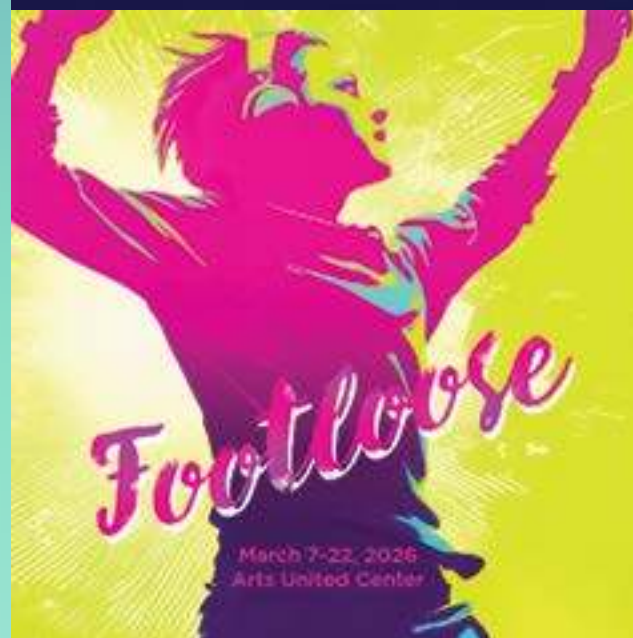
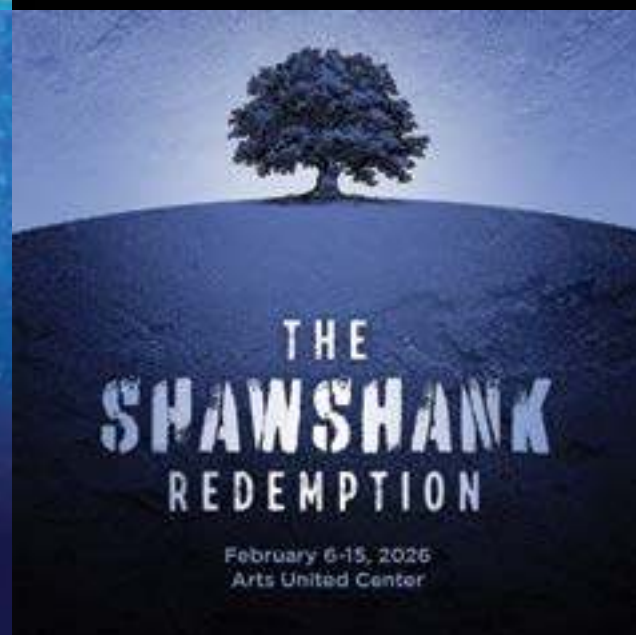
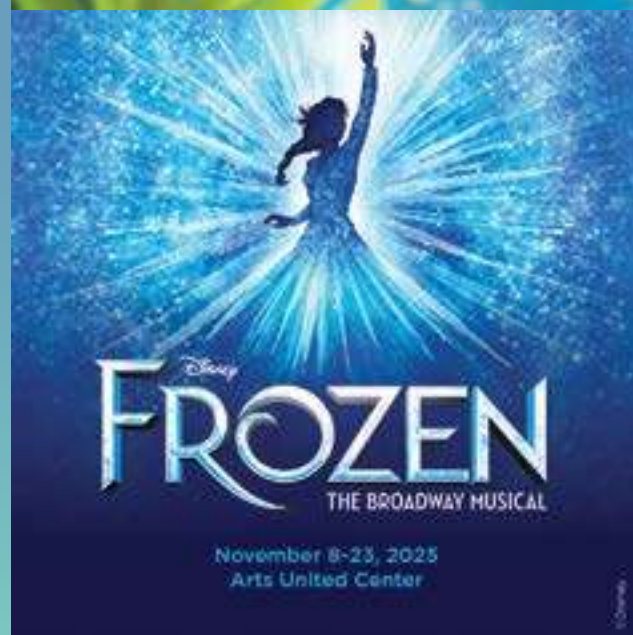
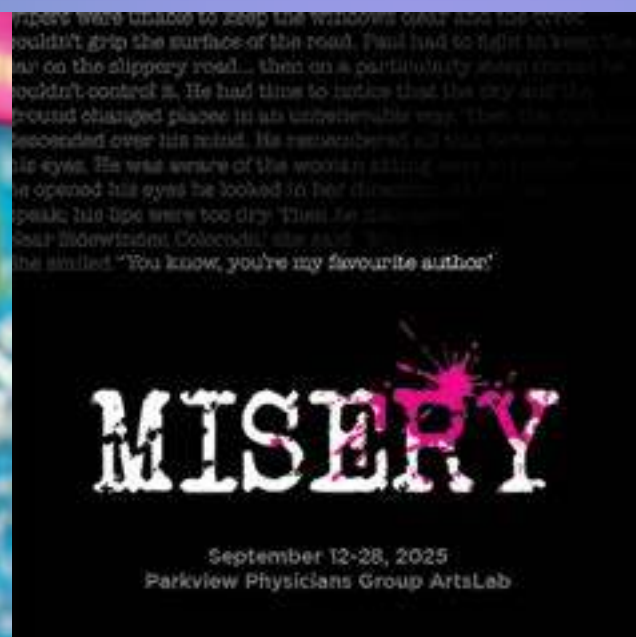
Brooklynn has a tattoo on her right arm.

Brooklynn Madox
NCIC# M798532632
Missing Since: August 13, 2025
Garfield Heights, OH
Age Now: 16 Years Old
Female



Garfield Heights
Police Department
(Ohio) 1-216-475-6607





New Heights Educational Group™

Educational Resources to Help Reach Your Goals

Resource and Literacy Center

We are now part of the First Book Network!

FIRST BOOK

Eliminating Barriers. Inspiring Young Minds.

Need Books?

Members of the First Book Network have 24-hour, year-round access to an award-winning repository of affordable and new books, educational resources, and basic necessities curated for kids in need ages 0-18.

**WE CAN HELP
YOUR STUDENT
GAIN ACCESS TO
FREE, HIGH
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MATERIAL!**

If your Child or Student lacks access to quality books, NHEG can help provide you with a high quality, online library through First Book.

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Preschool-12th grade

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done for only

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Genealogy costs cover the genealogist's time and there may be extra charges for expenses that include photocopies, travel, website fees (Ancestry, MyHeritage, and public library fees) and postage if necessary.

For more information, please visit <https://School.NewHeightsEducation.org/affordable-genealogy/>
To sign up: <https://NHEG.MemberHub.com/store/items/838457>

New Heights Educational Group is now offering pre-recorded

Genealogy and DNA courses

Genealogy & Education

In this free course, students will explore the history of genealogy and be inspired to learn about their family history and its connection to their community.

Course topics:

- History of genealogy
- Family history and its ties to their environment
- Significance of learning about family history
- Steps to researching family history
- Sites to help organize a family tree
- Steps to downloading and moving a family tree

DNA & Education

In this free course, students will explore the world of genetics and DNA testing and be inspired to learn about their genetic makeup and their connection to others.

Course topics:

- Significance of learning about family history
- Introduction to genetic testing
- Overview of DNA
- DNA testing options
- Steps to take after DNA testing
- Value of adding DNA results to other websites
- Using Gedmatch
- Comparing DNA in multiple systems
- Comparing DNA relatives
- DNA results and social media

For more information, please visit <https://School.NewHeightEducation.org/online-courses/genealogy-dna-course/>

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\$10,000

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K-3 Fall 2024

Yukon,
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Give your child...

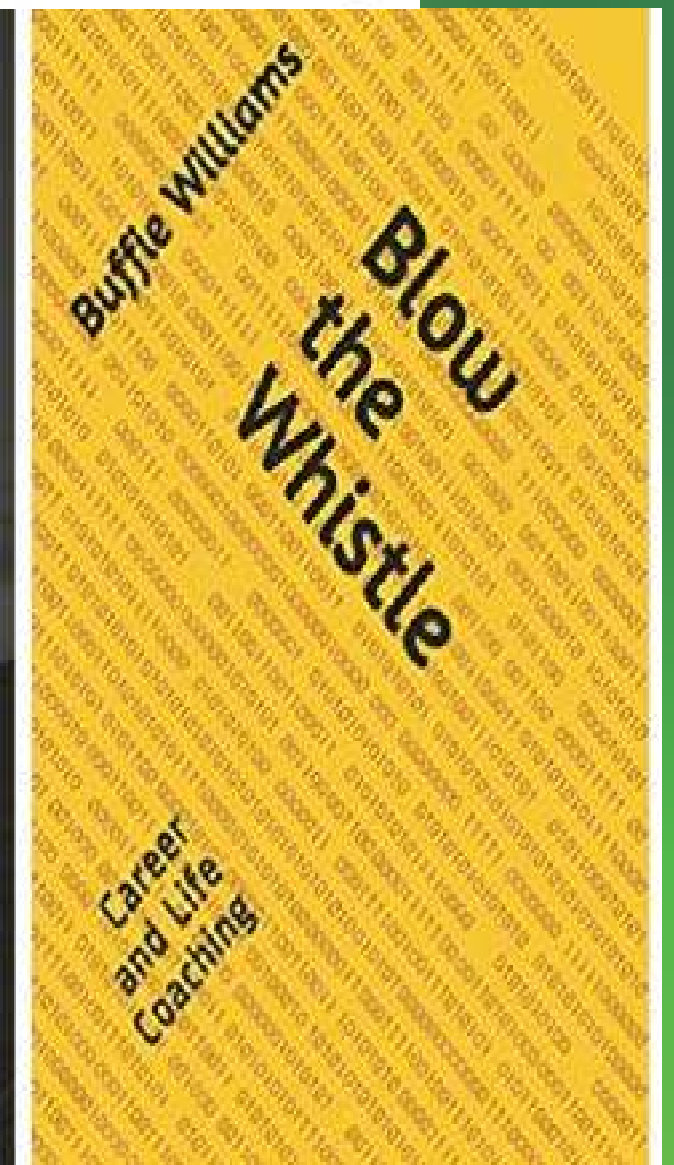
- **small** class sizes (10 max)
- **support** from a *professional* teacher
- built-in **social** opportunities
- quality **curriculum**
- **flexible** options (hybrid/full-time)
- a **caring** community



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<https://www.nshss.org/>



<https://School.NewHeightsEducation.org/membership/national-csi-classes/>

An advertisement for two free math gifts. The background is a collage of blue, orange, and light blue shapes. The text "Two FREE Math Gifts" is in large yellow font. Below it, "Use Code: NHEG" is in white font on a teal background. The first gift is an A/V book titled "How and Why Homeschool Math can be vastly Superior to Public School Math." The second gift is a \$47 interactive self-paced online math program titled "Learn to do Arithmetic Calculations with a TI30Xa Calculator - Quick and Easy!". The website "www.VastlySuperiorMath.com" is at the bottom.

[https://School.NewHeightsEducation.org/online-courses/
discounted-and-free-online-classes/](https://School.NewHeightsEducation.org/online-courses/discounted-and-free-online-classes/)



<https://NewHeightsEducation.org/NHEG-educational-programs/virtual-reading-program/>



New Heights Educational Group (NHEG)

and
Chamber Theatre Productions
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Edgar Allan Poe: The Midnight Collection

A one-hour dramatic educational package
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one-week rental options for classroom or
remote learning

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<https://school.chambertheatre.com/>

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Chamber Theatre Productions

America's Premier Educational Theatre Company



New Heights Educational Group

*Educational Resources to Help Reach Your Goals
Resource and Literacy Center*

<https://www.NewHeightsEducation.org>



Chamber Theatre Productions

America's Premier Educational Theatre Company

VOLUNTEER PAGES

NEW VOLUNTEERS

GARY STEVENS MAY 4, 2025
COMPILING EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES,
DOCUMENT BUILDER AND EDITOR
DONNALIE YAP 7/14/25
RESEARCH COORDINATOR AND COMPILING
EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES

VOLUNTEERS OF THE MONTH

Shukla Casanova	Heather Ruggiero
Ginnefine Jalloh	Gary Stevens
Marina Klimi	Donnalie Yap
Manya Laura	

THE INTERNET RADIO PROGRAM
FROM NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP



NEW HEIGHTS



SHOW ON EDUCATION



New Heights Educational Group Launches Podcast

The New Heights Educational Group is excited to announce the launch of a new podcast titled “American Service Men and Women Tell Their Stories of Survival.” Hosted by Pamela Clark, this podcast will feature firsthand accounts from sailors who served aboard the USS Drexler, with plans to explore additional stories and branches of the military, as well.

This pre-recorded show will be available on our website Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org starting June 25, 2025. Homeschool families are encouraged to incorporate this resource into their American History studies.

P.S. If anyone from the families would like to be interviewed on the show they can reach me at my email address.

(Info@NewHeightsEducation.org)

Commercial for show

https://www.canva.com/design/DAGVqZ9Ny2U/EZ8XuV0tHQU0URfQj07j9w/watch?utm_content=DAGVqZ9Ny2U&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=ha977a70340



NEW HEIGHTS

SHOW ON EDUCATION



Interested in Broadcasting?



Attention Students interested in broadcasting or working in radio and television: NHEG offers unique opportunities for students to explore.

Positions are all volunteer based and offer hands on experience working on a syndicated show, "New Heights Show on Education" (currently only online)

The Positions of Interest Include:

Internet Radio Host Assistant, Internet Radio Monitors, Creating of New Media, Editing Audio and Video, Press Secretary, Experience with Spreaker and Zoom, Experience working as a Communications Secretary, Hosting of Round-table discussions. There might also be an opportunity to become a host for our organization.

Contact us:

NewHeightsEducation@yahoo.com

419-786-0247

<http://www.NewHeightsEducation.org>

<https://Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org/>

Learning Annex: <https://School.NewHeightsEducation.org/>



New Heights Educational Group
Educational Resources to Help Reach Your Goals
Resource and Library Center



NEW HEIGHTS

SHOW ON EDUCATION



The Voices Of NHEG Internet Radio



CHARLOTTE MCGUIRE



MARIA ORTIZ



PAMELA CLARK



VICTORIA LOWERY



ERIKA HANSAN



KATHY WOODRING



BRIANA DINCHER



OLAMIYAN TABAT



PRISCILENA SHEARON



BUFFIE WILLIAMS



SADIA EIJAZ



ANNA SHI



MANYA SHUKLA



SHANNON WILLIAMSON



KADEN BEHAN



NEW HEIGHTS

SHOW ON EDUCATION



FeedSpot

The New Heights SHOW ON EDUCATION

JOIN HOST

Pamela Clark



AIRING WEDNESDAYS
6:00PM EST
INTERNET RADIO

AS SHE DISCUSSES EDUCATION NEWS AND HAPPENINGS



FeedSpot

The New Heights SHOW ON EDUCATION

JOIN HOST

Manya Shukla



AIRING, FRIDAYS
7:00PM EST
INTERNET RADIO

EMPOWERING HR WITHIN THE WORKFORCE



FeedSpot

The New Heights SHOW ON EDUCATION

NEW PODCAST

American Service Men and Women Tell Their Stories of Survival

JOIN HOST



Pamela Clark



Airing Wednesdays
6 PM EST



Empowering HR within the Workforce is the podcast where we explore the latest trends in human resources, workforce development, leadership, and personal development. This show will bring insights on building a more effective and efficient workforce while also focusing on personal growth. Tune in for some healthy solutions to elevate your personal development and team goals.

The New Heights SHOW ON EDUCATION

JOIN HOST

Manya Shukla



AIRING, FRIDAYS
7:00PM EST
INTERNET RADIO

EMPOWERING HR WITHIN THE WORKFORCE



FeedSpot



NEW HEIGHTS

SHOW ON EDUCATION



The Voices Of NHEG Internet Radio



The internet radio show hosts cover various topics of education for home, charter and public-school families in Ohio and beyond. We cover many aspects of education: education in the news, civil rights, the power of education, restructuring schools, the IEP process, tips for teens, zoology, technology, Common Core, history, science, reading, business, entrepreneurship, special needs, round-table discussions, Empowering HR within the Workforce, and reading of our teen comic book series that tackles youth issues.

FeedSpot

Welcome to the New Heights Show on Education, an Internet radio program and podcast in which the hosts cover various topics of education for Home, Charter and Public School families in Ohio and beyond. We cover many aspects of education: the power of education, restructuring schools, the IEP process, tips for teens, zoology, technology, common core, history, science, reading, business, entrepreneurship, special needs, round-table discussions, and reading of our bi-monthly teen comic book series which tackles youth issues. The show educates and inspires its audience by sharing and welcoming discussions. We invite the audience to send in show ideas and provide feedback.

The Voices of NHEG Internet Radio



New Heights Educational Group LAUNCHES PODCAST

The New Heights Educational Group is excited to announce the launch of a new podcast titled "American Service Men and Women Tell Their Stories of Survival." Hosted by Pamela Clark, this podcast will feature firsthand accounts from sailors who served aboard the USS Drexler, with plans to explore additional stories and branches of the military, as well. This pre-recorded show will be available on our website **Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org** starting June 25, 2025. Homeschool families are encouraged to incorporate this resource into their American History studies.

P.S. If anyone from the families would like to be interviewed on the show, email Info@NewHeightsEducation.org



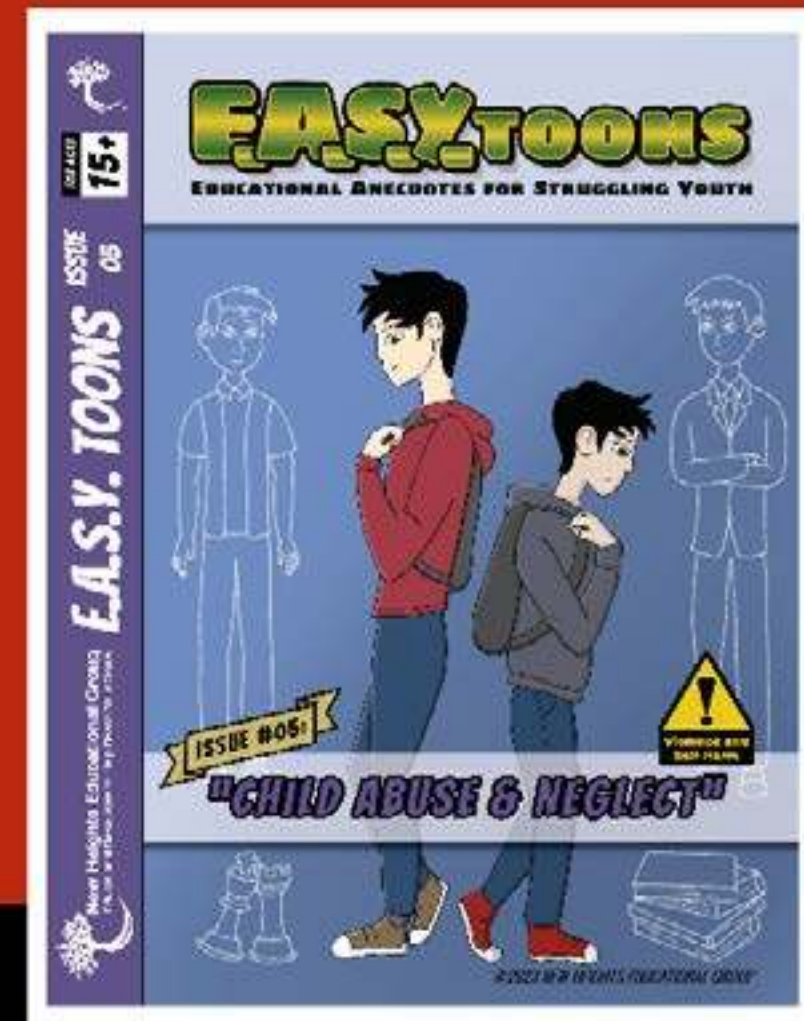
New Heights Educational Group
Educational Resources to Help Reach Your Goals



NEW ISSUE

E.A.S.Y. TOONS COMIC BOOK

AVAILABLE SEPTEMBER 1, 2023



www.yumpu.com/kiosk/newheightseducation



For 30 years, the Dollar General Literacy Foundation has been helping individuals increase their potential and pursue their dreams of a better tomorrow through the power of education. Through grant investments in local schools, nonprofits and libraries, we are supporting teachers, librarians and nonprofit leaders as they help individuals of all ages learn to read, prepare for the high school equivalency test or learn English. If you would like to learn more about the Foundation and our grant programs, please visit www.dgliteracy.org.

Grant Focus Areas:



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Grants provide support to organizations that help create access and opportunity for adults through adult basic education, high school equivalency preparation or English language acquisition.



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Grants support efforts to prevent the summer slide and engage students who are below grade level or reader's with learning differences during the summer months.



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Grants support efforts to implement, enhance or expand K-12 literacy instruction with a focus on increasing access for all students.



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Grants support learning for the whole family. Preferred programs include adult education, children's education and parent and child together time.

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YOU'LL LEARN:

- HOW to support ALL areas of child development through Active Experiential Learning
- HOW to create Indoor and Outdoor Active Learning Experiences
- HOW to use everyday objects in Active Holistic Learning
- HOW to design and implement Play & Learning Stations
- HOW to use technology to support Active Experiential Learning
- HOW to provide Multi-Sensory support
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Aligned with EYFS Framework
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NEW PAYMENT PLANS
from \$11.99 per person!

PROGRAM DURATION: 3 MONTHS



Letter to Volunteers 2025

Dear Volunteers, We’ve achieved another year of growth thanks to all your hard work. This dream is now 19 years in the making. Never could I have imagined where the dream would go and the achievements that a group of people could make from the comfort of their own homes. The families we serve around the world are forever grateful for your service and care. How proud you have made us, and what a powerful team we are. Thank you for believing in my dream, for acting on it, and, most importantly, for pushing it further than I could imagine. Sincerely, Pamela Clark

Happy NHEG Recognition Day 2025.

I’m sharing a list of Volunteers being recognized, including the Volunteers of the Year (*):

Pamela Clark –Board Member, Executive Director, Magazine Editor, Radio Host, Educator, Volunteer Mentor, Graphic Design, Video Editing/Creator, Social Media Manager, Website Content Builder, Production Manager of New Heights Show on Education

Laura Casanova - Board Member, Proofreader/Editor of NHEG EDGuide, *Proofreader of the Year

Heather Ruggiero -Board Member, NHEG Instructor, Researcher, Assistant Virtual Development Director of Education, Assistant to Director Ginnefine Jalloh *Project Manager of the Year , *Graphic designer of the year, Video Editor, Recognition Day Assistant, Certificate Builder

Marina Klimi Board Member *Manager of the Year -NHEG EDGuide NHEG EDGuide, *Magazine Cover Designer of the Year

Heather Ruggiero - Board Member, NHEG Instructor, Researcher, Assistant Virtual Development Director of Education, Assistant to Director, Social Media and Marketing, Video creation/ editing

Sheila Wright - Board Member Katie M. Buchhop Proofreader

Kristen Congedo Board Member

Rachel Lisa Mathurin Music Tutor

Manya Shukla HR Coordinator and Radio Show Host, *HR Coordinator of the Year

Peter Gordon Teacher/Tutor, Curriculum Developer

Nnaji Chiamaka Jacinta Microsoft Excel - Compiling Educational Resources

Oluwapelumi Adewole Graphic Designer

Gary Stevens Compiling Educational Resources, Document Builder and Editor, Radio Host Assistant, *Radio Host Assistant of the Year, *Compiling Educational Resources of the Year

Charles Lanier Best New Artist

Logan Moreland *Best Legacy Artist and *Cartoonist/ Colorist of the Year

Ginnefine Jalloh, *Project Manager of the Year , *Graphic designer of the year

Donnalie Yap - *Research Coordinator of the Year, Radio Host Assistant, Compilating Educational Resources

Instructions for printing certificates:

Each of you should receive a certificate for each position you hold. If there is a typo or a certificate missing, please let us know.

You can print the certificates at home, but I recommend that you send them to your local printing store for printing. I

suggest that you ask that they print the certificate(s) on nicer stock, such as 110 lb cardstock for a higher quality image.

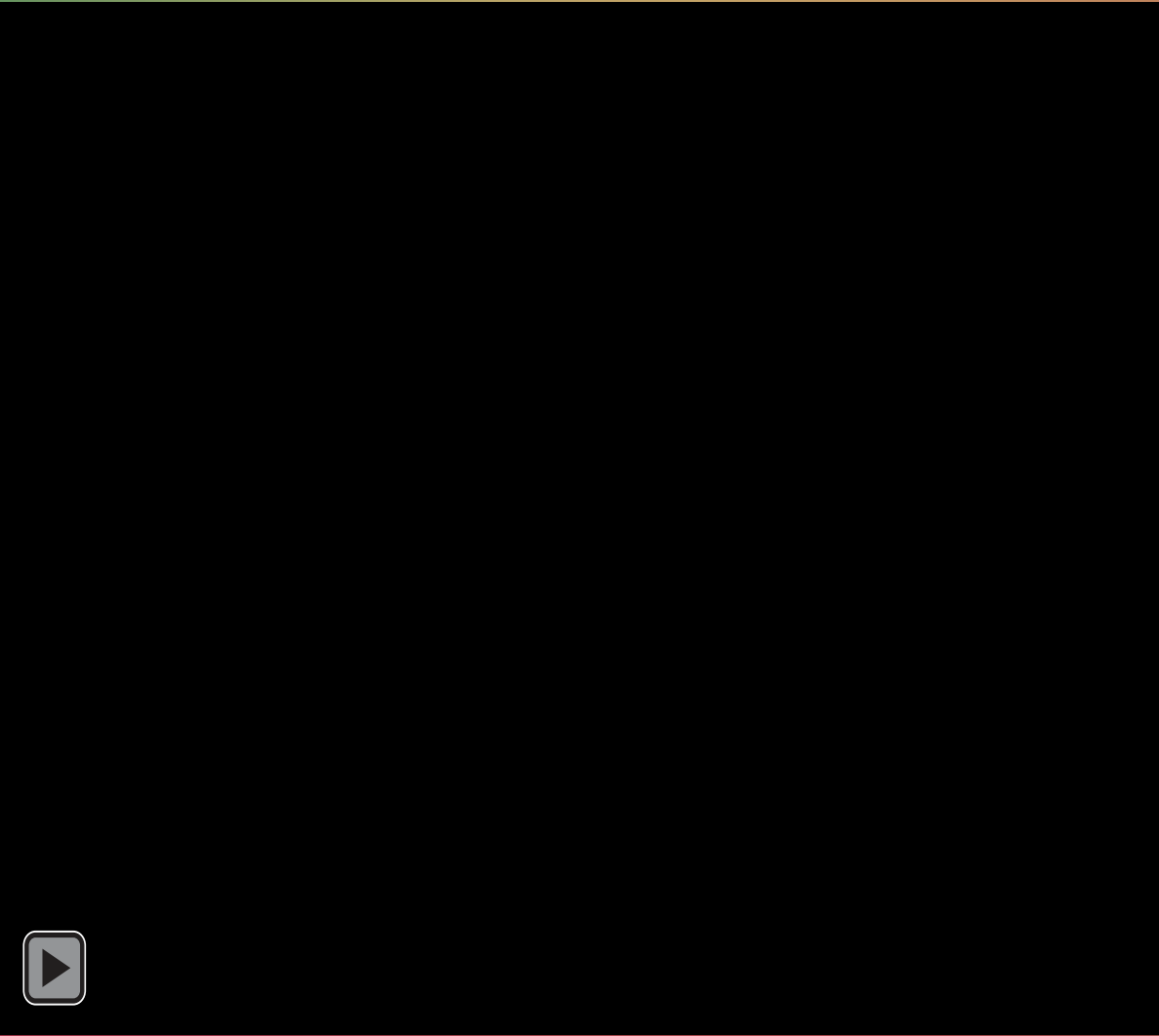
NHEG September Birthday

- SEPT 13** Marina Klimi
- SEPT 23** William Atkinson
- SEPT 28** Donnalie Yap

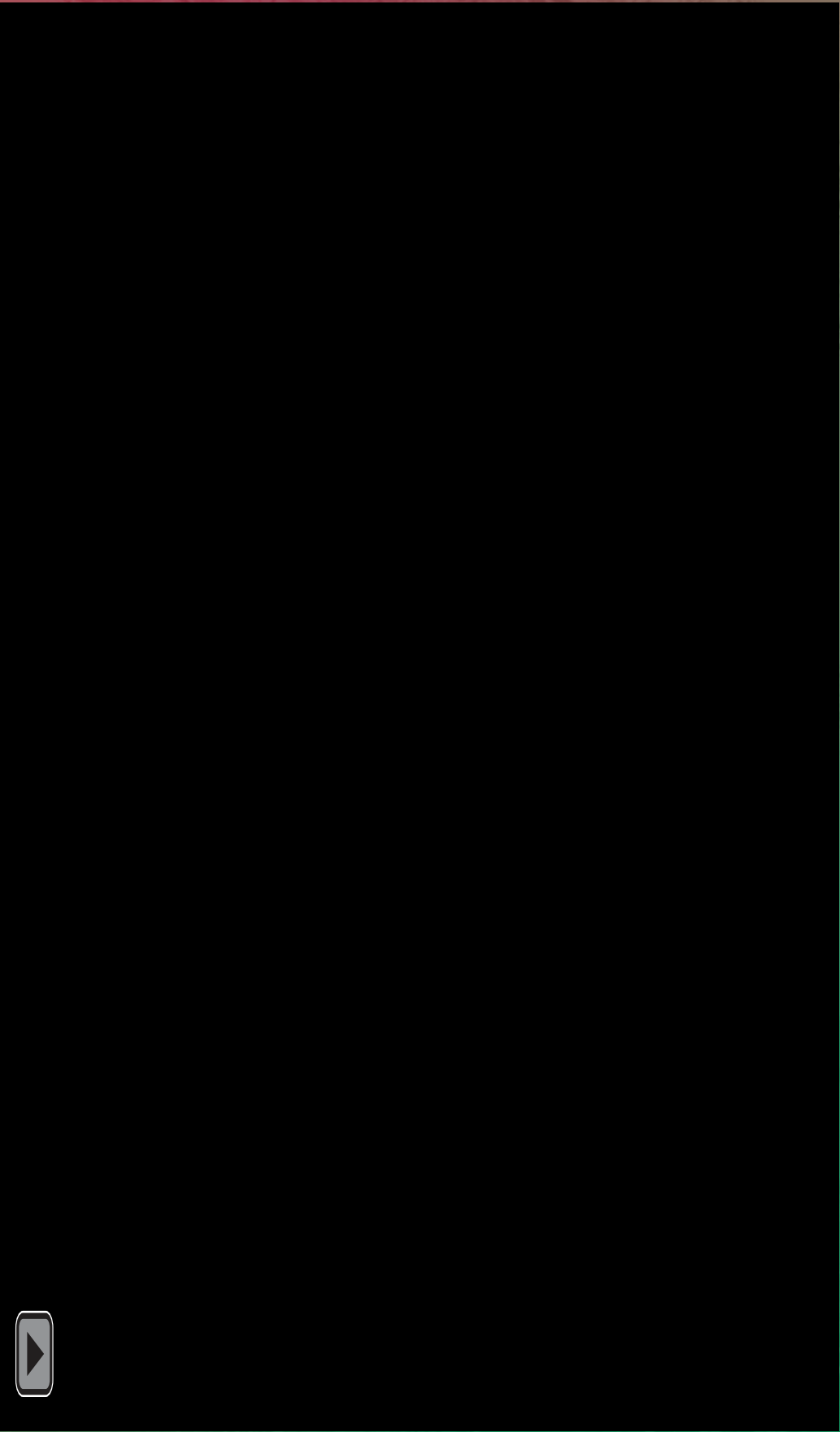
NHEG October Birthday

- OCT 15** Mike Anderson
- OCT 18** Javier Cortés

NHEG Birthday Card

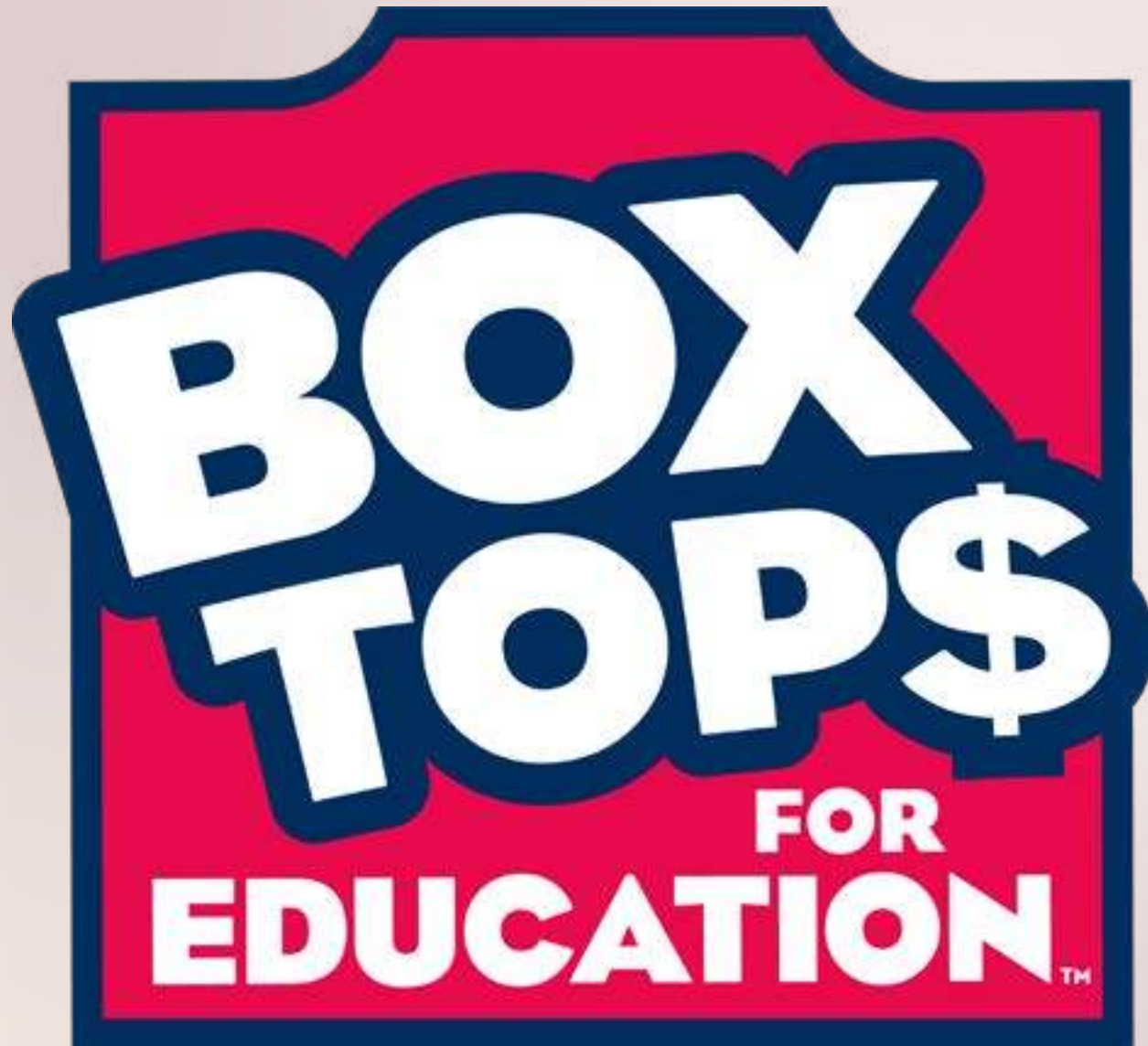


NHEG Anniversary Card



HOW TO EARN

BOX TOPS MAKES IT EASY



All you need is your phone! Download the Box Tops app, shop as you normally would, then use the app to scan your store receipt within 14 days of purchase. The

app will identify Box Tops products on your receipt and

automatically credit your school's earnings online.

Twice a year, your school will receive a check and can use that cash to buy

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<https://www.boxtops4education.com/enroll>

PRESS RELEASE

THE NEW HEIGHTS SHOW ON EDUCATION AND
THE NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP (NHEG)
WELCOMES A NEW HOST.

3/28/25

The New Heights Show on Education and the New Heights Educational Group (NHEG) welcomes a new host. Manya Shukla is a certified HR professional and a dedicated advocate for personal development and team growth. She is excited to bring her podcast show “Empowering HR Within the Workforce” to NHEG. It’s your go-to podcast for the ever-evolving world of HR. The podcast shares insights on building a more effective and efficient workforce while also focusing on personal growth. Manya firmly believes that high-quality work is best achieved when employees feel valued, engaged, and happy in their roles. She also believes that what is important is not the number of hours an employee spends in the office but the quality of work he or she performs. Manya currently volunteers with NHEG as an HR Coordinator. She resides in Austin, Texas, loves singing and dancing, and is deeply interested in geopolitics. The award-winning New Heights Show on Educa- tion covers educational topics and news for families, students and educators. The internet radio show hosts cover various topics of education for home-, charter- and public-school families in Ohio and beyond. We cover many aspects of education: education in the news, civil rights, the power of education, restructuring schools, the IEP process, tips for teens, zoology, technology,

Common Core, history, science, reading, business, entrepreneurship, special needs, and round-table discus- sions. Our shows can be followed and listened to on your favorite podcast player or by visiting [https://Radio. NewHeightsEducation.org/](https://Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org/). Manya’s show starts on March 28, 2025, and airs on Fridays at 7:00 p.m. EST. Pamela Clark (Founder/Executive Director, Creator of Show) hosts a show titled “Education in the News” that airs Wednesdays at 6:00 p.m. EST.

THE NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP PODCAST NEW
HEIGHTS SHOW ON EDUCATION

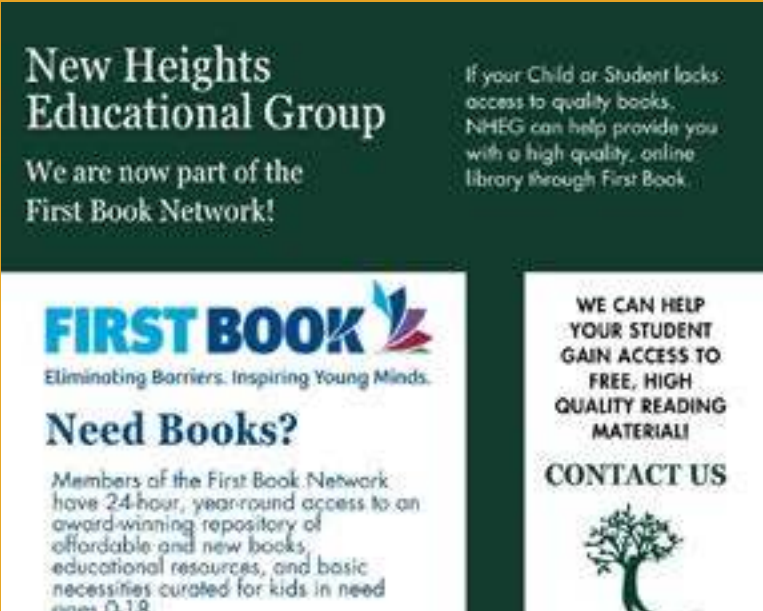
The New Heights Educational Group podcast New Heights Show on Education has been selected by the Feed- Spot panel as one of the 10 Best Ohio Education Podcasts on the web, for the second year in a row. It is listed among the Top 10 Best Ohio Education Podcasts online, and NHEG is honored to be part of this. Anuj Agarwal, founder of FeedSpot, personally congratulated NHEG’s work on the podcast and its many shows. The award-winning New Heights Show on Education covers educational topics and news for families, students, and educators. The internet radio program and podcast hosts cover various topics of education for home-, charter-, and publicschoo families in Ohio and beyond. Content topics include many aspects of education: education in the news, civil rights, the power of education, restructuring schools, the IEP process, tips for teens, zoology, technology, Common Core, history, science, reading, business, entrepreneurship, special needs, round-table discussions, and reading of our teen comic book series that tackles youth issues. The show educates and inspires its audience by sharing and welcoming discussions. New shows are added on a regular basis on our website: <http://Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org/>

STUDENT EDUCATIONAL SUPPORT SERVICE PROVIDER OF THE
YEAR 2024

The New Heights Educational Group was named the Student Educational Support Service Provider of the Year 2024 - Ohio by the North America Business Awards. <https://newworldreport.digital/winners/New-Heights-Educational-Group-2/> NHEG Founder/Executive Director Pamela Clark stated “I’m always thankful for recognition of our work. The work at NHEG is all done by volunteers, and I appreciate them for their passion and support.” Thank you to New World Report for recognizing our work. Sincerely, Pamela Clark It is listed among the Top 10 Best Ohio Education Podcasts online, and NHEG is honored to be part of this. Anuj Agarwal, founder of FeedSpot, personally congratulated NHEG’s work on the podcast and its many shows. The award-winning New Heights Show on Education covers educational topics and news for families, stu- dents, and educators. The internet radio program and podcast hosts cover various topics of education for home-, charter-, and public school families in Ohio and beyond. Content topics include many aspects of edu- cation: education in the news, civil rights, the power of education, restructuring schools, the IEP process, tips for teens, zoology, technology, Common Core, history, science, reading, business, entrepreneurship, special needs, round-table discussions, and reading of our teen comic book series that tackles youth issues. The show educates and inspires its audience by sharing and welcoming discussions. New shows are added on a regular basis on our website: <http://Radio.NewHeightsEducation.org/>

PRESS RELEASE

THE NEW HEIGHTS EDUCATIONAL GROUP IS NOW PART OF THE FIRST BOOK



The New Heights Educational Group is now part of the First Book Network! If your children or students lack access to quality books, NHEG can help provide them with a high quality, online library through the First Book Network. Members have 24-hour, year-round access to an award-winning repository of new and affordable books, educational resources and basic necessities curated for kids and young adults up to 18 years of age. To claim access to these free books, contact us at Info@NewHeightsEducation.org and send us the name, email address

and age for each child you would like access for. We will send you an email with sign-up information (check your spam folder if you don't see this email in your inbox). You can also sign up via the following link: <https://NewHeightsEducation.org/NHEG-educational-programs/virtual-reading-program/>. While you are there, check out the FREE 5-tier reading program.

ARTICLES FROM HILLSDALE COLLEGE

The first link is an issue of Imprimis, Hillsdale's free "Digest of Liberty," by Trent England on "The Danger of the Attacks on the Electoral College": <https://imprimis.hillsdale.edu/danger-attacks-electoral-college/>

The second is an article for the Wall Street Journal in 2016 entitled, "The Electoral College is Anything But Outdated": <https://www.hillsdale.edu/wp-content/uploads/2016/12/PR-The-Electoral-College-Is-Anything-But-Outdated-WSJ.pdf>

Check out the digital version of Imprimis, one of America's most widely-read publications in support of individual liberty, limited government, free market economics, moral responsibility, and strong national defense.

My name is Larry P. Arnn, and I am the president of Hillsdale College, which has published Imprimis since 1972.

PRESS RELEASE

https://info.hillsdale.edu/e3t/Ctc/LS+113/c2xp-04/VXb3fY2hTH5TV7IKQ41v9XpFW5l3Nw35g8q1SN1PJbts3qgyTW6N-1vHY6lZ3lfW4hyg5z17-J43W7SnRr57R-43LW1Q2Mk21fj04DW83zt6N2-ypn2W1wL_HM6R5SyRW7v_brC8qMZzBVR4SWs2Gbj-SyW7hFsf02M7kTzW70915v6MHZgdW1jR62Z1hhzwYW7h459C7IMvd_W5BR4Wz6x4YhMW79PK482fmGtjW5WbbSN1v6C1F-W6n2zmT2bd9bBVkGDcf83-YWYw7rKFwY36fWbyW8l8vth29_LxSW3TknPQ5pNfNjW2BFMwp6xNTVvW6WDbsh49qmBSVNk-wl-3M78Xxf4P84Y404

LETTER TO VETERANS' COMMUNITY
ARE YOU A VETERAN?
DO YOU KNOW A VETERAN?

The New Heights Educational Group has recently launched a new radio show titled, "American Service Men and Women Tell Their Stories of Survival." Our goal is to provide veterans with a platform to share their experiences through interviews with our Founder and Executive Director, Mrs. Pamela Clark. Mrs. Clark has a personal connection to this cause, as her paternal grandfather heroically gave his life in WWII, and his father served in WWI. Both were awarded Purple Heart medals.

Mrs. Clark has been passionate about honoring veterans' contributions to our nation for quite some time, envisioning this initiative either as a history class or a radio show. Through this program, we aim to amplify veterans' voices and foster community education about our nation's history.

We warmly welcome any suggestions on how we can effectively proceed and connect with veterans interested in participating. Your support is invaluable to us in making this project a success.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to honor and share the incredible stories of our veterans.

Sincerely, Pamela Clark, Executive Director

419-786-0247

Info@newheightseducation.org

NEUROEDUCATION IN SCHOOL: PRINCIPLES OF NEUROSCIENCE

Neuroeducation implies understanding how a child's brain works and how the nervous system affects their learning.

Neuroscience studies applied to schooling have been essential both for teachers to innovate in pedagogical strategies and for parents to create more favorable conditions for their children's learning.

This article presents eight principles of neuroscience in action to help children learn in the classroom. As a strategy for writing the article, I will use a study conducted by the Social Service of Industry (SESI) of Brazil, which is now part of the National

Network of Science for Education (Rede CPE), an association that integrates Brazilian researchers and laboratories from different areas that develop research to improve educational practices and policies.

The following principles also contribute to the transformations of education over time:

1. Learning changes the brain: Neuroimaging tests have found that our brain changes both in structure and in functioning as a person learns new skills such as reading, writing, counting, practicing a new language, etc. This is due to neuroplasticity and the brain's ability to reorganize itself and form new brain synapses with each new learning or experience acquired throughout life. For this reason, students need to know that intelligence is malleable and that it is always time to learn, regardless of the difficulty they have with a given content. Research in the field of neuroscience reveals that when students understand that their intelligence is malleable and that learning changes the structure of their brain, they can renew their self-confidence and motivation to study.

2. How we learn is unique: Although each of us has the same set of neural circuit (linked to attention, motivation, motricity, language, reasoning, etc.), how each person's brain connects to these circuits is different, as it depends on the set of experiences inherent to how each person learns and experiences learning. Each student has a different type of neural circuitry that influences their performance and learning. Thus, a classroom with students of the same age does not necessarily mean that everyone will learn in the same way. For this reason, it is necessary to awaken everyone's interest, investigating their previous knowledge, what they like to do most, their desires, and their curiosities. Diversifying pedagogical practices, as well as teaching resources, are alternatives for each student to put into practice their way of learning.

As the teacher manages to connect with the students, the easier it will be to connect the interests of the class to the concepts of the school curriculum.

3. Social interaction is conducive to learning: We are social beings. Learning by observing others is not as effective as learning by interacting with others. In a classroom, the exchange between teacher and student generates changes in each person's cognitive processing, and this is evident when the teacher needs to modify the lesson plan because of a doubt presented by a student. Learning occurs all the time, whether between students or groups of teachers. This way, a new neural construct is developed in the brain for each new learning. The neural circuits activated by social interactions have connections with the reward system, which triggers motivation, essential for quality learning!

4. The use of technology influences the processing and storage of information:

The teacher, when using smartphones, laptops, and tablets, as a pedagogical tool, first needs to ask himself/herself "What are the benefits and drawbacks that information technologies offer to students in the classroom?"

The indiscriminate use of these devices in the classroom can cause distractions and multitasking behaviors in students in a way that impairs their ability to focus and pay attention. For technology to be used to benefit learning, support and guidance are needed. It is necessary to guide the student on how to use selection strategies and identify inaccurate news when researching and seeking information, for example. Another important tip is to develop deep readings with students.

Students need to use cognitive strategies that allow in-depth reading, not only in printed texts but also on screens.

5. Emotion drives learning: In the human brain, reason and emotion are processes that work interdependently to allow our best adaptation to the environment.

From a neuroscientific point of view, it is impossible to build memories, carry out complex thoughts, or make meaningful decisions without emotion. That is why they are so important for human development and learning. In the classroom, "what" the student feels and "how" he feels about what is being taught will directly impact his learning. Leading him, for example, to pay more attention (or not) to the content of the class, to ask (or not) questions, and to dedicate himself more (or less) to his studies. This is how emotion guides learning. On the other hand, emotions that trigger episodes of stress and anxiety in students impair learning. Working with emotions in the classroom, and incorporating socio-emotional learning into pedagogical practice, means considering students in all their dimensions. It is about understanding and valuing the way students perceive themselves, interact, and perceive learning.

6. Motivation puts the brain in action for learning: Motivation is associated with the activity of brain areas that analyze the value of a given experience and also whether it is rewarding enough to be repeated and maintained over time. In learning, this process occurs when the student decides to dedicate more time to studying certain content.

A tip to stimulate motivation in students is to arouse their curiosity through thought-provoking questions in the classroom. Remember that every research project starts with a question or a problem!

Research indicates that when something truly awakens curiosity, brain regions associated with motivation and memory are activated. In other words, curiosity can be a great motivator that makes the brain want to learn.

7. Attention is the gateway to learning: Attention is the gateway to learning. It is through this that the brain is able to filter the necessary and relevant information for our knowledge. Without focus and attention, we cannot filter the information necessary for learning, and consequently, we cannot learn. But the challenge of attention is to maintain concentration, and this involves emotion. For this reason, it is essential that the learning content has value and meaning for the student.

This was proven through research in which, using electrophysiology techniques, they observed that when adolescents were presented with stimuli they considered more "interesting," areas related to selective attention were influenced by brain areas related to motivation. Thus, the study demonstrated that more interesting stimuli increase attentional focus.

8. The brain is not multitasking: Although the modern world values multitasking behavior in people, neuroscience has proven that the brain is not multitasking, alternating its attention on one stimulus at a time when performing a task.

Simultaneous tasks require the brain to compromise the same brain area, the prefrontal cortex, responsible for working memory. Thus, carrying out multiple tasks when studying can compromise academic performance and the reading comprehension, for example. Other harmful factors include difficulty maintaining focus, mental fatigue, working memory overload, and difficulty retaining the content studied.

In order to make students understand the harm of multitasking behavior, it is necessary to explain to them that the greater the number of activities they are doing, the greater the level of distraction. In practice, this means avoiding using social media while studying and only using it again during the break between classes. cannot filter the information necessary for learning, and consequently, we cannot learn. But the challenge of attention is to maintain concentration, and this involves emotion. For this reason, it is essential that the learning content has value and meaning for the student.

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The educator’s work can be more effective when he/she understands how the brain learns, what motivates learning, and how it better captures attention—in short, how stimuli and social interactions impact the learner’s formation. The brain is the organ of learning, and neuroeducation aims to provide scientific evidence of how the brain learns more effectively in the classroom. Hence the importance of neuroeducation for the student’s academic life and for the teacher’s teaching process.

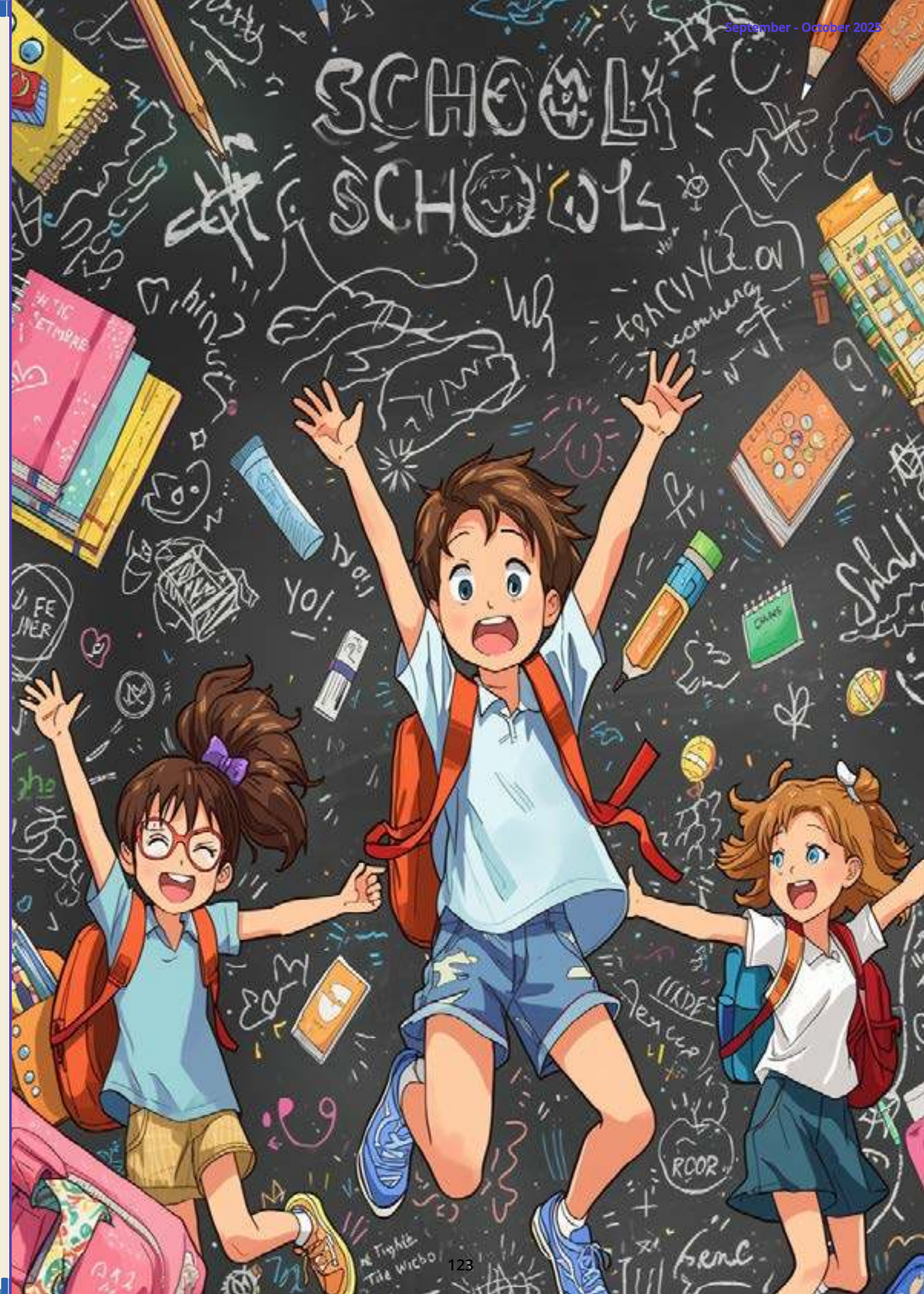
Source:

Serviço Social da Indústria. Departamento Nacional.

Neuroscience and education: looking out for the future of learning / Serviço

Social da Indústria, Ana Luiza Neiva Amaral, Leonor Bezerra Guerra;

translation Mirela C. C. Ramacciotti. Brasília : SESI/DN, 2022.





TUESDAY, MAY 20, 2025 Young people are finding cheaper paths to successful careers.
IULIA LUPSE

How Trade Schools Can Beat a Four-Year Degree

With student loan debt surpassing \$1.7 trillion, more Americans are questioning whether a four-year college degree is the only route to success. In fields like cosmetology and practical nursing, some are discovering a faster, more affordable path to financial stability, reshaping traditional notions of social mobility.

After graduating with a marketing degree, Katherine Millar of York, Pennsylvania, said she struggled to find opportunities aligned with her career goals despite completing an unpaid internship. Frustrated by the lack of prospects in her field, the 25-year-old pivoted to cosmetology school. Less than a year later, she was working in a salon and earning more than she had anticipated in her previous line of work.

“As soon as I got out of school, I started working as an entry-level stylist,” Millar says. “I’m already making more money than I would have in marketing.”

At her salon, she earns 50% commission on all services and keeps 100% of her tips. While building a “full book” of around 800 clients remains a long-term goal, Millar notes that “even part-time stylists can earn six figures.” She also views cosmetology as a springboard to entrepreneurship: “I looked around and thought, if I ever wanted to be entrepreneurial and start my own business, this would be the type of environment I’d want to work in.”

In Florida, Sherita Simmons discovered a path for rapid career advancement. In her mid-30s, she enrolled in Cape Coral Technical College’s Practical Nursing program

in 2022, where scholarships covered nearly all her expenses. “They opened a lot of doors for me to get scholarships to pay for the school,” Simmons says. “I didn’t pay out of pocket for anything.”

After completing the program and passing her state exam in 2023, Simmons landed a nursing job paying \$27.50 an hour. In just 18 months, she was earning \$31, with some per-diem shifts offering \$43.

“I can support my kids, pay rent, and have money left over,” she explains. “Now I’m enrolled in an LPN-to-RN bridge program that costs \$7,000, and scholarships cover most of that, too. No debt.”

Simmons credits the technical college route for transforming her family’s finances and fueling her ambition to keep advancing in nursing. She’s not alone. Vocational school enrollment has risen 16% since 2024, and a 2024 Thumbtack Report found 55% of Gen Zers are considering skilled trades, up from 43% in 2023.

Stories like Millar’s and Simmons’s show how trade and vocational programs, often completed in just one or two years, can lead to stable careers without the burden of overwhelming student debt. Graduates typically begin earning sooner, keep more of their incomes, and gain an early edge in building financial security.

The average graduate of a two-year vocational or technical program owes about \$10,000 in student loans, while the typical bachelor’s degree holder carries over \$38,000, sometimes exceeding \$41,000, with repayments stretching over decades. Meanwhile, federal projections show healthcare roles booming over the next decade. Nurse practitioners, for instance, are expected to grow 46% by 2033, far outpacing the overall job market. Other skilled fields, like wind turbine service technicians, project 60% growth. Many of these in-demand careers require less than four years of schooling—a quicker entry to the workforce without the weight of crushing debt.

Despite the promising data, trade careers still face cultural stigma, often seen as a fallback for those who “aren’t college material.” David Michael Phelps, President of Harmel Academy of Trades in Michigan, sees this as a misunderstanding of hands-on professions:

People look at the question of, “What do young people do after high school?” and tend to think along a certain set of assumptions that we’ve been playing with for two or three generations now. There seems to be this game—if you go off and you get credentialed in a certain way by a certain type of institution, say college, then that provides a certain amount of freedom. But all that is predicated on the assumption that it gives you competence. I think so few people have questioned whether that’s actually true.

Phelps adds that trades are “not simply about competence,” but rather placing people “in touch with reality in such a way that’s more undeniable.” While these careers offer “market opportunity,” “economic mobility,” and “freedom,” Phelps believes their deeper value lies in human formation.

At the same time, some worry that automation could threaten future jobs. Brent Orrell, a senior fellow at the American Enterprise Institute, argues that physical trades may hold a crucial advantage:

“I don’t think anything is future-proof,” Orrell notes. “But plumbers, electricians, and other hands-on fields are much harder to automate than white-collar work. They may be more resilient in the face of AI.”

Yet for many like Katherine Millar and Sherita Simmons, the benefits of skill-based training outweigh long-standing stigmas or fears about automation. Their experiences show how trade schools can unlock financial stability without the crushing debt that often comes with a four-year degree.

“I’m showing my kids that you don’t have to go to a four-year college to get where you want to be in life,” Simmons says.

She now plans to become a registered nurse, while Millar hopes to open her own salon. Both women have found that, in an era of skyrocketing tuition and uncertain returns on traditional degrees, the trades can offer a steadier route to professional growth—on their own terms.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>



FRIDAY, MAY 9, 2025 Harvard and the Trump administration clash over federal funding.
PETER JACOBSEN

Sorry, Harvard. There’s No Such Thing as a ‘Free’ Grant

America’s most prominent university, Harvard, is now fighting the Trump administration. This conflict marks the latest episode in what appears to be a new focus of the White House on higher education. Most recently, Columbia University gave in to some of the government’s demands to ensure continued funding.

The confrontation started when the Trump administration contacted Harvard to demand that it institute reforms based (at least partly) on Harvard’s perceived failure to deal with “[discrimination] against Jewish or Israeli students.” Harvard made some changes but rejected other demands, calling them unreasonable, and in response, the Trump administration has threatened to freeze federal funding.

Now Harvard is fighting back with lawsuits. In its public-facing website about the conflict, Harvard features what sounds like an inspiring message by the institution’s president, Alan Garber:

No government—regardless of which party is in power—should dictate what private universities can teach, whom they can admit and hire, and which areas of study and inquiry they can pursue.

This sounds nice, but when you scroll down the site a bit further, you see what’s really at stake:

Without federal funding, this work [research] will come to a halt midstream, and researchers will lack necessary resources to finish ongoing projects or to finance new ones in the numerous fields Harvard supports...

Do you see the tension here? Harvard is upset that the government is trying to tell them what to say, while simultaneously demanding that it continue sending them money.

Of the \$9 billion being threatened, not all goes immediately to Harvard. Some funding goes in grant form to students who then transmit it to the university in fees. Other grants go to researchers who share a portion (often more than half) with the university. But, regardless of the transmission mechanism, this funding is critical to Harvard’s current operations; otherwise, Trump’s threat would be inconsequential.

Is Harvard entitled to receive millions of taxpayer dollars, directly or indirectly? Are the wealthy administrators and faculty the proper owners of taxes paid by Americans of all economic classes? In my view, no. Harvard has no right to tax dollars; therefore, it’s hardly an injustice for them to lose that funding.

Why is our government funding one of the most powerful institutions in America when it is sitting on a \$53 billion endowment and while it receives donations from foreign governments?

It’s hard to feel bad for Harvard here. One of the oldest lessons in human history is that you have to be careful accepting generous gifts, whether directly or through employees or customers. Money comes with strings attached. Federal money is no different. When you tie your institution’s structure to the gifts of politicians, it’s strange to act surprised when the government leaders expect something (even if it’s unreasonable) in return.

Perhaps the court will rule in Harvard’s favor in this case, but if the voters who elected Trump also elect a Congress that votes to defund Harvard, what will the institution do then?

If institutions like Harvard want to live without fear of being defunded, it’s time for them to let go of the federal government’s hand and walk on their own. Other institutions already do this. Hillsdale College in Michigan and Grove City College in Pennsylvania both eschew federal funding explicitly because they dislike the control the funding gives the government over free inquiry.

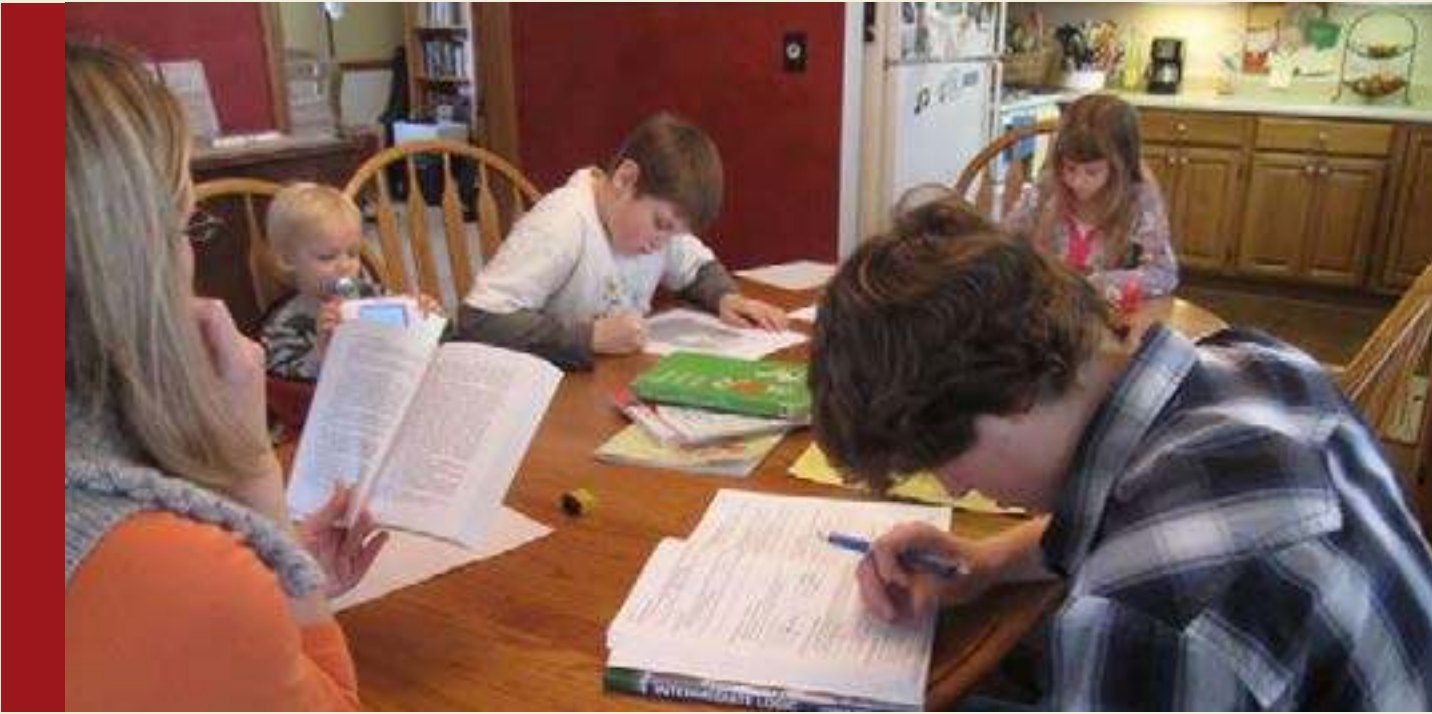
These organizations are immune to pressure precisely because they turn down the kind of money Trump is now threatening to take from Harvard. They have the freedom to decide their institutions’ path.

Whoever lives by funding will die by funding. There’s no such thing as a free grant. At the end of this academic year, I will have the joy of graduating Samuel, who is currently dual-enrolled at Prince George’s Community College and applying to seventeen (that’s not a typo—17) colleges, all in pursuit of his goal of becoming a commercial airline pilot. He currently holds a 3.89 GPA, and I have no doubt he will earn multiple scholarships to attend the college of his dreams.

Jessica, my other “neurospicy” child, is a high school sophomore who struggled with executive functioning skills. Homeschooling for her includes assignment sheet checklists, and long phone calls with her older sister Samantha, to help keep her focused as she completes her homework. As I’ve watched their relationship and Jessie’s grades blossom, I am reminded of the beauty and flexibility of homeschooling, and how it truly is a family affair. In the fall, Jessie, who is a budding chef and cosmetologist, will dual enroll at Prince George’s Community College, taking that opportunity to explore both professions.

When I look at my children, I see what is possible for all homeschoolers. I use their stories to encourage those who are building programs with students for whom the traditional model has not worked, not to stop their programs at 8th grade. Building high school programs that create opportunities for all students to succeed—whether in college, in trade schools, as entrepreneurs, or wherever life takes them—is not just possible; it is absolutely necessary.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>



THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 7, 2019 Subjecting all homeschooling families to regulation and oversight because of fears of a few is a blatant example of state intrusion.
KERRY MCDONALD

Homeschoolers: Guilty Until Proven Innocent?

My eight-year-old daughter and I recently read about the Salem witch trials. She had heard about Salem from a friend who visited the nearby town during its popular Halloween festivities, and she was curious about the witches. We went to the library to get some books on the topic of how 20 innocent people were put to death for “witchcraft” in 1692, with scores more accused and jailed.

What struck me most about revisiting the Salem Witch Trials with my children was the fact that these English Puritans who had recently settled in Massachusetts Bay Colony had no presumption of innocence. Those accused of a crime at the time, both in the New World and elsewhere, were guilty until proven innocent. The presumption of innocence in trials, with court defenders and impartial juries, would take centuries to catch on. The phrase “innocent until proven guilty” was coined by an English lawyer in 1791, but even then it took a long while to become the legal precedent we all now take for granted.

A Pattern of Privacy Invasion

Of course, this legal designation is still imperfectly applied, particularly in cases of fear and bias against certain groups. The US PATRIOT Act, for instance, allows law enforcement agencies the authority to conduct surveillance on individuals and groups by monitoring personal phone calls, emails, and financial documents without a court order. First passed in 2001 in the wake of the 9/11 attacks and reauthorized since, it is intended

to root out the evils of terrorism but does so by violating individual liberty and presuming guilt over innocence.

We see this pattern of privacy invasion by the state and presumed guilt in other areas, as well. In the United Kingdom, for example, there has been such a dramatic rise in the number of homeschoolers that the state believes it must regulate and monitor the practice. Estimates suggest that the number of homeschoolers in the UK increased 40 percent in just three years, and it is thought to be the fastest-growing education option in the UK, with approximately 60,000 homeschooled children in 2018.

The rapid growth of parents taking back control of their children’s education has led to calls by government officials to create a “compulsory register” of homeschooled children and to monitor their education. The UK’s Department of Education told the BBC through a spokesperson this week:

Where children are being home educated, we know that in the vast majority of cases parents are doing an excellent job. We also know, however, that in a very small minority of cases children are not receiving the standard of education they should be.

The idea that all homeschooling families in the UK must now be presumed guilty of neglect because a “very small minority” might be is not a legitimate reason to violate the privacy and personal freedom of law-abiding citizens.

There are already laws to protect children from abuse and neglect in the UK and elsewhere, and those laws should be duly enforced; but subjecting all homeschooling families to regulation and oversight because of fears of a few is a blatant example of state intrusion.

Guilty Until Proven Innocent

Families often choose the homeschooling option because they are especially attentive to their child’s well-being. As The Guardian reported last fall:

Many parents who opt to homeschool their children say they are avoiding bullying, exam pressure and stress. Others have concerns about special educational needs, not getting a place at the school of their choice, or the school environment.

In other words, most of these homeschooling parents are going above and beyond to provide the best education for their children and should not have their decisions questioned and educational approaches monitored.

Supporters of homeschooling regulation, both in the United States and abroad, frequently say that it’s really no big deal. If you’re one of the vigilant homeschooling families then you shouldn’t mind state oversight. But that’s like saying if I have nothing to hide, it’s okay for the government to search my house and read my emails—without a warrant. It presumes guilt over innocence.

Intentions may be good. The Salem Puritans wanted to root out witchcraft and what they saw as the work of the devil. The PATRIOT Act aimed to prevent terrorism through government surveillance. Monitoring homeschooling families is presented as protecting children. But in all cases, innocent people are suspected of guilt and must prove themselves worthy. It’s antithetical to the values of a free society.

I wanted to tell my daughter that we’re so much better now than those Puritans, that “innocent until proven guilty” now prevails. But I’m honestly not so sure.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>



SUNDAY, DECEMBER 19, 2021 The signaling function of college degrees may have been distorted by the phenomenon known as credential inflation.
PETER CLARK

Why College Degrees Are Losing Their Value

The concept of inflation (the depreciation of purchasing power of a specific currency) applies to other goods besides money. Inflation is related to the Law of Supply and Demand. As the supply of a commodity increases, the value decreases. Conversely, as the good becomes more scarce, the value of the commodity increases. This same concept is also applicable to tangible items such as vintage baseball cards and rare art. These are rare commodities that cannot be authentically replicated and therefore command a high value on the market. On the other hand, mass-produced rookie cards and replications of Monet’s work are plentiful. As a result, they yield little value on the market.

Inflation and the opposite principle of deflation can also apply to intangible goods. When looking at the job market, this becomes quite evident. Jobs that require skills that are rare or exceptional tend to pay higher wages. However, there are also compensating differentials that arise because of the risky or unattractive nature of undesirable jobs. The higher wages are due to a lack of workers willing to accept the position rather than the possession of skills that are in demand.

The Signaling Function of College Degrees

Over the past couple of decades, credentialing of intangible employment value has become more prevalent. Credentials can range from college degrees

to professional certifications. One of the most common forms of credentialing has become a 4-year college degree. This category of human capital documentation has evolved to take on an alternate function.

Outside of a few notable exceptions, a bachelor’s degree serves a signaling function. As George Mason economics professor Bryan Caplan argues, the function of a college degree is primarily to signal to potential employers that a job applicant has desirable characteristics. Earning a college degree is more of a validation process than a skill-building process. Employers desire workers that are not only intelligent but also compliant and punctual. The premise of the signaling model seems to be validated by the fact that many graduates are not using their degrees. In fact, in 2013; only 27 percent of graduates had a job related to their major. Since bachelor’s degrees carry a significant signaling function, there have been substantial increases in the number of job seekers possessing a 4-year degree. Retention rates for 4-year institutions reached an all-time high of 81 percent in 2017. In 1940, 4.2 million Americans were 4-year college graduates. Today, 99.5 million Americans have earned a bachelor’s degree or higher. These numbers demonstrate the sharp increase in the number of Americans earning college degrees. Today, nearly 40 percent of all Americans hold a 4-year degree. Considering the vast increase in college attendance and completion, it’s fair to question if a college degree has retained

its “purchasing power” on the job market. Much of the evidence seems to suggest that it has not.

What is Credential Inflation?

The signaling function of college degrees may have been distorted by the phenomenon known as credential inflation. Credential inflation is nothing more than “... an increase in the education credentials required for a job.”

Many jobs that previously required no more than a high school diploma are now only accepting applicants with bachelor’s degrees. This shift in credential preferences among employers has now made the 4-year degree the unofficial minimum standard for educational requirements. This fact is embodied in the high rates of underemployment among college graduates. Approximately 41 percent of all recent graduates are working jobs that do not require a college degree. It is shocking when you consider that 17 percent of hotel clerks and 23.5 percent of amusement park attendants hold 4-year degrees. None of these jobs have traditionally required a college degree. But due to a competitive job market where most applicants have degrees, many recent graduates have no means of distinguishing themselves from other potential employees. Thus, many recent graduates have no other option but to accept low-paying jobs.

The value of a college degree has gone down due to the vast increase in the number of workers who possess degrees. This form of debasement mimics the effect of printing more money. Following the Law of Supply and Demand, the greater the quantity of a commodity, the lower the value. The hordes of guidance counselors and parents urging kids to attend college have certainly contributed to the problem. However, public policy has served to amplify this issue.

Various kinds of loan programs, government scholarships, and other programs have incentivized more students to pursue college degrees. Policies that make college more accessible—proposals for “free college,” for example—also devalue degrees. More people attending college makes degrees even more common and further depreciated.

Of course, this not to say brilliant students with aspirations of a career in STEM fields should avoid college. But for the average student, a college degree may very well be a malinvestment and hinder their future.

Incurring large amounts of debt to work for minimum wage is not a wise decision. When faced with policies and social pressure that have made college the norm, students should recognize that a college degree isn’t everything. If students focused more on obtaining marketable skills than on credentials, they might find a way to stand out in a job market flooded with degrees.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)

<https://fee.org/>



FRIDAY, JUNE 21, 2024 Why should we assume the government knows best when it comes to education?
KERRY MCDONALD

No, We Don't Need Federal Homeschooling Standards

Some of you may remember that four years ago this week I debated Harvard Law School Professor Elizabeth Bartholet who called for a “presumptive ban” on homeschooling. The online event was hosted by the Cato Institute and drew thousands of participants, including many homeschooling families who were incensed by Bartholet’s proposal.

Now, Scientific American is joining the crowd of busybodies eager to constrain a family’s right to raise and educate their children how they choose. “The federal government must develop basic standards for safety and quality of education in homeschooling across the country,” read a recent editorial in the magazine.

Beyond the obvious point that there is no constitutional role for the federal government in education, the proposal for top-down, national mandates on homeschoolers assumes that the government knows best when it comes to education. Yet, the vast majority of school founders I interview are former public school teachers who grew so disillusioned with the rigidity, standardization, and coercion of government-run schooling that they left to create their own schools and spaces.

Many families are also leaving government-run schools for similar reasons, seeking more joyful and enriching learning experiences for their children. “It’s a virtually

untapped market,” said Amy Marotz of the growing demand for homeschooling, microschooling, and other innovative educational models. On Tuesday’s LiberatED podcast, she shared her entrepreneurial journey: from Minneapolis public charter school teacher, to homeschooling parent, to microschool founder who is now helping others to launch their own schools.

The Scientific American piece calls for “federal mandates for reporting and assessment to protect children,” such as background checks on all homeschooling parents and regular reporting requirements to prove that children are learning. Yet, many parents choose homeschooling because government-run schooling is not protecting their children, who may be bullied or abused by peers or school personnel. As for reporting requirements for homeschoolers to demonstrate learning? That’s a pretty brazen request given that in the federal government’s own backyard of Washington, DC, only about one-third of public school students are reading at or above grade level, and only 22 percent are performing at or above grade level in math. For DC high schoolers it’s even worse, with only 11 percent of them proficient in math.

Homeschooling families don’t need more regulations—and certainly not from the federal government, which should have no role in education policy. Perhaps those who think the government knows best on education should work on improving government-run schools rather than coming after the millions of homeschooling families choosing something different.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>





FRIDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2018
KERRY MCDONALD

Eliminating compulsory schooling laws would break the century-and-a-half stranglehold of schooling on education.

Compulsory Schooling Laws: What if We Didn’t Have Them?

We should always be leery of laws passed “for our own good,” as if the state knows better. The history of compulsory schooling statutes is rife with paternalism, triggered by anti-immigrant sentiments in the mid-nineteenth century and fueled by a desire to shape people into a standard mold.

History books detailing the “common school movement” and the push for universal, compulsory schooling perpetuate the myths that Americans were illiterate prior to mass schooling, that there were limited education options available, and that mandating school attendance under a legal threat of force was the surest way toward equality.

In truth, literacy rates were quite high, particularly in Massachusetts, where the first compulsory schooling statute was passed in 1852. Historians Boles and Gintis report that approximately three-quarters of the total U.S. population, including slaves, was literate¹. There was a panoply of education options prior to mass compulsory schooling, including an array of public and private schooling options, charity schools for the poor, robust apprenticeship models, and homeschooling—this latter approach being the preferred method of Massachusetts education reformer Horace Mann, who homeschooled his own three children while mandating common school

attendance for others.

The primary catalyst for compulsory schooling was a wave of massive immigration in the early to mid-1800s that made lawmakers fearful. Many of these immigrants were Irish Catholics escaping the deadly potato famine, and they threatened the predominantly Anglo-Saxon Protestant social order of the time. In 1851, the editor of The Massachusetts Teacher, William Swan, wrote:

“In too many instances the parents are unfit guardians of their own children. If left to their direction the young will be brought up in idle, dissolute, vagrant habits, which will make them worse members of society than their parents are; instead of filling our public schools, they will find their way into our prisons, houses of correction and almshouses. Nothing can operate effectually here but stringent legislation, thoroughly carried out by an efficient police; the children must be gathered up and forced into school, and those who resist or impede this plan, whether parents or priests, must be held accountable and punished.”

This is the true history of compulsory schooling that rarely emerges behind the veil of social magnanimity.

So what would happen if these inherently flawed compulsory schooling laws were eliminated?

A Power Shift

First, power would tilt away from the state and toward the family. Without legal force compelling school attendance, parents would have the freedom and flexibility to assume full responsibility for their child’s education. They would not need government permission to homeschool, as is currently required in the majority of U.S. states. Private schools would not need to submit their attendance records to the state to show compliance. Public schools could still be available to those who wanted them, as they were prior to the 1852 law; but government schooling would no longer be the default education option.

More Choices

Because the state would no longer need to bless the creation of various private schools and ratify their curriculum and attendance protocols, an assortment of education options would emerge. Entrepreneurial educators would seize the opportunity to create new and varied products and services, and parents would be the ones responsible for determining quality and effectiveness—not the state. With less government red tape, current trends in education would gain more momentum. Virtual schooling, part-time school options, hybrid homeschooling models, and an array of private schools with diverse education approaches would emerge. As more education choices sprouted, competition would lower prices, making access to these new choices more widespread.

More Pathways to Adulthood

Without the state mandating school attendance for most of childhood, in some states up to age 18, there would be new pathways to adulthood that wouldn’t rely so heavily on state-issued high school diplomas. Innovative apprenticeship models would be created, community colleges would cater more toward independent teenage learners, and career preparation programs would expand. As the social reformer Paul Goodman wrote in his book New Reformation: “Our aim should be to multiply the paths of growing up, instead of narrowing the one existing school path.”

A Broader Definition of Education

In his biography of Horace Mann, historian Jonathan Messerli explains how compulsory schooling contracted a once expansive definition of education into the singular definition of schooling. Indeed, today education is almost universally associated with schooling. Messerli writes: “That in enlarging the European concept of schooling, [Mann] might narrow the real parameters of education by enclosing it within the four walls of the public school classroom.”² Eliminating compulsory schooling laws would break the century-and-a-half stranglehold of schooling on education. It would help to disentangle education from schooling and reveal many other ways to be educated, such as through non-coercive, self-directed education, or “unschooling.”

Even the most adamant education reformers often stop short of advocating for abolishing compulsory schooling statutes, arguing that it wouldn’t make much difference. But stripping the state of its power to define, control, and monitor something as beautifully broad as education would have a large and lasting impact on re-empowering families, encouraging educational entrepreneurs, and creating more choice and opportunity for all learners.

¹ Samuel Bowles and Herbert Gintis, “The origins of mass public education,” *History of Education: Major Themes, Volume II: Education in its Social Context*, ed. Roy Lowe (London: Routledge Falmer, 2000), 78.

² Jonathan Messerli, *Horace Mann: A Biography* (New York: Alfred A. Knopf, 1972), 429.



THURSDAY, JUNE 12, 2025 Families need choices, not punishments.
KERRY MCDONALD

Now Is the Time to Eliminate Compulsory Schooling Laws

In the spring of 2019, HuffPost ran an in-depth story on the human costs of Kamala Harris’s war on truancy. It described how Harris had cracked down on truancy when she was San Francisco’s district attorney and later as California’s attorney general. Her efforts were ruining lives. When she took her post as the state’s top “progressive prosecutor” in 2011, Harris vowed that parents would “face the full force and consequences of the law” if their children missed too many days of school. They soon felt that force. Numerous parents were handcuffed in front of their children and hauled off to jail for violating compulsory school attendance laws. One of the parents arrested under Harris’s watch was Cheree Peoples, whose 11-year-old daughter struggled with painful sickle cell disease and had reportedly missed 20 days of school.

Soon after the HuffPost exposé appeared, I wrote about how compulsory schooling laws aren’t progressive—they’re inhumane. It is one of several FEE articles I have written on this topic since 2017, because repealing compulsory school attendance laws is a fundamental pathway toward removing the coercive underpinnings of American K-12 education. This week at the annual FreedomFest conference, I am presenting on a panel about ending these laws.

It’s good timing. Last week, Politico reported that “California lawmakers are quietly advancing a bill that would undo controversial anti-truancy legislation Kamala Harris pushed more than a decade ago.” While the proposed California bill doesn’t seek to abolish compulsory school attendance, it is a step in the right

direction. This legislative action should be applauded, and more states should follow California’s lead by loosening—and ideally eliminating—compulsory school attendance laws.

When my home state of Massachusetts became the first to enact a compulsory school attendance law in May 1852, it set a troubling precedent. For the first time, parents were compelled to send their children to school under a legal threat of force. Indeed, that was the intent. Six months before that law was passed, William Swan, editor of The Massachusetts Teacher, clearly stated the purpose of this compulsion:

In too many instances the parents are unfit guardians of their own children. If left to their direction the young will be brought up in idle, dissolute, vagrant habits, which will make them worse members of society than their parents are... Nothing can operate effectually here but stringent legislation, thoroughly carried out by an efficient police; the children must be gathered up and forced into school, and those who resist or impede this plan, whether parents or priests, must be held accountable and punished.

The mid-19th century was a time of massive immigration into Boston, primarily of Irish Catholics who threatened the dominant Anglo-Saxon Protestant cultural norms of the time. Compulsory school attendance laws were used as a coercive tactic to mold these newcomers. Not surprisingly, and largely by design, it was the poor and downtrodden who experienced the brunt of these laws, while parents like Horace Mann the architect of the

Massachusetts “common school” movement, homeschooled his own children even as he mandated forced schooling for others.

Today, it is still the poor and disadvantaged who bear the brunt of compulsory school attendance laws, which spread to all US states by the early 20th century. In 2023, the Missouri Supreme Court upheld a high-profile case involving two separate single moms who were sentenced to jail because their elementary-age children each missed approximately fifteen days of school during the 2021–22 academic year.

And just three weeks ago, a Florida judge sentenced two parents to jail for not sending their kids to school.

These laws have got to go. If schools are desirable places to grow and to learn, then families and students will happily flock to them, as they do to the schools and spaces featured in my new book, Joyful Learning. The breathtaking expansion of school-choice programs across the US, which enable a portion of education funding to follow students to their preferred educational environment, can help to increase the variety of learning options available to families, helping them to find a desirable fit.

The current “chronic absenteeism” epidemic in schools across the country, typically defined as students missing at least 10% of schooldays, is a sign that forced schooling isn’t desirable for many students and their families. The solution isn’t to prosecute parents or threaten students with disciplinary action. The solution is to reduce compulsion, expand choice, and encourage entrepreneurial parents and teachers to launch new and better schools that students and parents want.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)

<https://fee.org/>



TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 25, 2020 Cuba has made less educational and health care progress than most Latin American countries over the last 60 years, data show.
HANS BADER

No, Fidel Castro Didn't Improve Health Care or Education in Cuba

On CBS's 60 Minutes, Senator Bernie Sanders recently praised the achievements of communist Cuba. An interviewer asked him about his 1985 comments that Cubans supported communist dictator Fidel Castro because he "educated their kids, gave their kids health care, totally transformed society." In response, Sanders defended those comments, by stating that when "Fidel Castro came into office, you know what he did? He had a massive literacy program."

But Castro did not give Cubans literacy. Cuba already had one of the highest literacy rates in Latin America by 1950, nearly a decade before Castro took power, according to United Nations data (statistics from UNESCO). In 2016, the Washington Post fact-checker Glenn Kessler debunked a politician's claim that Castro's rule significantly improved Cuban healthcare and education.

In today's Cuba, children are taught by poorly paid teachers in dilapidated schools. Cuba has made less educational progress than most Latin American countries over the last 60 years.

According to UNESCO, Cuba had about the same literacy rate as Costa Rica and Chile in 1950 (close to 80 percent). And it has almost the same literacy rate as they do today (close to 100 percent).

Meanwhile, Latin American countries that were largely illiterate in 1950—such as Peru, Brazil, El Salvador, and the Dominican Republic—are largely literate today,

closing much of the gap with Cuba. El Salvador had a less than 40 percent literacy rate in 1950, but has an 88 percent literacy rate today. Brazil and Peru had a less than 50 percent literacy rate in 1950, but today, Peru has a 94.5 percent literacy rate, and Brazil a 92.6 percent literacy rate. The Dominican Republic's rate rose from a little over 40 percent to 91.8 percent. While Cuba made substantial progress in reducing illiteracy in Castro's first years in power, its educational system has stagnated since, even as much of Latin America improved.

Contrary to Sanders' claim that Castro "gave" Cubans healthcare, they already had access to healthcare before he seized power. Doctors frequently provided free healthcare to those who couldn't afford it. As the Washington Post's Glenn Kessler noted:

As for health care and education, Cuba was already near the top of the heap before the revolution. Cuba's low infant mortality rate is often lauded, but it already led the region on this key measure in 1953-1958, according to data collected by Carmelo Mesa-Lago, a Cuba specialist and professor emeritus at the University of Pittsburgh.

Cuba led virtually all countries in Latin America in life expectancy in 1959, before Castro's communists seized power. But by 2012, right after Castro stepped down as Communist Party leader, Chileans and Costa Ricans lived slightly longer than Cubans. Back in 1960, Chileans had a life span seven years shorter than Cubans, and Costa Ricans lived more than two years less than Cubans

on average. In 1960, Mexicans lived seven years shorter than Cubans; by 2012, the gap had shrunk to just two years. (Today, life spans are virtually the same in Cuba as more prosperous Chile and Costa Rica—if you accept the rosy official statistics put out by Cuba's communist government, which many people do not. Cuba has been credibly accused of hiding infant deaths, and exaggerating the life spans of its citizens. If these accusations are true, Cubans die sooner than Chileans or Costa Ricans). Cuba has made less progress in health care and life expectancy than most of Latin America in recent years, due to its decrepit health care system. "Hospitals in the island's capital are literally falling apart." Sometimes, patients "have to bring everything with them, because the hospital provides nothing. Pillows, sheets, medicine: everything." As The Washington Post's Kessler noted:

Reporters have also documented that Cuban hospitals are ill-equipped. A 2004 series on Cuba's health-care system in Canada's National Post said pharmacies stock very little and antibiotics are available only on the black market. "One of the myths Canadians harbor about Cuba is that its people may be poor and living under a repressive government, but they have access to quality health and education facilities," the Post said. "It's a portrait encouraged by the government, but the reality is sharply different."

Under communism, Cuba has also fallen behind on more general measures of human development. As the progressive economist Brad DeLong pointed out:

Cuba in 1957—was a developed country. Cuba in 1957 had lower infant mortality than France, Belgium, West Germany, Israel, Japan, Austria, Italy, Spain, and Portugal. Cuba in 1957 had doctors and nurses: as many doctors and nurses per capita as the Netherlands, and more than Britain or Finland. Cuba in 1957 had as many vehicles per capita as Uruguay, Italy, or Portugal. Cuba in 1957 had 45 TVs per 1000 people—fifth highest in the world ... Today? Today the UN puts Cuba's HDI [Human Development indicators] in the range of ... Mexico. (And Carmelo Mesa-Lago thinks the UN's calculations are seriously flawed: that Cuba's right HDI peers today are places like China, Tunisia, Iran, and South Africa.) Thus I don't understand lefties who talk about the achievements of the Cuban Revolution: '... to have better health care, housing, education.'

As Michael Giere notes, Cuba was prosperous before Castro's communists seized power:

A United Nations (UNESCO) report in 1957 noted that the Cuban economy included proportionally more workers who were unionized than in the U.S. The report also stated that average wages for an eight hour day were higher in Cuba than in "Belgium, Denmark, France, and Germany." ... PBS explained in a 2004 retrospective, that. "Havana [prior to Castro] was a glittering and dynamic city. Cuba ranked fifth in the hemisphere in per capita income, third in life expectancy, second in per capita ownership of automobiles and telephones, first in the number of television sets per inhabitant. The literacy rate, 76%, was the fourth highest in Latin America. Cuba ranked 11th in the world in the number of doctors per capita. Many private clinics and hospitals provided services for the poor. Cuba's income distribution compared favorably with that of other Latin American societies. A thriving middle class held the promise of prosperity and social mobility."

But after Castro took over, the prosperity came to an end:

Castro's destruction of Cuba cannot be over dramatized. He looted, murdered, and destroyed the nation from the ground up. Just one factoid explains it all; Cubans once enjoyed one of the highest consumption of proteins in the Americas, yet in 1962 Castro had to introduce ration cards (meat, 2 ounces daily), as food consumption per person crashed to levels not seen since the 1800s.

Hunger became so widespread that a visiting Swedish doctor, Hans Rosling, had to warn Cuba's dictator in 1992 about widespread protein deficiency among Cubans. Roughly 40,000 Cubans had been reported to have been experiencing "visual blurring and severe numbness in their legs." Rosling investigated at the invitation of the Cuban embassy in Sweden, and with the approval of Castro himself. Rosling travelled to the heart of the outbreak, in the western province of Pinar del Río. It turned out that those stricken with the disorder all suffered from protein deficiency. The government was rationing meat, and adults had sacrificed their portion to nourish children, pregnant women and the elderly. Dr. Rosling told Fidel Castro about this.

During this period of widespread hunger, Bernie Sanders was peddling the myth that hunger was non-existent in Cuba. In 1989, he published a newspaper column claiming that Fidel Castro's Cuba had "no hunger, is educating all of its children and is providing high quality, free health care."

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)

<https://fee.org/>



WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 21, 2024 Casimir Pulaski and Thaddeus Kosciuszko are two names that are worth remembering.
LAWRENCE W. REED

Two Polish Heroes Every American Should Know

As a sixth grader some 60 years ago, I learned that two Polish heroes played prominent roles in the struggle to secure American independence from Great Britain—Casimir Pulaski and Thaddeus Kosciuszko. What they did for America left a deep impression on me and began a lifelong appreciation for Poland and things Polish.

As a successful commander against invading Russian forces, Pulaski, one of only eight people ever to receive honorary U.S. citizenship, was a hero in his native land (then known as the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth) before he came to America in 1777 at the age of 32.

Pulaski told George Washington, whose life he later saved on the battlefield, “I came here, where freedom is being defended, to serve it, and to live or die for it.” By the time he was killed in action two years later near Savannah, Georgia, he had earned the rank of brigadier general in the Continental Army.

Pulaski became “the Father of the American Cavalry” and is buried near Savannah, not far from an 18th-century fort that bears his name. All over America you can find highways, townships, towns and villages, schools, bridges, and monuments monikered in his memory.

Thaddeus Kosciuszko, however, is my focus in this essay. Born in 1746, a few months after Pulaski, Kosciuszko came to America for the same reason, to fight for liberty. He distinguished himself as a master engineer

of fortifications and, like Pulaski, also earned the rank of brigadier general. His work proved indispensable to the American victory at Saratoga and in the successful defense of West Point.

Later dispatched to the South, he is credited with valuable service in the Carolinas, including the reoccupation of Charleston after the British retreat. He endured seven years of fighting for America without pay, until Congress finally found the money to compensate him and other Continental Army soldiers, meager though it was.

But it is for another venture that I write about Kosciuszko here. Over eight months from March to November 1794—exactly 230 years ago—he led a courageous insurrection in his native Poland against the Russians.

Insurrection is a loaded term these days, laden with offensive connotations. But in Poland all these years later, the so-called “Kosciuszko Insurrection” is celebrated as a heroic moment. Context is important. This one was much more than a crowd out of control; it was composed of armed men seeking a violent overthrow of a foreign occupier. The Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth in the early 1790s was a nation under siege by three powerful neighbors: Austria-Hungary, Prussia, and most importantly, Russia. Those three adjoining nations had long vexed the Poles—grabbing land, bribing Polish politicians, and

isolating the country diplomatically. After his valiant efforts on behalf of the freedom of America, he returned to Europe to fight for the freedom of his beloved Poland.

When the Russians invaded the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth in 1792, Kosciuszko sprang into action. Rising to the rank of lieutenant general, he fought the Russians and never lost a battle. But in an act judged misguided at best and cowardly at worst, King Stanisław Poniatowski stunned the nation by ordering a cessation of hostilities against the Russians. The King’s surrender opened the door to Russian occupation, and in disgust, Kosciuszko left the country to begin planning a revolution against the Russian usurpers.

The King thought he had struck a deal with the Russians that would leave Polish borders intact. That was naïve. If you wonder why Poles today distrust, even despise, the regime then in St. Petersburg and now in Moscow, this is one of many good reasons. In January 1793, Russia and Prussia signed an agreement that produced a second partition of the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth (the first being in 1772) that shrunk the country further.

The patriot in Kosciuszko wouldn’t allow for acceptance of these circumstances. Working with other Polish emigres in Europe, he plotted to liberate occupied Poland. Under threat of arrest and execution, he made his way back to the country, and in the main square of Krakow on March 24, 1794, he daringly announced what would quickly become known as the Kosciuszko Insurrection. He was now commander-in-chief of Polish-Lithuanian forces opposing the forces of Catherine the Great’s autocratic Russia.

Kosciuszko’s forces fought valiantly in every corner of the country. Two months in, he issued the Polaniec Manifesto. It granted the people substantial civil liberties and a partial end to serfdom, private ownership of land, and certain legal rights previously unknown to ordinary people. Though the Manifesto rallied the peasantry to support the cause of the insurrection, it was ultimately to little avail. The old nobility resisted it, and by November, the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth succumbed to the overwhelming numbers of the Russian enemy.

Kosciuszko’s effort failed. The Commonwealth was snuffed out by the third and final partition of the country in 1795. For the next 123 years, the map of Europe showed no Poland and no Lithuania. In the part of the old Commonwealth won at gunpoint by the Russians, a kind of ethnic cleansing took place. The occupiers sought to erase Polish culture and heritage, but brave Poles continued to resist as they created one of the most innovative underground societies in the world. Even the famous Polish Nobel laureate and physicist Maria Skłodowska (Marie Curie) would earn her undergraduate degree in an illegal, underground university.

With the conclusion of World War I in 1918, Poland and Lithuania would both emerge again on the map. And the first thing a revived Polish nation faced was an attack by Lenin’s Bolshevik Russia. Undoubtedly emboldened by Kosciuszko’s example of so many decades before, Poles clobbered the Russians and saved Europe from a communist assault.

As for Kosciuszko himself: After the Russian victory in 1795, he emigrated to America again. He enjoyed a long friendship with many American patriots, including Thomas Jefferson. He wrote his will in 1798 and bequeathed much of his estate to the freedom and education of black slaves in the U.S. He died in Switzerland in 1817, at age 71.

And now you know yet another reason why, though I have no Polish blood in me, I love Poland!



THURSDAY, MARCH 7, 2024 Any efforts to control new school startups or create “guardrails” around them will only slow educational progress and stymie entrepreneurship and innovation.

A Robust Education Marketplace Means Some Schools Will Fail

A couple of years ago, I was presenting at a small education conference in New York when someone asked what a success indicator might be for a dynamic, decentralized education marketplace.

“When we see some schools shutting down,” I responded.

In an education free market, parents are the customers. If they are not satisfied with a particular school’s offerings, they can and will leave—just as they would stop using any other product or service that doesn’t meet their expectations. If enough parents aren’t satisfied and leave, the school will shut down. This is a signal of a vibrant, competitive educational marketplace. It is the ultimate accountability metric.

It’s perhaps because true accountability in the education system is so rare that when it does occur it can prompt concern. That was the case with a new microschool in West Virginia that shuttered after just a few months in operation. Parents weren’t happy with their children’s program so they demanded, and received, a refund and the school closed. It was an example of the market working well, not poorly. As the Nobel Prize-winning economist Friedrich Hayek wrote in *The Road to Serfdom*: “Our freedom of choice in a competitive society rests on the fact that, if one person refuses to satisfy our wishes,

we can turn to another.”

Still, this small business failure raised alarm bells because the families who attended the microschool received funds through West Virginia’s new school choice program, the Hope Scholarship education savings account (ESA), that enables families to access a portion of state-allocated education funding to use toward a variety of educational expenses, including microschools.

“Hailed by Republicans, and fueled by the spread of ESAs, microschools operate out of homes, storefronts and churches with a degree of freedom from government oversight. But the West Virginia episode shows that managing that freedom while maintaining public accountability can be a tricky balancing act...,” The 74’s Linda Jacobson recently reported, adding that the state Treasurer’s office is conducting an investigation and some advocates are calling for “guardrails” around education entrepreneurship.

Yet, the “public accountability” in this instance was full and immediate, thanks to a decentralized, competitive education market. The parents left and got their Hope Scholarship funds back, and the school closed. This is a far cry from the supposedly taxpayer-accountable West Virginia public schools which are among the worst performing in the nation and yet see increasing budgets.

“School choice is successful at growing good schools and closing bad schools,” said Katie Switzer, a West Virginia parent and ardent supporter of school choice policies such as the Hope Scholarship. “How long do you think it would take a poor-performing traditional public school to be closed or overhauled? Certainly more than a few months,” she told me, referencing how quickly the undesirable microschool closed.

Indeed, school choice policies can help to accelerate education entrepreneurship, catalyze innovation and experimentation, and make new K-12 schools and learning spaces more accessible to more families. Sometimes, these new schools and spaces will fail, just as 20 percent of all U.S. businesses do within their first two years, and nearly half do within their first five years. But surely it’s better to let bad schools fail than to preserve the status quo, which keeps them open in perpetuity.

The West Virginia microschool failure demonstrates a feature of the free market, not a flaw. The great strength of the market approach is that free people are able to freely choose products and services aligned with their individual needs and preferences and take their business elsewhere when they are not satisfied.

Any efforts to control new school startups or create “guardrails” around them will only slow educational progress and stymie entrepreneurship and innovation. As the economist Milton Friedman reminds us: “Underlying most arguments against the free market is a lack of belief in freedom itself.” Let’s believe in freedom—in education and beyond.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>



TUESDAY, JANUARY 23, 2018 The advantage gained by having a college degree is rapidly diminishing.
RICHARD VEDDER

From Apprenticeships to Microcredentials, Why Alternatives to College Are Gaining Popularity

There has been mounting evidence that the financial payoff from the traditional bachelor's degree is declining, particularly for men. For example, the Census Bureau data suggest that from 2005 to 2016, the average earnings differential for male workers holding bachelor's degrees compared with those holding high school diplomas fell from \$39,440 to \$37,653 (in 2016 dollars)—at a time when college costs were rising.

Other evidence from the New York Federal Reserve Bank confirms that a large portion of college graduates are underemployed, working jobs traditionally held by high school graduates.

There are two interpretations of this data, one by the general American public and the second from the "College for All" crowd, the cheerleaders for higher education who believe the nation benefits from more students earning more degrees.

Time to Upgrade the New Standard

Turning to the first interpretation, in light of rising costs and at best stagnant benefits, more Americans are simply not going to universities. The National Student Clearinghouse reports enrollments are down for the sixth consecutive year, which is unprecedented in modern American history. Even during the Great Depression,

enrollments grew.

The College for All interpretation is that the diminishing payoff to the bachelor's degree means students need to get more degrees, specifically master's degrees. Historically, a bachelor's degree was a powerful and reliable signaling device, telling employers that the college-educated individual was almost certainly smarter, more knowledgeable, disciplined, ambitious, and harder-working than the average American. College graduates were special people — the best and the brightest, deserving a nice wage premium in labor markets.

But now that one-third of adult Americans have bachelor's degrees, some college graduates have pretty ordinary levels of intelligence and the other positive attributes that employers like. The fact that American college students on average spend less than 30 hours weekly on academics for perhaps 30 weeks annually reinforces this point. Therefore, to get a positive "sheepskin effect" from a diploma, one now has to go for the new standard, a master's degree. If trends continue, by 2025 we will be offering master's degrees in janitorial science.

Yet there are two pieces of evidence showing that even obtaining a master's is not a surefire path to economic success; indeed it may be an increasingly risky one.

Not All Master's Degrees Are Created Equal

First, I examined the earnings differential between workers with master's and with bachelor's degrees over the 25 years of 1991 to 2016, using Census Bureau data. In the first part of that period, say 1991 to 2005, the master's payoff grew substantially, but since then, that is decidedly not the case for men.

Looking at the average earnings differential in inflation-adjusted terms, the average master's degree advantage for working men declined over 28 percent from \$20,768 in 2005 to \$14,877 in 2016.

Then there is a new American Enterprise Institute study by Mark Schneider and Jorge Klor de Alva, "The Master's as the New Bachelor's Degree." The payoff from a master's degree varies vastly by field of study. Census Bureau data for 2009 shows that for social science majors, the master's degree earnings advantage was less than \$100 monthly, but it was more than \$3,000 monthly in business administration.

The authors gathered unique data from Colorado, Texas, and Florida. It turns out that earnings for those receiving master's degrees are extremely low in some situations — less than those with bachelor's degrees typically make. Philosophy master's graduates in Colorado had annual median earnings under \$30,000, while "area studies" master's graduates in Texas typically earned a relatively paltry \$36,000 annually. Yet petroleum engineers with master's degrees in Colorado had typical earnings of \$176,500 annually, six times the earnings of philosophy graduates.

This study shows the dangers of looking at broad aggregate statistics. The field of study is as important in determining earnings as the level of degree earned, and labor market location importantly matters as well. Additionally, there are important gender differences. While on average, the payoff to earning a master's declined for men after 2005, it rose significantly for women.

Although the AEI and Census data don't show it, I suspect the payoff from a degree also varies dramatically by institution. The U.S. Department of Education, when it is not harassing colleges by mandating Star Chamber procedures for student judiciary proceedings, occasionally publishes some interesting statistics. Looking at undergraduates, for example, I learned that the average student at M.I.T. makes \$94,200 after graduating, 2.3 times the average \$41,000 earnings at Salem State, located only 18 miles away.

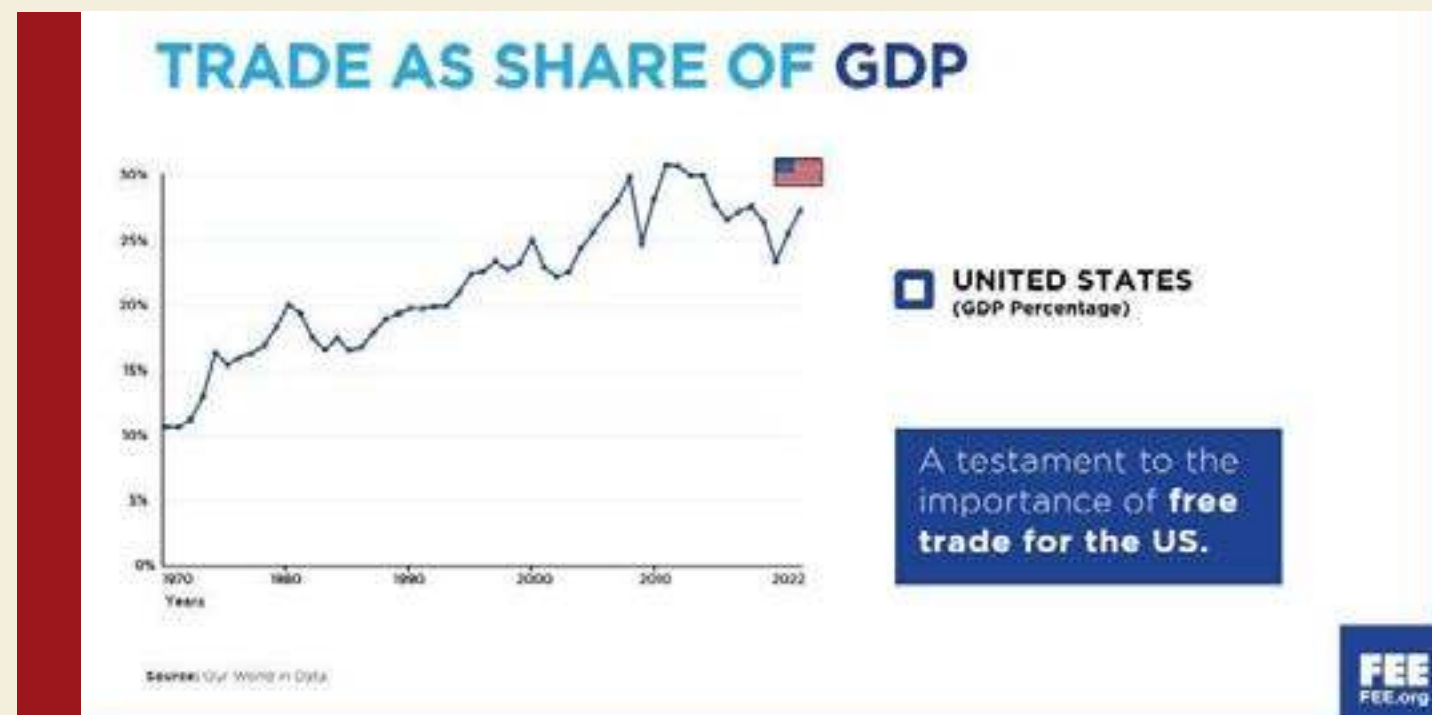
As Bryan Caplan points out in his new book, *The Case Against Education*, most of the earnings differential associated with college does not reflect stuff colleges teach their students, but rather the already-existing advantages that college graduates possess (more intelligence, greater discipline, more ambition, more prior learning, etc.). The Sheepskin Effect is real. We expend enormous resources in producing pieces of paper (diplomas) conveying labor market information. The move toward getting a master's degree — more diplomas — aggravates an already hugely inefficient system.

Are There Better Ways to Provide Evidence of Potential Competency?

Suppose every person seeking highly-skilled employment in America took a standardized National College Equivalency Examination (NCEE) that was 3.5 hours long, testing critical reasoning and writing skills (perhaps the existing CLA+ exam), general knowledge that all college graduates should know (via a 75 multiple choice question test), and maybe 25 questions in the student's area of major interest.

My guess is that the correlation of scores on that test with either college reputation or the actual post-graduate earnings of those tested would be quite high. With some exceptions, the best jobs would go to the kids with the highest scores. So why even require degrees? Why mess with college accreditation — look at the scores on the NCEE for each college's graduates. Why isn't the business community devising such a test?

No doubt there are other approaches to stop the gamesmanship leading students to obtain master's degrees that often do relatively little to truly improve employment skills or much else, such as making students more virtuous.



TUESDAY, JULY 23, 2024

SERGIO MARTÍNEZ

The benefits of global trade are significant—and often underappreciated.

Why Trade in the US Remains an Important Force for Development

Protectionist fears have not stopped the United States from capitalizing on the gains of free trade. Trade as a share of GDP grew from 10.8 percent in 1970 to 27.4 percent in 2022: an increase of 16.6 percentage points in a span during which the US economy quadrupled in size in real terms. America's value of exported goods and services more than doubles that of the United Kingdom and is over 33 percent higher than that of Germany.

International trade allows each country to specialize in the production of those goods in whose production it enjoys a comparative advantage. Specialization increases the productive capacity of an economy. Absent exchange opportunities, the scope for specialization would be smaller. As Adam Smith suggested in *The Wealth of Nations*, the division of labor is limited by the extent of the market. Thus, trade and production are strongly linked. Economist Douglas Irwin documents how trade reforms have positively impacted economic growth in different countries; while Arnaud Costinot and Andres Rodriguez-Clare suggest in a working paper that the gains from trade for the United States “range from 2 to 8 percent of GDP.”

Trade as a Technology

Free trade has effects similar to those of introducing a new technology: a technology in which we use exports

as “inputs” to obtain imports. Economists Armen Alchian and William R. Allen, authors of *University Economics* (1972), distinguish between three groups of people affected by a new technology. We can replicate their exercise for the evaluation of a trade policy. Free trade will give rise to three categories of people: (1) Those who will receive higher wages as a consequence of the possibilities opened up by trade and who will enjoy a greater variety of goods at lower prices;

(2) Those whose income will not change significantly, but who will enjoy the consumption of goods at lower prices;

(3) Those whose income will probably decrease, as they will have to move to other jobs. In this last category, we can find two further subcategories: (a) those who are net gainers anyway from the benefits of consuming from abroad and (b) those who, even accounting for the gains from cheaper and more varied goods, suffer such a sharp reduction in their real income that they lose in net terms. It is these latter people who have the greatest incentive to form coalitions to fight trade liberalization, although most people make up the rest of the categories.

Economist Bryan Caplan, in his book *The Myth of the Rational Voter*, explains that one of the most common biases among non-economists is the anti-foreigner bias: people tend to underestimate the economic benefits of interacting with foreigners.

I have on a handful of occasions asked for a student to take my class again—a do-over. My oldest son, Josh, needed do-overs for both Pre-Algebra and Algebra 1, and during that time, he was undergoing testing for autism. In the follow-up appointments with specialists, our work as homeschoolers was affirmed. They effectively told us to continue doing exactly what we were doing with the small classes and extended time and instruction. As a result of the do-overs, Josh gained such confidence in math that he went on to become the top student in his Geometry and Algebra 2 classes, and aced all of his college math classes.

My youngest son, Samuel, also benefited from a do-over of Pre-Algebra. His confidence in math soared. He was a top student in Algebra 1 and took both Geometry and Algebra 2 the following year, acing both classes. This year, in addition to taking Advanced Math (Pre-Calculus and Trigonometry), he is also dual-enrolled in a college math class, and has an A in both classes thus far.

At the beginning of this academic year, the parent of a former student of mine reached out to share that her student tested out of college math. She pointed back to the academic foundation her student received in my math classes and specifically noted that her son taking a do-over in Pre-Algebra proved to be one of the best decisions for him. Another homeschooling parent took her student back two grade levels in math and focused on solidifying his foundations. He recently graduated college with honors with an Engineering degree.

Why does the do-over work at eXtend? I believe part of the answer is found in how it is presented to students. Using words such as “we need to spend some more time on...” and “not yet”—very different from “no”—and even the term “do-over” changes how students perceive repeating a class. Presenting the do-overs as opportunities to make sure students are incredibly strong in certain skills and giving them the option to serve as leaders in the class can go a long way towards helping students embrace the do-over.

Additionally, a do-over at eXtend doesn't necessarily mean a student is repeating an entire grade. Rather, it is more targeted to a specific subject or skill set that needs additional work before moving forward. This level of flexibility is one of the many benefits of a nontraditional educational setting such as homeschooling.

Ultimately, the heart of the do-over is not to punish or condemn a student. Rather, the heart of the do-over is to empower the student by providing needed educational space and time to grow and gain confidence and master foundational skills. In every instance when a student has needed a do-over, that student has emerged with a strong foundation and the confidence to proceed to the next level of instruction. Without the do-over, students may struggle; but with the do-over, students may soar!

This bias gives rise to protectionist arguments suggesting that foreigners “steal” jobs or that foreign companies “exploit” local workers.

The idea that international trade “destroys” jobs stems from a fallacy: the lump of labor fallacy. The fallacy consists in assuming that there are only a limited number of jobs to be done. We might conclude that any innovation or technological change that saves labor will leave people who once had an occupation unemployed forever.

The truth, however, is that the reality of scarcity implies that at all times there is an unlimited number of jobs to be done to achieve ends that have not yet been satisfied. Trade sets free resources that individuals, through a market system, can use to produce goods that were previously uneconomical to produce. The more flexible a country's labor market, the more easily it can transfer its resources to the production of those goods.

Protectionists conceive of international trade as a boxing match in a ring. A more appropriate metaphor would be to visualize trade as a relay race: each country runs a distance and passes the “baton” to another. The speed with which countries complete the circuit will depend on the speed and skill of all. Once the baton has been passed to one country, and that country is reluctant to run, the speed (growth) of the other countries slows down. The economic development of all countries is interdependent. Free trade allows countries to explore opportunities for mutually beneficial exchange, and those opportunities enrich us all in the long run.

Additional Reading:

[Why We Trade](#) by Daniel J. Ikenson

[Trade Is What Makes Us Human](#) by Dan Sanchez

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)

<https://fee.org>



SUNDAY, JULY 27, 2025 Covid-era relief for SAVE borrowers expires after five years.
PETER JACOBSEN

The Student Loan Interest Pause Finally Ends

The last holdouts of Covid-era student loan programs will have their interest reinstated in August 2025. In March 2020, President Donald Trump announced a pause on federal student loan payments. The economy was about to shut down (mostly due to government policy), so it seemed fair to suspend the obligation on the part of students to repay the government.

Nobody imagined that this would last as long as five years for some borrowers. During the Biden administration, generosity toward student loan holders expanded. One major addition was the SAVE Plan—a very generous repayment plan which capped interest and offered payments as low as \$0 per month.

This plan was introduced in August 2023, and over the following months around 8 million people (nearly one fifth of all borrowers) registered, despite a coalition of states filing suit to block it. The courts issued an injunction around March 2024 that paused the implementation of SAVE, but did not remove those already registered. SAVE officially ended with the Trump administration’s takeover of the Department of Education. It remains unclear how borrowers will be transitioned off.

For most borrowers, interest forgiveness continued for about three and a half years, with interest accumulation restarting around September 2023. However, borrowers

were given another year without penalties for non-payment (except for the interest accumulation). Borrowers on the SAVE Plan, however, were allowed to remain in interest-free forbearance, where they still are, until next month.

This series of decisions has been extraordinarily expensive. According to the American Enterprise Institute, the interest pause alone cost the government nearly \$250 billion. That means money that would offset federal debts must now come from somewhere else, likely taxpayers.

The US already has several legal pathways to loan forgiveness. Perhaps the largest is Public Service Loan Forgiveness (PSLF). If, after graduation, a borrower works for the government or a qualified non-profit, he can enroll in PSLF. After making 10 years of student loan payments, the remainder of his balance is forgiven.

Other programs, like Income-Driven Repayment (IDR), are available to those with lower incomes and require 20 to 25 years of payments.

This matters because during the Covid student loan repayment pause, the non-payments counted towards the timers of PSLF and IDR. If you were enrolled in one of these programs, you’ve essentially had three years of payments removed from your obligation.

Assuming these programs continue, the Covid pause will have eradicated about 30% of PSLF debt for affected borrowers. Like the interest pause, this lower revenue for the government likely means higher taxes.

On August 1, the pause on interest will finally end for the SAVE Plan holdouts, who at this point have had their loan payments paused for about five years. What the future holds for student loans remains unclear. The Trump administration has signaled a willingness to chip away at programs like PSLF.

A CBS story on the budget reconciliation bill notes:

The new law also does away with Grad PLUS loans, which help people finance higher education degrees... Those seeking unsubsidized federal loans for professional degrees, such as law or medicine, will be restricted to \$50,000 per year and a \$200,000 lifetime cap. Those seeking advanced degrees in nonprofessional areas, such as history or philosophy, will be subject to an annual borrowing cap of \$20,500 and a lifetime limit of \$100,000.

This change likely targets the regressive nature of loan forgiveness—programs that often benefit doctors, lawyers, and others earning high salaries in the nonprofit or government world.

The cost of Covid student loan programs will be with us for a long time. But with the end of SAVE interest forbearance, it seems that Covid-era loan policies are finally behind us.

Source: *The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)* <https://fee.org/>



SATURDAY, JANUARY 12, 2019 The story of a man who showed the world how a peaceful, non-governmental system can flourish.
NAOMI MATHEW

Lysander Spooner: The Anarchist Who Single-Handedly Took on the US Post Office

This is a story about a philosopher, entrepreneur, lawyer, economist, abolitionist, anarchist—the list goes on. As his obituary summarizes, “To destroy tyranny, root and branch, was the great object of his life.” Although he is rarely included in mainstream history, Lysander Spooner was an anarchist who didn’t merely preach about his ideas: He lived them. No example illustrates this better than Spooner’s legal battle against the US postal monopoly.

Born in 1808 in Athol, Massachusetts, Lysander Spooner was raised on his parent’s farm and later moved to Worcester to practice law. Eventually, he found himself in New York City, where business was booming—but not for the Post Office.

The Postal System of the 1840s

In Spooner’s day, government subsidized the cost of building infrastructure used for mail routes. Postage rates paid for these subsidies, which in turn made the rates expensive. For example, in 1840 it cost 18.75 cents, over a quarter of a day’s wages, to send a letter from Baltimore to New York.

Corruption was another issue facing the post office. Positions appeared to change after each election cycle, indicating political cronyism. Congress was also under pressure from the coach contractor lobby, and favorable postage routes were often given to contractors with political connections. Thanks to a legal monopoly it

had enjoyed since the Confederation, the Post Office remained the sole legal mail business despite its skyrocketing costs and corruption. In his book *Uncle Sam, The Monopoly Man*, William Wooldridge describes how high postal costs led some to defy postal laws: Traveling individuals doubled as temporary, private postmen. By the 1840s, these illicit services were chipping into government revenues. Eventually, a court ruled it legal for individuals (but not companies) to carry mail. As a result, underground mail enterprises sprung up. Agents covertly used the existing rails, coaches, and steamboats to transport letters. It is estimated that in 1845, a third of all letters were transported by private mail firms.

Spooner’s Resistance

Spooner, who saw the postal monopoly as unjust, was not content to operate in secrecy like most. Instead, he announced the founding of his private mail company to the US Postmaster General, writing on January 11, 1844: “I propose soon to establish a letter mail from Boston to Baltimore. I shall myself remain in this city, where I shall be ready at any time to answer any suit.” Spooner’s explicit purpose was to challenge the post office’s monopoly; his advertisement boldly claimed: “The Company design also (if sustained by the public) thoroughly to agitate the question, and test the constitutional right of free competition in the business of carrying letters.”

According to Spooner’s book, *Who Caused the Reduction of Postage?: Ought He to Be Paid?*, Spooner’s “American

Letter Mail Company” was distributing mail two weeks later. Delivery occurred daily between New York, Boston, Baltimore, and Philadelphia. Additionally, Spooner’s five-cent stamps were drastically cheaper than the post office’s rates.

Lysander Spooner justified his business to the public in his 1844 pamphlet, “The Unconstitutionality of the Laws of Congress, Prohibiting Private Mails”: He argued that although the Constitution granted Congress the power to “establish post offices and post roads,” this only gave Congress the authority to create a postal service, not to prohibit competition. For comparison, the same Constitutional clause gave Congress the power “to borrow money,” yet no one claimed that only Congress could do that. If a postal monopoly was legitimate, the Constitution would have granted a “sole and exclusive” power to create a postal service like the Articles of Confederation had done.

The Post Office Strikes Back

Constitutional or not, the government defended its monopoly. Six days after Spooner’s company began, Congress introduced a resolution to investigate the establishment of private post offices. Meanwhile, Spooner’s company was booming. As the US postal revenue went down, the government threatened those who were caught serving private mail carriers. In his book, Spooner noted that by March 30, he and his agents were arrested while using a railroad in Maryland to transport letters. Spooner, busy with multiple legal challenges, was released on bail by mid-June (“Mr. Spooner’s Case.” *Newport Mercury*, June 15, 1844.)

People had become accustomed to inexpensive mail, and Congress reluctantly acknowledged the need to lower postal rates. Still, officials stressed that “it was not by competition, but by penal enactment, that the private competition was to be put down” (*The Congressional Globe*, 14. Washington: The Globe Office, 1845, page 206). In March 1845, Congress fixed the rate of postage at five cents within a radius of 500 miles. The post office adopted tactics that private carriers used to increase efficiency, such as requiring prepayment via stamps. These changes turned the post office’s budgetary deficit into a surplus within three years.

The reforms were a victory for the public, but they contributed to the end of Spooner’s company. Legal fees, along with the increased usage of the post office, brought about Spooner’s downfall. As Benjamin Tucker, Spooner’s mentee, described: “[A]s the carrying of each letter constituted a separate offense, the government was able to shower prosecutions on him and crush him out by loading him with legal expenses.”

Spooner went back to Athol and dedicated himself to the abolitionist cause as the Civil War drew near. After the war, he advocated for the right to secession and continued to write on his anarchist views. Finally, on May 14, 1887, Lysander Spooner died peacefully in his room, surrounded by his books and pamphlets.

A Lasting Legacy

In contrast to other activists who tried to lower postal prices through politics, Spooner’s competitive approach de facto forced the government to respond. So although the postal monopoly remained, Spooner’s conflict led to a nearly 75 percent reduction in postal rates, and his legacy remains as the “father of cheap postage in America.”

In 1970, the United States Postal Service replaced the Post Office Department of Spooner’s day. However, the legal monopoly persists, along with the legal battles. In 1971, a company delivering Christmas cards at a lower rate than USPS was stopped by a court injunction. Until 1993, Equifax had been sending letters via FedEx. This ended when company headquarters were raided by armed USPS agents, and the company was fined 30,000 dollars. Even in 2018, President Donald Trump attacked the online retailer Amazon for damaging post office revenues.

In contrast to other activists who tried to lower postal prices through politics, Spooner’s competitive approach de facto forced the government to respond. So although the postal monopoly remained, Spooner’s conflict led to a nearly 75 percent reduction in postal rates, and his legacy remains as the “father of cheap postage in America.”

Despite this, Lysander Spooner’s ideas remain relevant today. Murray Rothbard, founder of the anarcho-capitalist movement, drew inspiration from Spooner. Gerard Casey notes in his book *Murray Rothbard* that it was Rothbard’s synthesis of Spooner’s beliefs and those of other philosophers that shaped modern libertarianism.

Rothbard admired Spooner most for his action-oriented vision. It is easy to denounce government; it is much harder to show how a peaceful, non-governmental system can flourish. With his postal company, Spooner did exactly that. Instead of passively waiting for government reform, Spooner illustrated how individuals could create their own solutions to government problems.

This entrepreneurial version of government resistance persists today in everything from black markets to Bitcoin. The fully anarchist society Spooner envisioned may never happen, but as long as individuals with Spooner’s enterprising spirit exist, “anarchy” will always have a place in society.



THURSDAY, DECEMBER 7, 2023 Child labor operations are more widespread than you realize.
CONNOR VASILE

California’s Dirty Secret

Throughout the summer, Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) agents conducted raids targeting illegal immigrants and cartel members. Tensions culminated in violent riots in Los Angeles, where activists clashed with ICE agents and other federal officials over deportation efforts in the Los Angeles County area. However, one key issue has been overlooked in this debate: the presence of child labor trafficking.

After ICE officials raided a marijuana farm near Camarillo, California, on July 10, it was revealed that at least ten underaged workers, most of them unaccompanied, were kept at the farm as laborers. The cannabis farm is now under federal investigation for potential Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) violations.

How have California authorities responded to illegal child labor operations in their state? Not with the level of concern we might hope.

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass doubled down on her sanctuary city policies just hours after the raid by signing a new executive order further limiting local law enforcement cooperation with federal agents. “We are a proud city of immigrants, and with the Trump Administration signaling that they will ratchet up their chaotic approach, I’m making sure we deploy every resource and tool available within the City to ensure that we are supporting immigrant communities,” Bass said.

“I will never accept these unlawful and chaotic raids and will continue to do all that I can to defend the rights of the people of Los Angeles.” She deftly dodged the issue of child exploitation. California Governor Gavin Newsom similarly deflected, suggesting that ICE were part of the problem, posting on X: “We prosecute criminals that break child labor laws. You make the kids pose for photos, tear gas them, and promote laws like this,” linking to legislative bills in other states.

Unfortunately for America, this ambivalence and refusal to condemn illegal child labor is nothing new. Illegal labor practices are not only well-documented in the US; they are often ignored by authorities. A decade ago, The New Yorker reported on the abusive and illegal working conditions within Chinese fast food restaurants across the country. Workers were smuggled in, lived in squalid conditions, were confined to black-market housing, and were regularly moved from town to town to prevent them from forming lasting relationships. These exploitative operations have become common in many states.

A PBS investigation last year revealed how many children are similarly subject to labor exploitation, in dangerous industries across the country. According to their report: “The most common job for migrant children is also one of the most hazardous, roofing and construction, despite laws prohibiting anyone under 18 from doing so.” These children are working risky jobs, with stolen ID, and nobody is looking out for their interests.

California state law actually hampers investigations into child exploitation when those children are illegally in the country. State Bill 54, signed into law in 2017 by then-Governor Jerry Brown, established a statewide sanctuary for illegal aliens residing in California. Under this law, state and local police officers are prohibited from even inquiring into an individual’s immigration status, thus obstructing leads involving trafficked children. As a result of these policies, federal agencies are left in the dark as to where smuggled children may be, where they are being trafficked, and for what purposes.

Tens of thousands of unaccompanied children remain missing throughout the US. Between 2019 and 2023 alone, ICE reported more than 32,000 unaccompanied migrant children who failed to appear for their immigration court hearings. With limited means to track these minors, coupled with sanctuary states’ refusal to cooperate with federal agencies, it is likely that the true number has ballooned considerably in recent years. ICE Director Tom Homan remarked: “We’re looking for over 300,000 missing children. We’ve already found 10,000... This should be a non-partisan issue... we’re rescuing thousands of children.”

Sanctuary state laws like California’s make rooting out these illegal and oftentimes dangerous work operations next to impossible. And with that, any chance at saving smuggled children is severely diminished. Politics have successfully moralized an issue on which everyone should be united on: saving children from modern-day slavery.

As the PBS investigation noted, regulators are not equipped to track what’s going on in workplaces using child labor: “[T]he system is set up in a way that it’s not going to find children. Children work at night, and the auditors come in the morning. Children work with fake I.D.s. The auditors are checking paperwork, not actually speaking with children.”

Protecting children from exploitation should be a non-partisan priority. Right now, too many legislators seem happy to sweep it under the rug.

Source: The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE) <https://fee.org/>



TUESDAY, JULY 22, 2025 Rent-seeking and exams in India’s public sector exams.
ALEX TABARROK

India’s Talent Trap

In India, government jobs pay far more than equivalent jobs in the private sector—so much so that the entire labor market and educational system have become grossly distorted by rent-seeking to obtain these jobs. Teachers in the public sector, for example, are paid at least five times more than in the private sector. It’s not just the salary. When accounting for lifetime tenure, generous perks, and potentially remunerative possibilities for corruption, a government job’s total value can be up to 10 times that of an equivalent private sector job. (See also here.)

As a result, it’s not uncommon for thousands of people to apply for every government job—a ratio far higher than in the private sector. In one famous example, 2.3 million people submitted applications for 368 “office boy” positions in Uttar Pradesh.

The consequences of this intense competition for government jobs are severe. First, as Karthik Muralidharan argues, the Indian government can’t afford to pay for all the workers it needs. India has all the laws of, say, the United States, but about one-fifth the number of government workers per capita, leading to low state capacity.

But there is a second problem which may be even more serious. Competition to obtain government jobs wastes tremendous amounts of resources and distorts the labor

and educational market.

If jobs were allocated randomly, applications would be like lottery tickets, with few social costs. Government jobs, however, are often allocated by exam performance. Thus, obtaining a government job requires an “investment” in exam preparation. Many young people spend years out of the workforce studying for exams that, for nearly all of them, will yield nothing. In Tamil Nadu alone, between one to two million people apply annually for government jobs, but far fewer than 1% are hired. Despite the long odds, the rewards are so large that applicants leave the workforce to compete. Kunal Mangal estimates that around 80% of the unemployed in Tamil Nadu are studying for government exams.

Classical rent-seeking logic predicts full dissipation: if a prize is worth a certain amount, rational individuals will collectively spend resources up to that amount attempting to win it. When the prize is a government job, the “spending” is not cash, but years of a young person’s productive life. Mangal calculates that the total opportunity cost (time out of the workforce) that job applicants “spend” in Tamil Nadu is worth more than the combined lifetime salaries of the available jobs (recall that jobs are worth more than salaries, so this is consistent with theory). Simply put, for every ₹100 the government spends on salaries, Indian society burns ₹168 in a collective effort of rent-seeking just to decide who gets them.

The winners are happy but the loss to Indian society—of unemployed young, educated workers who do nothing but study for government exams—is in the billions. Indeed, India spends about 3.86% of GDP on state salaries (27% of state revenues times 14.3% of GDP). If we take Mangal’s numbers from Tamil Nadu, a conservative (multiplier of 1 instead of 1.68) back-of-the-envelope estimate suggests that India could be wasting on the order of 1.4% of GDP annually on rent-seeking. (Multiply 3.86% of GDP by 15 (30 years at 5% discount) to get lifetime value, and take 0.025 as annual worker turnover.) Take this with a grain of salt, but regardless, the number is large.

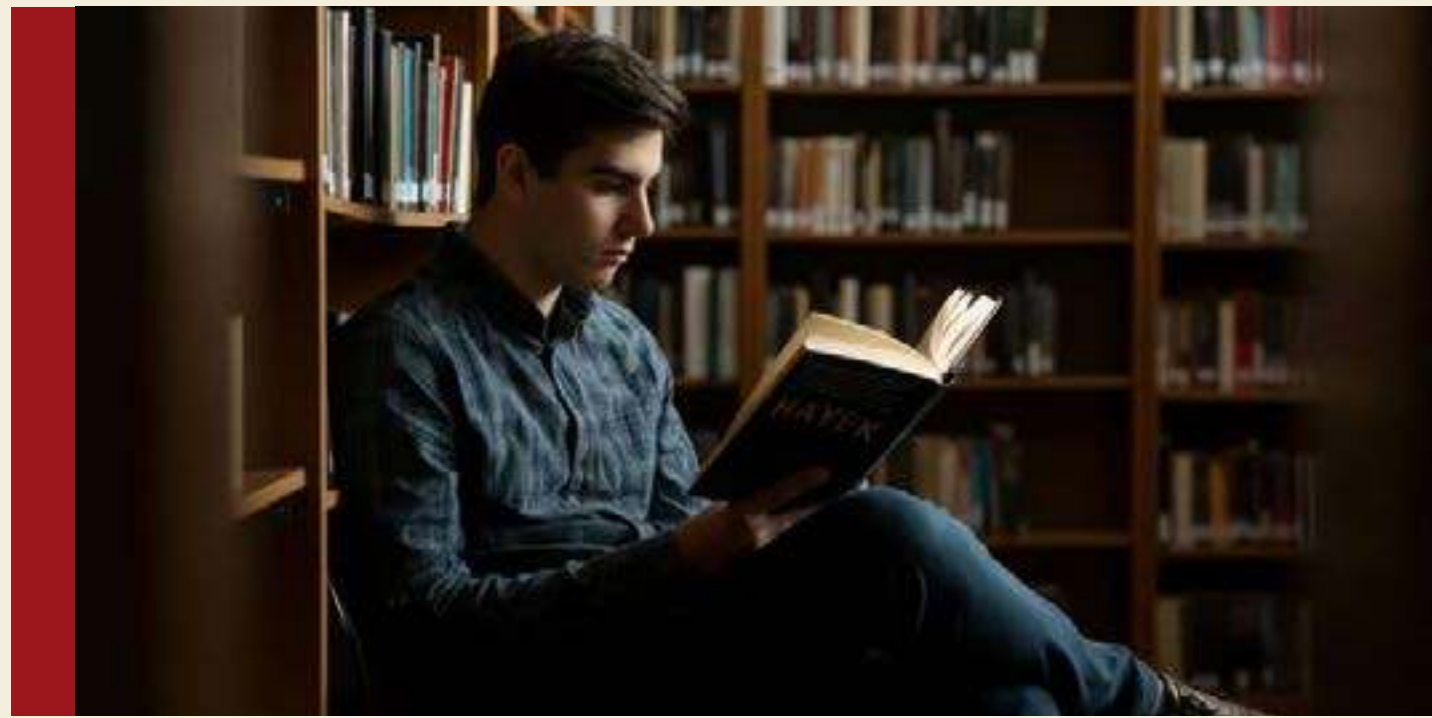
India’s most educated young people—precisely those it needs in the workforce—are devoting years of their lives cramming for government exams instead of working productively. These exams cultivate no real-world skills; they are pure sorting mechanisms, not tools of human capital development. But beyond the staggering economic waste, there is a deeper, more corrosive human cost.

As Rajagopalan and I have argued, India suffers from premature imitation. In this case, India is producing Western-educated youth without the economic structure to employ them. In one survey, 88% of grade 12 students preferred a government job to a private sector job. But these jobs do not and cannot exist in the numbers demanded. The result is disillusioned cohorts trained to expect a middle-class, white-collar lifestyle, convinced that only a government job can deliver it. India is thus creating large numbers of educated young people who are inevitably disillusioned. That is not a sustainable equilibrium.

Mangal valiantly proposes redesigning the exams to reduce waste, but this skirts the core issue: India’s wildly skewed public wage structure. Government salaries far exceed what is justified by GDP per capita or job requirements, distorting education, employment, and unemployment throughout the entire economy in deeply wasteful ways. The only real solution is to bring public sector pay back in line with economic fundamentals.

Source: *The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)*

<https://fee.org/>



TUESDAY, JULY 15, 2025

Students rarely hear the moral case for markets.

LAUREN KIM

Classical Liberalism and the Academy

Teaching libertarian principles at universities is often considered heterodox by those who shape mainstream academic discourse. Of course, many important ideas from the Austrian school of economics have been incorporated into curricula, among them the subjective theory of value, boom and bust cycles, and diminishing marginal utility. But liberty-oriented economic ideas, those that promote economic liberty over government intervention, are generally overlooked.

In their paper *Groupthink in Academia: Majoritarian Departmental Politics and the Professional Pyramid*, Daniel B. Klein and Charlotta Stern discuss how classical liberal viewpoints among professors in the humanities and social sciences are relatively absent, while social democratic ideas prevail. They suggest that academics inclined toward social democratic worldviews project images of their critics, oversimplified stereotypes that broadly label them as “right-wing” or “conservative”—and therefore problematic.

Economist and professor Donald J. Boudreaux notes in an article for CapX that even in high school, he was taught a particular economic narrative: that the Great Depression was caused by capitalism and that Keynesianism saved the day (a narrative he later recognized as flawed and oversimplified). His reflection sheds light on how one-sided economic narratives and myths about markets have become entrenched in American education. In my coursework at Yale (in the ethics, politics, & economics major, which is comparable to a social

sciences program), I find it undeniably true that social democratic ideas are emphasized more than classical liberal ones. This doesn’t mean I haven’t read *The Wealth of Nations* in my classes. However, I have never been exposed to readings by Hayek, a Nobel Prize-winning economist, in my economics and political philosophy courses. This seems worth questioning. *The Use of Knowledge* has over 20,000 citations. *The Road to Serfdom*, which warns of the dangers of central economic planning, is a foundational text of modern political thought. It has been referenced throughout history by key figures like Margaret Thatcher and Ronald Reagan, who cited it as an intellectual justification for rolling back the welfare state. So it seems strange that Hayek’s contributions would be excluded from the political economy curriculum at a university.

Perhaps this is because economics as a discipline has transitioned its emphasis from economic history to abstract economic concepts (such as rational choice and equilibrium) alongside quantitative modeling and data analysis. Or perhaps there are other institutional factors at play as well.

Some on the right argue that the American left has succeeded in a full ideological capture of humanities and social sciences education, particularly in elite institutions. I find criticisms that portray Ivy League students as out-of-touch socialists to be somewhat unfair, or at least lacking in nuance. First of all, a significant portion of students immediately go into

corporate careers, so it simply seems implausible that campuses are truly committed to anti-capitalist ideas, even if progressive thought dominates in the classroom. Yale’s “First Destination summary,” created by the Office of Career Strategy, shows the postgraduate plans of Yale College graduates six months after graduation. For the Class of 2024, finance and consulting were the top two career paths, making up approximately 30.2% of the class.

Secondly, it seems that a fair proportion of students recognize that campuses lean left, which has led to genuine efforts to protect free speech and civil discourse. Yale’s commitment to institutional neutrality reflects an effort to “help protect free speech and a culture of open inquiry on campus,” as noted by Michael Strambler, an Associate Professor at the Yale School of Medicine.

Although less than 3% of Yale’s faculty members are registered as Republicans, 12% of Yale’s undergraduate population are members of the Buckley Institute, a campus organization that promotes intellectual diversity. Even though 12% may not seem like an overwhelming figure, in the context of the student body’s ideological tilt, it’s surprising and encouraging that this many students care about the issue of free speech. Despite what some might think about the homogeneity of political opinions at elite institutions, a decent portion of our campuses at least believe in the importance of learning from perspectives outside of the left-leaning status quo.

But the academic environment nonetheless remains tilted toward left-leaning ideas, especially when it comes to economics. I asked Lawrence Reed, former president of FEE, why free-market ideas receive less attention than more interventionist ideas in today’s universities. He cited Thomas Sowell, who once wrote, “The most fundamental fact about the ideas of the political left is that they do not work. Therefore we should not be surprised to find the left concentrated in institutions where ideas do not have to work in order to survive.” Sowell discusses how academic Marxists are unaffected by the blatant failures of socialism in the real world, claiming that professors can produce whatever content they want as long as the topic is ideologically fashionable enough. He concludes that leftists concentrate in places where it doesn’t matter whether or not their ideas “stand the test of performance,” leading many of them to be drawn to academia.

Echoing this sentiment, lawyer and former university professor Allen Mendenhall told me that most of “our people” (referring to those who are committed to the cause of promoting liberty and free markets around the world) are more often concentrated in public policy think tanks than in universities. It may be because professors, at least at public universities, are government employees and are more likely to be in favor of Keynesianism over libertarian economics.

Or it may be that there is something to be said about the relationship between the university and activism. Although I disagree with the broad sentiment that the academy creates socialists, it seems possible that it encourages the idea that activism is more noble than enterprise, and state intervention is more virtuous than free-market solutions. Klein and Stern suggest that there are certain claims which, despite being plausible and testable, would lead academics to fail on the job market. I think this is particularly true of the first two claims they discuss: that “social justice” is an incoherent idea and that it functions as a moral atavism (as argued by Hayek). In the academy, moral seriousness is assumed to reside on the side of redistribution or state action, casting skepticism toward market-oriented approaches as complicit in “injustice”—however loosely the term might be defined.

Whatever the cause, the marginalization of libertarian ideas has consequences. Christian Houghton, a fellow intern at FEE, gave a presentation on school choice at an academic conference while pursuing a master’s in education policy at Suffolk University. “I was shut down by a professor who claimed that the idea of school choice is racist and bigoted,” he said. “Most other professors I encountered would probably have agreed with that one.” Christian claimed that the university should be a place that encourages freedom in intellectual beliefs, and that academics are often unwilling to be challenged.

I’ve learned from speaking with people in the liberty movement that many of them became passionate about economic liberty after seeking out information outside of the classroom. This is why organizations like FEE play such a crucial role. Without being exposed to free-market ideas, how can young people decide if they’re worth listening to?

Source: *The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)*

<https://fee.org/>



SUNDAY, MARCH 24, 2019

GARY M. GALLES

Governmental choices are not sophisticated ones requiring insights “far beyond those of mortal men” from political Supermen.

Why Government Officials Must Routinely Fudge Basic Arithmetic

For as long as politicians have claimed to represent “the people,” their power has relied on the idea that governing is too complicated or sophisticated to leave to ordinary people.

Common Sense, Not Rocket Science

This, however, was not the understanding of our founding generation. For instance, Cato’s Letters, “the most popular, quotable, esteemed source of political ideas in the colonial period,” according to Clinton Rossiter, said, “The principles of government lie open to common sense; but people are taught not to think of them at all, or to think of them wrong.” Rather than needing people with special, higher understanding to take charge of us, “Every ploughman knows a good government from a bad one...whether the fruits of his labor be his own, and whether he enjoys them in peace and security.” Experience reinforces our Founders’ view. The errors that degrade government policy choices are not sophisticated ones requiring insights “far beyond those of mortal men” from political Supermen. They are basic errors of logic and economic principles. The sophistication comes in how those errors are disguised from or misrepresented to those to be ruled as a result.

Further, such government deceptions have far worse consequences than our personal self-deceptions. We learn from them because we must bear the

consequences of our blunders. The same is not true of politicians. Government’s fingers also invade uncountable areas, with trillions of dollars involved. And misrepresenting issues to create political support, following the adage that “figures don’t lie, but liars figure,” is far surer to reduce citizens’ general welfare than advance it.

Contradictory Reasoning

Consider the abuse of benefit-cost analysis in evaluating government policies. From a technique to organize and clarify our judgments, which Ben Franklin used a version of, it has morphed into a systematic way of misrepresenting reality in the desired political direction. Big government backers routinely count multiplier effects where the government spends money while ignoring that raising the money has similar effects in the opposite directions.

They ignore relevant costs (say, by treating resources already owned by the government as costless even though they have valuable alternative uses). Double counting of benefits is endemic (e.g., counting jobs created and income generated as if they are separate benefits when those are really two different ways of counting the same thing twice).

Costs and completion dates are massively underestimated, overstating benefits (that don’t start until later than promised) and understating costs (California’s bullet train offers an excellent illustration).

The implied higher taxes in the future created by deficits and growing debt are routinely ignored. And those are just for starters.

Using misrepresentation upon misrepresentation, “analysts”—who know “they will never work in this town again” unless they reach the answers their employers want—can reverse-engineer the assumptions necessary to produce them. But they have little relationship to reality and provide virtually no useful guidance.

Backward Fundraising for Massive Spending Proposals

The latest illustration of such massively costly simple errors comes from the Green New Deal and other proposals, such as Medicare for All, free child care, and free higher education, all to be paid for through taxes on “the rich.” Proponents always assert that the rich have enough to pay for each particular piece of their pipedream. But a dollar taken for one of those proposals cannot also finance other proposals, and there are not enough tax dollars to do everything proposed.

Ed Morrissey reports that economists Emmanuel Saez and Gabriel Zucman, primary supporters of Elizabeth Warren’s proposed wealth tax, estimated that it could raise up to \$2.75 trillion over 10 years. But Medicare for All is estimated to cost \$32 trillion over the same period. Even that draconian tax cannot even approach paying for it. And that basic mathematics error is compounded when those same dollars are also represented as able to pay for other promised programs (whose cumulative cost may be \$93 trillion over a decade).

Alternatively, if the government took the wealth of every US billionaire, it could cover only about nine months of federal outlays, and only once, which could not finance multiple massive increases in government spending.

Government, supposedly the advancer of our well-being, routinely relies on logical errors, misrepresentations, and even basic arithmetic mistakes to justify its policies and proposals. Such manipulation advances the interests of those in government and their favorites, not Americans’ general welfare. As Thomas Sowell has written, “When you want to help people, you tell them the truth.”

Can anything good be inferred from how incredibly distant politicians are from that standard?

Source: *The Foundation for Economic Education (FEE)*

<https://fee.org/>



THURSDAY, MARCH 29, 2018 Penn was a remarkable diplomat for religious toleration.
JIM POWELL

William Penn Was America's First Great Champion for Liberty and Peace

Nothing is so contagious as example; and we never do any great good or evil which does not produce its like. — Francois de la Rochefoucauld (1613-1680).

Heroes for liberty are not particular to any region of the world or to a particular time period or to one sex. They hail from all nationalities, races, faiths, and creeds. They inspire others to a noble and universal cause—that all people should be free to live their lives in peace so long as they do no harm to the equal rights of others. They are passionate not solely for their own liberty, but for that of others as well.

In my last book, *Real Heroes: Inspiring True Stories of Courage, Character and Conviction*, I wrote about 40 individuals whose views, decisions, and actions served this cause in various ways. That book planted the seed for this new weekly series to be published each Thursday at FEE.org. But this time, others from around the world will do the writing, and I'll be content to do the editing while keeping that to a minimum to preserve the author's voice. It is my hope that when all is said and done some months from now, the literature of liberty will be greatly complemented by this collection of short biographies. The authors will be writing about heroes for liberty who are (or were) citizens of each author's own country. Each week's installment will be added to the collection here.

The subject of this seventeenth essay in the series is a man whom every American reader should know whether or not you've ever been to my native state of Pennsylvania. William Penn was a giant of colonial America—politically and intellectually. This essay by the Cato Institute's Jim Powell was first published by FEE in October 1995.

— *Lawrence W. Reed, President, Foundation for Economic Education*

William Penn was the first great hero of American liberty. During the late 17th century, when Protestants persecuted Catholics, Catholics persecuted Protestants, and both persecuted Quakers and Jews, Penn established an American sanctuary which protected freedom of conscience. Almost everywhere else, colonists stole land from the Indians, but Penn traveled unarmed among the Indians and negotiated peaceful purchases. He insisted that women deserved equal rights with men. He gave Pennsylvania a written constitution which limited the power of government, provided a humane penal code, and guaranteed many fundamental liberties.

For the first time in modern history, a large society offered equal rights to people of different races and religions. Penn's dramatic example caused quite a stir in Europe. The French philosopher Voltaire, a champion of religious toleration, offered lavish praise.

"William Penn might, with reason, boast of having brought down upon earth the Golden Age, which in all probability, never had any real existence but in his dominions."

Penn was the only person who made major contributions to liberty in both the New World and the Old World. Before he conceived the idea of Pennsylvania, he became the leading defender of religious toleration in England. He was imprisoned six times for speaking out courageously. While in prison, he wrote one pamphlet after another, which gave Quakers a literature and attacked intolerance. He alone proved capable of challenging oppressive government policies in court—one of his cases helped secure the right to trial by jury. Penn used his diplomatic skills and family connections to get large numbers of Quakers out of jail. He saved many from the gallows.

Despite the remarkable clarity of Penn's vision for liberty, he had a curious blind spot about slavery. He owned some slaves in America, as did many other Quakers. Anti-slavery didn't become a widely shared Quaker position until 1758, 40 years after Penn's death. Quakers were far ahead of most other Americans, but it's surprising that people with their humanitarian views could have contemplated owning slaves at all.

Early Life

There were just two portraits of Penn painted during his lifetime, one depicting him as a handsome youth, the other as a stout old man. A biographer described young Penn's

"oval face of almost girlish prettiness but with strong features, the brusqueness of the straight, short nose in counterpoint to the almost sensuous mouth. What gives the face its dominant character are the eyes, burning with a dark, luminous insistence ... it is known from verbal descriptions that Penn was fairly tall and athletic. Altogether, the young man must have been both handsome and impressive."

William Penn was born on October 14, 1644, in London. The most specific description of his mother, Margaret, came from a neighbor, the acid-tongued diarist Samuel Pepys who described her as a "well-looking, fat, short old Dutch woman, but one who hath been heretofore pretty handsome." She did the child-rearing, since her husband, William Penn Sr., was seldom at home. He was a much sought-after naval commander because he knew the waters around England, could handle a ship in bad weather and get the most from his crew. Admiral Penn had a good personal relationship with the Stuart kings and for a while served their most famous adversary, the Puritan Oliver Cromwell.

Left mostly to himself, young William became interested in religion. He was thrilled to hear a talk by Thomas Loe, a missionary for the Society of Friends—derisively known as Quakers. Founded in 1647 by the English preacher George Fox, Quakers were a mystical Protestant sect emphasizing a direct relationship with God. An individual's conscience, not the Bible, was the ultimate authority on morals. Quakers didn't have a clergy or churches. Rather, they held meetings where participants meditated silently and spoke up when the Spirit moved them. They favored plain dress and a simple life rather than aristocratic affectation.

After acquiring a sturdy education in Greek and Roman classics, Penn emerged as a rebel when he entered Oxford University. He defied Anglican officials by visiting John Owen, a professor dismissed for advocating tolerant humanism. Penn further rebelled by protesting compulsory chapel attendance, for which he was expelled at age 17.

His parents sent him to France where he would be less likely to cause further embarrassment and he might acquire some manners. He enrolled at l'Académie Protestante, the most respected French Protestant university, located in Saumur. He studied with Christian humanist Mose Amyraut, who supported religious toleration.

Back in England by August 1664, Penn soon studied at Lincoln's Inn, the most prestigious law school in London. He learned the common law basis for civil liberties and gained some experience with courtroom strategy, which was fortunate; he was going to need it.

Admiral Penn, assigned to rebuilding the British Navy for war with the Dutch, asked that his son serve as personal assistant. Young William must have gained a valuable inside view of high command. Admiral Penn also used his son as a courier delivering military messages to King Charles II. Young William developed a cordial relationship with the King and his brother, the Duke of York, the future King James II.

Penn’s quest for spiritual peace led him to attend Quaker meetings even though the government considered this a crime. In September 1667, police broke into a meeting and arrested everyone. Since Penn looked like a fashionable aristocrat rather than a plain Quaker, the police released him. He protested that he was indeed a Quaker and should be treated the same as the others.

Penn drew on his legal training to prepare a defense. Meanwhile, in jail, he began writing about freedom of conscience. His father disowned him, and young Penn lived in a succession of Quaker households. He learned that the movement was started by passionate preachers who had little education. There was hardly any Quaker literature. He resolved to help by applying his scholarly knowledge and legal training. He began writing pamphlets, which were distributed through the Quaker underground. In 1668, one of his hosts was Isaac Penington, a wealthy man in Buckinghamshire. Penn met his stepdaughter Gulielma Springett, and it was practically love at first sight. Poet John Milton’s literary secretary Thomas Ellwood noted her “innocently open, free and familiar Conversation, springing from the abundant Affability, Courtesy and Sweetness of her natural Temper.” Penn married Gulielma on April 4, 1672. She was to bear seven children, four of whom died in infancy.

Meanwhile, Penn attacked the Catholic/Anglican doctrine of the Trinity, and the Anglican bishop had him imprisoned in the notorious Tower of London. Ordered to recant, Penn declared from his cold isolation cell: “My prison shall be my grave before I will budge a jot; for I owe my conscience to no mortal man.”

By the time he was released seven months later, he had written pamphlets defining the principal elements of Quakerism. His best-known work from this period: No Cross, No Crown, which presented a pioneering historical case for religious toleration.

The Conventicle Act

He wasn’t free for long. To curb the potential power of Catholics, notably the Stuarts, Parliament passed the Conventicle Act, which aimed to suppress religious dissent as sedition. But the law was applied mainly against Quakers, perhaps because few were politically connected. Thousands were imprisoned for their beliefs. The government seized their properties, including the estate of Penn’s wife’s family.

He decided to challenge the Conventicle Act by holding a public meeting on August 14, 1670. The Lord Mayor of London arrested him and his fellow Quakers as soon as he began expressing his nonconformist religious views. At the historic trial, Penn insisted that since the government refused to present a formal indictment—officials were concerned the Conventicle Act might be overturned—the jury could never reach a guilty verdict. He appealed to England’s common-law heritage:

If these ancient and fundamental laws, which relate to liberty and property, and which are not limited to particular persuasions in matters of religion, must not be indispensably maintained and observed, who then can say that he has a right to the coat on his back? Certainly our liberties are to be openly invaded, our wives to be ravished, our children enslaved, our families ruined, and our estates led away in triumph by every sturdy beggar and malicious informer—as their trophies but our forfeits for conscience’s sake.”

The jury acquitted all defendants, but the Lord Mayor of London refused to accept this verdict. He hit the jury members with fines and ordered them held in brutal Newgate prison. Still, they affirmed their verdict. After the jury had been imprisoned for about two months, the Court of Common Pleas issued a writ of habeas corpus to set them free. Then they sued the Lord Mayor of London for false arrest. The Lord Chief Justice of England, together with his 11 associates, ruled unanimously that juries must not be coerced or punished for their verdicts. It was a key precedent protecting the right to trial by jury.

Penn had become a famous defender of liberty who could attract several thousand people for a public talk. He traveled in Germany and Holland to see how Quakers there were faring. Holland made a strong impression because it was substantially free. It was a commercial center where people cared mainly about peaceful cooperation. Persecuted Jews and Protestants flocked to Holland. Penn began to form a vision of a community based on liberty.

He resolved to tap his royal connections for his cause. With the blessing of King Charles II and the Duke of York, Penn presented his case for religious toleration before Parliament. They would have none of it because they were worried about the Stuarts imposing Catholic rule on England, especially since the Duke of York had converted to Roman Catholicism and married a staunch Catholic.

The Founding of Pennsylvania

Penn became convinced that religious toleration couldn’t be achieved in England. He went to the King and asked for a charter enabling him to establish an American colony. Perhaps the idea seemed like an easy way to get rid of troublesome Quakers. On March 4, 1681, Charles II signed a charter for territory west of the Delaware River and north of Maryland, approximately the present size of Pennsylvania, where about a thousand Germans, Dutch, and Indians lived without any particular government.

The King proposed the name “Pennsilvania” which meant “Forests of Penn”—honoring Penn’s late father, the Admiral. Penn would be proprietor owning all the land, accountable directly to the King. According to traditional accounts, Penn agreed to cancel the debt of 16,000 pounds which the government owed the Admiral for back pay, but there aren’t any documents about such a deal. At the beginning of each year, Penn had to give the King two beaver skins and a fifth of any gold and silver mined within the territory.

Penn sailed to America on the ship Welcome and arrived November 8, 1682. With assembled Friends, he founded Philadelphia—he chose the name, which means “city of brotherly love” in Greek. He approved the site between the Delaware and Schuylkill rivers. He envisioned a 10,000-acre city, but his more sober-minded Friends thought that was overly optimistic. They accepted a 1,200-acre plan. Penn named major streets including Broad, Chestnut, Pine, and Spruce.

Penn was most concerned about developing a legal basis for a free society. In his First Frame of Government, which Penn and initial land purchasers had adopted on April 25, 1682, he expressed ideals anticipating the Declaration of Independence:

“Men being born with a title to perfect freedom and uncontrolled enjoyment of all the rights and privileges of the law of nature ... no one can be put out of his estate and subjected to the political view of another, without his consent.”

Penn provided that there would be a governor—initially, himself—whose powers were limited. He would work with a Council (72 members) which proposed legislation and a General Assembly (up to 500 members) which either approved or defeated it. Each year, about a third of members would be elected for three-year terms. As governor, Penn would retain a veto over proposed legislation.

His First Frame of Government provided for secure private property, virtually unlimited free enterprise, a free press, trial by jury and, of course, religious toleration. Whereas the English penal code specified the death penalty for some 200 offenses, Penn reserved it for just two—murder and treason. As a Quaker, Penn encouraged women to get an education and speak out as men did. He called Pennsylvania his “Holy Experiment.”

Penn insisted on low taxes. A 1683 law established a low tax on cider and liquor, a low tariff on imports and on exported hides and furs. To help promote settlement, Penn suspended all taxes for a year. When the time came to reimpose taxes he encountered fierce resistance and had to put it off.

Penn’s First Frame of Government was the first constitution to provide for peaceful change through amendments. A proposed amendment required the consent of the governor and 85 percent of the elected representatives. Benevolent though Penn was, people in Pennsylvania were disgruntled about his executive power as proprietor and governor. People pressed to make the limitations more specific and to provide stronger assurances about the prerogatives of the legislature. The constitution was amended several times. The version adopted on October 28, 1701, endured for three-quarters of a century and then became the basis for Pennsylvania’s state constitution, adopted in 1776.

Collecting rent due to Penn as proprietor was always a headache. He never earned enough from the colonies to offset the costs of administration which he paid out of his personal capital. Toward the end of his life, he complained that Pennsylvania was a net loss, costing him some 30,000 pounds.

Penn’s practices contrasted dramatically with other early colonies, especially Puritan New England which was a vicious theocracy. The Puritans despised liberty. They made political dissent a crime. They whipped, tarred, and hanged Quakers. The Puritans stole what they could from the Indians.

Penn achieved peaceful relations with the Indians—Susquehannocks, Shawnees, and Leni-Lenape. Indians respected his courage because he ventured among them without guards or personal weapons. He was a superior sprinter who could out-run Indian braves, and this helped win him respect. He took the trouble to learn Indian dialects, so he could conduct negotiations without interpreters.

From the very beginning, he acquired Indian land through peaceful, voluntary exchange. Reportedly, Penn concluded a “Great Treaty” with the Indians at Shackamaxon, near what is now the Kensington district of Philadelphia. Voltaire hailed this as “the only treaty between those people [Indians and Christians] that was not ratified by an oath, and that was never infringed.” His peaceful policies prevailed for about 70 years, which has to be some kind of record in American history.

Defending Pennsylvania

Penn faced tough challenges defending Pennsylvania back in England. There was a lot at stake because Pennsylvania had become the best hope for persecuted people in England, France, and Germany. Charles II tried to establish an intolerant absolutism modeled after that of the French King Louis XIV. Concerned that Pennsylvania’s charter might be revoked, Penn turned on his diplomatic charm.

Behind the scenes, Penn worked as a remarkable diplomat for religious toleration. Every day, as many as 200 petitioners waited outside Holland House, his London lodgings, hoping for an audience and help. He intervened personally with the King to save scores of Quakers from a death sentence. He got Society of Friends founder George Fox out of jail. He helped convince the King to proclaim the Acts of Indulgence which released more than a thousand Quakers—many of whom had been imprisoned for over a dozen years.

Penn’s fortunes collapsed after a son was born to James II in 1688. A Catholic succession was assured. The English rebelled and welcomed the Dutch King William of Orange as William III, who overthrew the Stuarts without having to fire a shot. Suddenly, Penn’s Stuart connections were a terrible liability.

He was arrested for treason. The government seized his estates. Though he was cleared by November 1690, he was marked as a traitor again. He became a fugitive for four years, hiding amidst London’s squalid slums. His friend John Locke helped restore his good name in time to see his wife, Guli, die on February 23, 1694. She was 48.

Harsh experience had taken its toll on Penn. As biographer Hans Fantel put it,

“he was getting sallow and paunchy. The years of hiding, with their enforced inactivity, had robbed him of his former physical strength and grace. His stance was now slightly bent, and his enduring grief over the death of Guli had cast an air of listless abstraction over his face.”

His spirits revived two years later when he married 30-year-old Hannah Callowhill, the plain and practical daughter of a Bristol linen draper.

But he faced serious problems because of his sloppy business practices. Apparently, he couldn’t be bothered with administrative details, and his business manager, fellow Quaker Philip Ford, embezzled substantial sums from Penn’s estates. Worse, Penn signed papers without reading them. One of the papers turned out to be a deed transferring Pennsylvania to Ford who demanded rent exceeding Penn’s ability to pay.

After Ford’s death in 1702, his wife, Bridget, had Penn thrown in debtor’s prison, but her cruelty backfired. It was unthinkable to have such a person govern a major colony, and in 1708 the Lord Chancellor ruled that “the equity of redemption still remained in William Penn and his heirs.”

In October 1712, Penn suffered a stroke while writing a letter about the future of Pennsylvania. Four months later, he suffered a second stroke.

While he had difficulty speaking and writing, he spent time catching up with his children whom he had missed during his missionary travels. He died on July 30, 1718. He was buried at Jordans, next to Guli.

Long before his death, Pennsylvania ceased to be a spiritual place dominated by Quakers. Penn’s policy of religious toleration and peace—no military conscription—attracted all kinds of war-weary European immigrants. There were English, Irish, and Germans, Catholics, Jews, and an assortment of Protestant sects including Dunkers, Huguenots, Lutherans, Mennonites, Moravians, Pietists, and Schwenkfelders. Liberty brought so many immigrants that by the American Revolution, Pennsylvania had grown to some 300,000 people and became one of the largest colonies. Pennsylvania was America’s first great melting pot.

Philadelphia was America’s largest city with almost 18,000 people. It was a major commercial center—sometimes more than a hundred trading ships anchored there during a single day. People in Philadelphia could enjoy any of the goods available in England. Merchant companies, shipyards, and banks flourished. Philadelphia thrived as an entrepôt between Europe and the American frontier.

With an atmosphere of liberty, Philadelphia emerged as an intellectual center. Between 1740 and 1776, Philadelphia presses issued an estimated 11,000 works including pamphlets, almanacs, and books. In 1776, there were seven newspapers reflecting a wide range of opinions. No wonder Penn’s “city of brotherly love” became the most sacred site for American liberty, where Thomas Jefferson wrote the Declaration of Independence, and delegates drafted the Constitution.

By creating Pennsylvania, Penn set an enormously important example for liberty. He showed that people who are courageous enough, persistent enough, and resourceful enough can live free. He went beyond the natural right theories of his friend John Locke and showed how a free society would actually work. He showed how individuals of different races and religions can live together peacefully when they mind their own business. He affirmed the resilient optimism of free people.



GRILLED BLUE MARLIN WITH LEMON-BUTTER SAUCE RECIPE

Ingredients

- 150 grams blue marlin
- rock salt
- 1 tbsp calamansi juice
- 1 tsp garlic salt
- 1 tbsp seasoning
- dash paprika
- 1 tbsp melted butter
- 1 tsp chopped garlic, fried
- Lemon Butter sauce:e N
- lemon
- butter
- salt
- parsley



Directions

1. Wash and clean fish with rock salt. Rinse and set aside.
2. Mix together calamansi juice, garlic salt, seasoning, paprika and butter.
3. Marinate blue marlin in mixture for few minutes, turning both sides from time to time.
4. Over hot charcoal, grill the fish 15 minutes or until done on both sides.
5. Baste blue marlin with marinade all over while cooking.
6. remove from heat and serve with lemon and butter sauce. Sprinkle with fried garlic for the finale then serve.

LOUISIANA CORNBREAD DRESSING RECIPE

Ingredients

- The Cornbread:
- 3 tablespoons bacon drippings or butter
- 2 large eggs
- 1-1/2 cups corn meal
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
- 1 teaspoon baking powder
- 1-1/4 cups buttermilk
- The Dressing:
- 1 9x13-inch pan of cornbread, crumbled
- 10 pieces white or whole wheat bread, heels are good (left out overnight)
- 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 3 large stalks celery, chopped
- 1 large onion, chopped (2-1/2 to 3 cups)
- 1 large green pepper, chopped
- 3/4 cup butter (1-1/2 sticks)
- 4 cups chicken broth, canned or homemade
- 3 large eggs, slightly beaten
- 2 tsp poultry seasoning
- 1/2 tsp rubbed sage



Directions

1. Preheat oven to 450°F. Put the bacon drippings/butter in a 9x13-inch baking dish and put it in the oven while it is preheating. It will melt while you're mixing up the batter.
2. Preheat oven to 375°F. Crumble the cornbread and white bread into a very large baking dish or pan (This is the pan you will cook your dressing in, and you need room to stir it while it's cooking). Combine the vegetables with the bread crumbs and mix well. Melt the butter and add it and the beaten eggs, chicken broth and stir. (You may need a little more chicken broth – its better if it's too moist than too dry; the uncooked dressing should be a little on the slushy side.) Add poultry seasoning, rubbed sage, black pepper, and mix thoroughly.

EASY DUMP CAKE: ANGEL FOOD PINEAPPLE CAKE RECIPE

Ingredients

- 1 16-ounce box angel food cake mix
- 1 20-ounce can crushed pineapple in its own juice, undrained
- Optional topping: Powdered sugar or whipped topping



Directions

1. Heat oven to 350 degrees F.
2. Dump cake mix and undrained pineapple into an ungreased 9" x 12" baking pan.
3. Stir together until well blended (see photos).
4. Bake 25 minutes. The top should be nicely browned (see photo) and cake should be pulling away from edges. Do not underbake or cake will sink in center and be too moist.
5. Cool in pan on wire rack.
6. Optional: To serve, dust with powdered sugar or top with a dollop of whipped cream topping.

SUCCOTASH WITH FRESH HERBS & SMOKED MEAT (GLUTEN FREE) RECIPE

Ingredients

- 1 lb of baby lima beans, parboiled for 4 minutes, then rinsed under cold water
- 2 lbs sweet corn, off the cob (you can use frozen veggies, if you don't have access to fresh) {TIP: You CAN make this 1 to 1, beans to corn, but I find that, much like ethanol, more corn produces less gas...}
- 8 oz smoked meat, chopped (ham, venison, duck all work well)
- 1/3 C minced shallots
- 1/2 C red Bell pepper, chopped
- 3 Tbs sweet butter
- 2 tsp granulated sugar
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- 1/2 tsp fresh ground black pepper
- 1/4 tsp grated nutmeg
- 1 C heavy whipping cream
- 1 Tbs fresh chives
- 1 Tbs fresh parsley
- 1 Tbs fresh tarragon



Directions

1. Line the ingredients and groups up as follows:
2. butter, ham, bell pepper & shallots, corn & beans & salt & pepper nutmeg, cream, the 3 minced fresh herbs
3. Melt the butter in a large, deep pan
4. As the butter starts to bubble, add the ham and lightly brown it for about 4 minutes, stirring occasionally
5. Add the Bell pepper & shallots and combine, saute for about 3 minutes
6. Add the corn, beans & seasoning, combining well, stirring often for about 8 minutes
7. Add the cream, cook for 10 minutes, stirring often - vegetables will be tender, cream slightly thickened and reduced
8. Add the minced herbs, combine well.
9. Serve hot

CHERRY WINKS ~ CLASSIC COOKIES (GLUTEN FREE) RECIPE

Ingredients

- 2-1/2 cups flour (GF: King Arthur works great, CIA #2 is excellent)
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 3/4 C shortening (I use lard)
- 1 C granulated sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 Tbs milk
- 1 tsp pure vanilla extract
- 1 C chopped dates
- 1 C chopped pecans
- 1/3 C maraschino cherries, chopped + 12 cherries, quartered
- 2-1/2 C cornflakes, crushed (G-F: Nature's Path Mesa Sunrise (corn, flax, quinoa & amaranth)



Directions

1. Sift the flour, salt, soda and baking powder together & set aside
2. Blend the shortening, sugar
3. Add the eggs and blend with the shortening and sugar mixture
4. Then add the milk and vanilla
5. Incorporate the flour into the liquid mixture
6. Add the pecans, dates and chopped cherries
7. Mix thoroughly
8. Crush the cornflakes
9. Drop the teaspoonfuls of dough into the cornflakes and roll to coat
10. Place on a greased cookie sheet gently press a 1/4 slice of cherry in the middle of each cookie (the Wink)
11. Bake at 350° for 15 minutes



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